

ENTREPRENEUR

PREMIUM PROFILE



16 Personalities

What's in This Profile?

This profile is designed to cover all the main aspects of the Entrepreneur personality as it affects different areas of their life, including Entrepreneurs' key strengths and weaknesses, relationships, academic path, career and professional development, as well as their communication and social skills, parenting tips and advice, and much, much more. It combines personality type theory with practical, real-world advice from others who share the Entrepreneur personality type.

As Aristotle said millennia ago, "The hardest victory is the victory over self" – and, to this end, personality types have been considered and studied throughout human history. The information in these pages provides profound personal insight that can help with handling day-to-day situations in healthier, more balanced ways. Consider this profile a plan for success.

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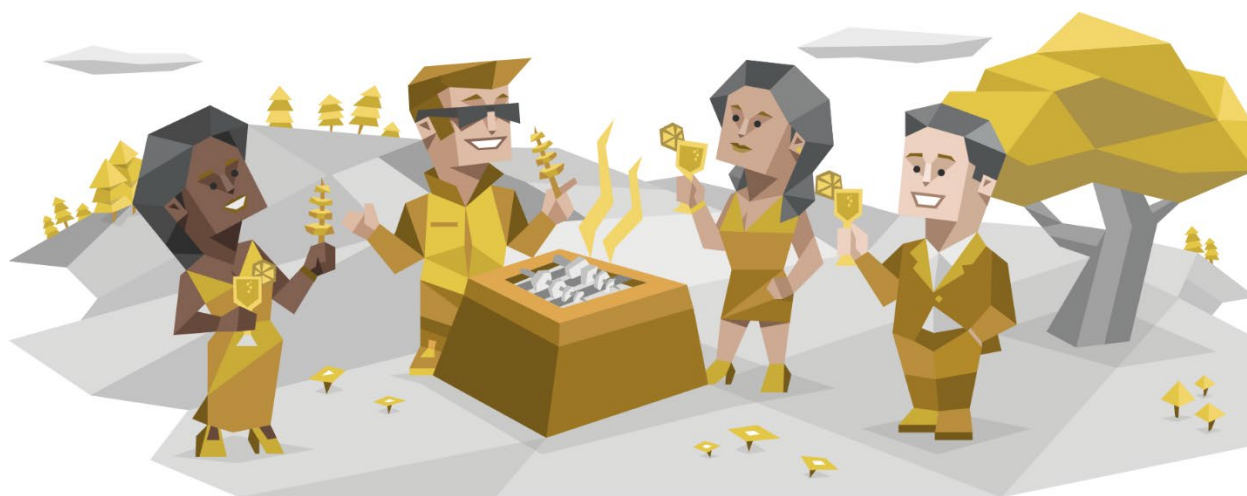
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Who Is “The Entrepreneur?”



This e-book explores how Entrepreneurs’ traits influence their personalities – and their lives. As we’ll explain, these traits produce a unique set of tendencies and behaviors that affect Entrepreneurs’ personal growth, relationships, and academic and professional development. So, let’s embark on a brief overview of the Entrepreneur personality type, venturing into topics that we’ll discuss more extensively in later chapters.

Personal Growth

For Entrepreneurs, life is meant to be experienced – and enjoyed. Spontaneous and action-oriented, people with this personality type crave new opportunities and ventures, from extreme sports to exotic travel. Like other members of the Explorer type group, Entrepreneurs seize the moment, creating a sense of fun and adventure whenever possible. Gregarious and passionate, they thrive on novelty, social energy, and physical pleasures.

However, people with this personality type should pay close attention to how this desire for novelty and pleasure manifests itself. Entrepreneurs may find themselves

drawn to unbalanced, risky, or destructive habits and addictions, such as gambling or substance abuse. Entrepreneurs’ lack of interest in rules, laws, and conventions may compound this tendency.

Through self-awareness, Entrepreneurs can resist unhealthy temptations, satisfying their lust for life and their trailblazing spirits in more balanced and sustainable ways. They can also learn to balance their spontaneity and independence with productive habits that help them manage day-to-day necessities without becoming bogged down in chores or obligations. By establishing healthy priorities and developing relationships with people who are good influences, Entrepreneurs can sideline any propensity toward recklessness and enjoy the best of all worlds: pleasure and fulfillment, novelty and joy.

Relationships

As Extraverts, Entrepreneurs love interacting with other people. They light up a room, drawing everyone’s attention by spurring fun, lively, and sometimes pointed conversations. Whether it’s a hip party or a family reunion, group gatherings energize people with this personality type, showing them at their colorful, confident, and magnetic best.

Beneath their entertaining exteriors, Entrepreneurs have an uncanny ability to discern other people’s thoughts and motives, noticing even the slightest change in someone’s facial expressions or behaviors. This trait helps them “read” other people, establishing new connections and relationships with ease. This ability doesn’t necessarily reflect a strong emotional intelligence. It’s generally more utilitarian than it is empathetic. These types don’t hesitate to speak their minds, and may loudly point out secrets or changes that other people don’t want broadcast – anything from an extra five pounds or a missing wedding ring.

This bluntness typifies Entrepreneurs’ communication style. Although it can spice up a conversation, their sharp humor and extreme candor can hurt or offend more sensitive types. Between their directness and their reliance on facts and logic rather than emotions, Entrepreneurs may inadvertently upset others. In their balanced friendships and romantic relationships, Entrepreneurs temper their frankness with consideration of others’ feelings – even though this emotional awareness may not come easily to them.

On the romance front, Entrepreneurs are enthusiastic and unpredictable – two traits that can make them irresistible. They tend to sweep their partners off their feet, introducing them to new experiences and pleasures. However, commitment doesn’t come easily to this type. Entrepreneurs may bounce from relationship to relationship in an unbalanced manner, craving novelty and stimulation. They may expect their partners to keep up with their high-flying, adrenaline-seeking pace, which is a tall order for most other personality types. To establish true intimacy and cultivate longstanding relationships, Entrepreneurs must take advantage of their innate adaptability and curiosity, finding new delights in their everyday lives with their lovers.

Fortunately, Entrepreneurs bring many strengths to their relationships. They invigorate their partners, make their friends feel alive, and – if they become parents – teach their children just how fascinating the world can be.

Academic and Professional Development

Entrepreneurs are likely to be bored by theories and abstractions, which can cause them to underperform in traditional academic settings. This may affect their self-esteem, particularly regarding their intelligence. Fortunately, most Entrepreneurs discover and harness their unique gifts by adolescence. When they find activities and

pursuits that excite them – whether it’s sports or wilderness first aid – these types unleash their energy and passion, growing into their full potential.

A common mantra for Entrepreneurs is *act first, ask questions later*. This aversion to planning can prove problematic in the workplace or the classroom, particularly with complex, long-term projects. That said, people with this personality type don’t mind stepping back and fixing their mistakes when necessary. Unsurprisingly, Entrepreneurs have little patience for routine tasks or administrative planning, and they’re likely to seek situations where they can avoid or delegate these responsibilities.

Whatever their stage of academic or professional development, pursuits that leverage their strengths are a big draw for Entrepreneurs. These activities might involve competition or physical risk, but they probably require bold improvisation and intense focus on the present moment – two things that come naturally to people with this personality type. Entrepreneurs do best in self-directed environments, free of rigid rules, hierarchies, and protocols. Given their social intelligence, they may gravitate toward settings that take advantage of their ability to read other people. This skill gives them a leg up in a range of environments, from athletics to sales.

In their careers, many people with the Entrepreneur personality type find themselves drawn to emergency response, such as law enforcement, transport medicine, or disaster management. In addition, their easy popularity and networking skills help them climb the ladder in areas such as sales and marketing. Once they move past rigid academic environments, most of these enterprising people find that their observational skills, passionate energy, and quick thinking are invaluable in a range of settings.

On That Note...

In this section, we’ve explored what sets apart people with the Entrepreneur personality type. But a brief introduction can’t do justice to the full scope of Entrepreneurs’ strengths and gifts, let alone how they can counterbalance their weaknesses. In the following chapters, we’ll investigate these areas further, highlighting unexpected insights as well as suggestions and resources for improvement. Understanding one’s personality type is valuable, and we hope that this information proves useful.

Theory Overview

Five Personality Aspects

Introverted (I) vs. Extraverted (E)

People have long noted that some among them are more outgoing and comfortable interacting with their surroundings, and others are more at ease remaining in quiet solitude with their thoughts. You can see the two types in almost any home, office, or classroom. In our first scale, we focus on the difference between Introversion and Extraversion, which we call the Energy scale.

The Energy scale describes how we see and approach the outside world, including people, objects, and activities within it. There are significant links between this scale and things like willingness to volunteer, boredom, thrill seeking, motivation, and romantic assertiveness, to name just a few. The links may not prove one causes the other. However, it does hint at a relationship.

Introverted People: Attuned Inwards

More Internal: Introverts ground themselves more easily in solitude and derive energy from their own thoughts.

More Selective: Introverts are careful when choosing the people with whom they spend time and prefer a quieter environment when they have a choice.

Slow to Offer Opinions: Within reason, Introverts like a little time to process their thoughts and ideas and are slow to offer opinions, fearing they may be too rash.

Extraverted People: Outwardly Engaged

More Outgoing: Extraverts tend to be outgoing both socially and in their willingness to interact with new and interesting environments.

Energetic: Extraverts have an energy that is almost replenished by its expression. They are energized by being energetic and putting themselves in stimulating situations.

Quick with Opinions: Extraverts are generally more comfortable with a flurry of opinions that typically are a part of casual conversations. It's almost like brainstorming ideas on the spot while saving the editing for later.

Intuitive (N) vs. Observant (S)

The second scale in our model is called Mind and addresses Intuitive and Observant styles. Each trait determines what kind of information we focus on and how it is used. It's the foundation on which all the other approaches are built.

All personality types include either those who favor the Intuitive style or those who prefer the Observant style. But before we start, it's important to say that this has nothing to do with how they take in information. The word "Observant" might suggest it does. But Intuitive and Observant types use their five senses in the same way. Rather than how they absorb information, these qualities show how each of these traits manages it once it's received.

Intuitive People: Living in the World of Ideas

Focus on Ideas: Intuitive people are fascinated by the world of ideas and love to discover the connections between various concepts and realities.

Are Deeply Curious: Within the realm of ideas, Intuitive individuals have a strong curiosity that leads them to somewhat adventurous discoveries.

Highly Imaginative: Those who prefer this trait typically stretch concepts to include possibilities beyond the obvious. “What if this not only means... but what if it could also mean...”

Observant People: Feet On the Ground

A Practical Focus: Observant people are more in touch with the concrete world and work within it. They favor consistent actions and measurable results.

Facts Over Theory: These individuals leave theorizing and brainstorming to others, preferring to effectively apply established facts.

More in the Moment: While Observant individuals have a respect for the past and the future, they see them through the lens of what they can do now. The task at hand is always the most important.

Thinking (T) vs. Feeling (F)

The Thinking and Feeling traits determine how we decide matters and cope with emotions. While we all have feelings, there are significant differences in how we react to them and what role those feelings play in our lives. This then influences several other areas, mostly related to our interactions with other people. This is what our third trait, Nature, focuses on.

Thinking People: Where Reason Rules

Rational and Objective: Thinking individuals are most comfortable dealing with things that come from rational thought and involve proven principles.

Logic Over Feelings: While these types often feel quite deeply, they typically place their rationality and logic above any emotional responses.

Constantly Assessing: Thinking people constantly scan ideas and actions to decide whether they make sense or not. They can be valuable in any process that requires any level of critical thinking.

Feeling People: Those Who Follow Their Feelings

Lead from the Heart: Feeling types listen to their feelings, care about how others feel, and are unafraid of sharing this perspective.

Focus on Morals and Ethics: People and their welfare are usually prioritized above any other consideration with the individuals who exhibit the Feeling trait.

A Different Kind of Rationality: While the Feeling type's way of choosing a direction may not always be totally objective, that doesn't mean that they lack rationality. There is practical wisdom in including feelings and consideration for the well-being of oneself and others in the decisions one makes.

Judging (J) vs. Prospecting (P)

The Tactics scale – Judging and Prospecting – is about how people plan and deal with the options they have. But this definition doesn't just concern what individuals write in their day planners. It's much broader. These traits answer questions like, "Do you

prefer spontaneity or certainty?" "Do you feel more comfortable acting only with all your ducks lined neatly in a row? Or does a certain amount of flexibility or chaos excite you and prove motivating?" "Do you need more choices or fewer?"

At its core, this scale determines our attitude toward certainty and structure in our lives, both at mental and physical levels.

Judging People: A Steady Hand

Predictability Rules: Judging types are most at home when there is a clear-cut, well-considered plan that provides sure steps and promotes certain outcomes.

Work Hard: Judging individuals tend to work hard, perhaps seeing strong effort as a way of ensuring predictability.

By the Book: Individuals with this trait usually like to do things by the book and respect reasonable protocols, established techniques, and duties. They sometimes see doing things any other way as "reinventing the wheel."

Prospecting People: Possibilities in the Moment

Relaxed Spontaneity: Prospecting types tend to deal with life and all its opportunities as it comes at them.

Creative: This trait can promote "coloring outside the lines." This can lead to discovering new creative solutions.

Serial Passions: Prospecting individuals may find themselves passing quickly through many interests in their lives. Because of these experiences, they can possess a broad array of knowledge and ideas.

Assertive (-A) vs. Turbulent (-T)

Assertive and Turbulent – the Identity scale – measures how confident one is and how that confidence influences all other traits. The degree that people move more boldly or more timidly affects the way they make choices. It determines how they express their skills. Whether one is too confident to accept criticism or puts too much weight on the criticism of others because they lack self-confidence can make a major difference. The caution or lack of caution people apply to the things they do can color everything.

Assertive People: A Confident Approach

Confident Style: People with the Assertive identity are self-confident and resist stress.

Often Success-Oriented: Because these individuals don't spend hours fretting, it might be assumed they aren't interested in results. For many of them, nothing could be further from the truth.

Responsive and Proactive: Assertive people may jump into a task quickly, not being as burdened with the need to think endlessly about what may go wrong.

Turbulent People: Always Improving

Useful Worry: Turbulent people often worry and engage in self-doubt. While that might sound negative, the flipside of the coin is that it fuels much of their drive and productivity.

Driven to Succeed and Improve: Turbulent individuals are constantly seeking to do better and be better. This pushes them to put great effort into life.

Problem Spotters: Because of their cautious nature and tendency to worry, those with the Turbulent trait often spot problems early and are able to contain them quickly.

Type Groups

Now you know what each type consists of. But how do they fit together?

In our system, we group personality types in two different ways:

- **Roles** determine our goals, interests, and preferred activities.
- **Strategies** reflect our preferred ways of doing things and achieving our goals.

You can think of Roles and Strategies as two ways of organizing personality types into categories. These two categorization methods each highlight different facets of the types. For examples, Roles can show us why certain types share similar interests, and Strategies can explain why certain types approach socializing the way they do.

We discuss Strategies in depth at the end of this e-book, in *The Puzzle of Personality*. With that in mind, let's explore the importance of Roles.

Roles

There are four Roles, each of which groups together four personality types.

- The **Analyst Role** includes Architects (INTJ), Logicians (INTP), Commanders (ENTJ), and Debaters (ENTP).

- The **Diplomat Role** includes Advocates (INFJ), Mediators (INFP), Protagonists (ENFJ), and Campaigners (ENFP).
- The **Sentinel Role** includes Logisticians (ISTJ), Defenders (ISFJ), Executives (ESTJ), and Consuls (ESFJ).
- The **Explorer Role** includes Virtuosos (ISTP), Adventurers (ISFP), Entrepreneurs (ESTP), and Entertainers (ESFP).

So, why do we organize the types in this way? To put it simply, Roles help us to recognize important common ground between personality types.

The types within each Role all share the same Mind trait – either Intuitive or Observant. As you might remember, this trait is incredibly important because it determines how we view the world. As a result, the types within a given Role are alike in a very important respect: they share similar ways of understanding the world and their place within it.

In addition to the Mind trait, the types within a given Role also share the same Nature trait (Thinking or Feeling) or the same Tactics trait (Judging or Prospecting).

Does this seem like information overload? If so, don't worry. To help you get a better grasp of the Roles, let's go through them one by one and find out what makes them tick.

Analysts: Intuitive (N) and Thinking (T)

The personality types in the Analyst Role – Architects, Logicians, Commanders, and Debaters – are known for their irreverent curiosity. Thanks to the Intuitive trait, these types are rarely satisfied with the status quo. Instead, they'll go deep in their search

for ways to make things better, more efficient, and more effective. Meanwhile, the Thinking trait means that they value rationality over emotionality.

Analysts' greatest strengths include:

Driven to learn. Analysts want to know how the world works. In their quest for knowledge, they push the boundaries of their understanding. The result? Their expertise in certain areas can be remarkable.

Questioning natures. Analysts rarely accept things at face value. Ever questioning, they look beyond superficial appearances. This enables them to come up with deep, unexpected insights.

Intellectual energy. Full of fresh, counterintuitive ideas, Analysts know how to spark a lively debate. Conversations with these candid, sharp-witted types can be a breath of fresh air.

Born to improve. Analysts are relentless self-improvers. Once they've recognized a flaw, they apply all their rationality, imagination, and ambition to make it right.

Analysts' forceful imaginations, when trained and focused, enable them to achieve incredible results. But, like anyone, these types can have their Achilles heels, such as:

Lost in thought. Thinking up great ideas gives Analysts a rush. As a result, they're at risk of staying in the realm of thought, never acting out their ideas.

Ever the critic. In the same vein, some Analysts are more comfortable thinking about and critiquing other people's work than jumping into the fray themselves. In time, these types may be frustrated to find themselves outpaced by people with real-world experience.

Hunting for flaws. If taken too far, Analysts desire for improvement can have them hunting down the flaws in everything. As a result, they may undervalue the people and opportunities they encounter.

Emoti-what? Analysts feel more comfortable in the realm of thought than the messy world of emotions. But like anyone, they need to develop emotional literacy in order to deepen their relationships and fully understand themselves.

Fortunately, Analysts have enough creativity and ambition to move beyond these stumbling blocks. When they take action, look for the positive, and train their curiosity on the realm of emotions, these types can grow into their full potential.

Diplomats: Intuitive (N) and Feeling (F)

Diplomats – Advocates, Mediators, Protagonists, and Campaigners – tend to be warm, caring, and generous. Bringing together the Intuitive and Feeling traits, they shine in their understanding of emotions – both their own and other people's. This ability helps them shine when it comes to diplomacy, counseling others, and communication in general.

Diplomats' gifts and talents include:

Emotional literacy. Even when it's far from obvious, Diplomats can often perceive how others are feeling. From the outside, this might look like mind-reading. But in truth, it's a combination of self-reflection and radical compassion that helps Diplomats understand others' emotional states.

Only connect. Diplomats don't use their people skills to manipulate others. Instead, they aim to nurture genuine connections with the people they encounter. Moreover, many Diplomats feel called to serve others however they can.

Do no harm. Deep down, Diplomats want what's best for everyone. For them, causing someone else distress would feel like a wound to their own psyche. As a result, these types aim to promote cooperation and harmony rather than conflict.

Creators at work. Profoundly creative, Diplomats are always on the hunt for inspiration. Whether or not they take up artistic pursuits, these types tend to enjoy self-exploration and self-expression.

Diplomats have high ideals. For them, kindness and altruism burn as brightly as a fire on a chilly winter's night. But if left unchecked, this idealism can have its downsides, including:

Impractical magic. Tempering passion with cold practicality is a challenge for Diplomats. These types are often reluctant to make tough decisions – especially if those decisions require them to compromise on their ideals or hurt someone's feelings.

Beautiful ideas. Diplomats have the best of intentions, and they have countless ideas about ways to help people. They're at risk, however, of staying stuck in the realm of ideas instead of taking action and sticking to a plan.

Taking on too much. In their efforts to make a difference, Diplomats may overcommit themselves – emotionally, physically, or even financially. If they don't deliver everything they'd hoped, they may feel overwhelmed or disappointed in themselves.

Easily hurt. Sensitive to criticism and rejection, these types may react strongly if other people question the value of their ideals. Disagreement and conflict can leave Diplomats feeling discouraged and hurt.

In all their actions, Diplomats crave a sense of meaning and purpose. Specifically, they feel called to cultivate positive change and gentle beauty in the world around them. Motivated by intangible rewards felt in the heart and soul, these types have a conviction to serve the greater good.

Sentinels: Observant (S) and Judging (J)

Sentinels – Logisticians, Defenders, Executives, and Consuls – are cooperative and practical. This grounded approach helps them feel comfortable with themselves just as they are. Steadfast and hardworking, these types pride themselves on their character and competence.

Here are some of the ways that Sentinels contribute to their homes, workplaces, social circles, and beyond:

Loving duty. These types feel a deep responsibility for those they care about. Specifically, Sentinels feel duty-bound to keep their loved ones safe and to help them lead good lives.

Always on time. Sure, Sentinels might occasionally fall behind schedule. But most of the time, they pride themselves on being unfailingly reliable. As a result, friends, loved ones, and coworkers can trust that Sentinels won't flake on their commitments.

Keepers of tradition. Sentinels work hard to maintain the ways things are done. In their home life, this means they love to continue family traditions. At the workplace, these types keep track of and defend best practices.

Unwavering diligence. Sentinels aren't afraid of hard work. On a daily basis, they practice their virtues of consistency and persistence, refusing to take shortcuts or

stop before their work is done. And in situations where someone needs to step up and take responsibility, Sentinels can be counted on to come through.

Sentinels feel bolstered by having reliable people in their lives, and they make it a priority to hold up their end of the bargain. But even these dependable types can have their challenges, including:

Resistance to change. For Sentinels, trying new ways of doing things can feel wrong – almost like breaking an unwritten set of rules. These types can be skeptical of change, and they may stick with suboptimal choices on the grounds of “that’s how it’s always been done.”

Stubbornness toward others. Similarly, Sentinels may feel personally affronted when other people upset the status quo. What someone else might describe as “experimenting with new ideas” may seem reckless or disrespectful to Sentinels. As a result, these types might dig in their heels, even if that means forestalling progress.

Imposing their values. Sentinels love to give advice and shepherd people toward better lives – at least, what Sentinels consider better lives. It may be hard for these types to accept that not everyone holds stability, tradition, and respectability among their core values. And when other people don’t follow their advice, Sentinels may want to judge them harshly.

Sentinels’ loyalty and steadfastness shine in many situations. When they balance their firm convictions with curiosity and openness, these types can become nothing short of inspirations to the people in their lives.

Explorers: Observant (S) and Prospecting (P)

Explorers – Virtuosos, Adventurers, Entrepreneurs, and Entertainers – are self-reliant and quick-thinking. They're always ready to tackle a challenge or act on the spur of the moment. This spontaneity doesn't only help them solve problems – it also enables them to find opportunities for enjoyment in their everyday lives.

Here are a few of Explorers' notable strengths:

Surfing the waves. Many people struggle with change, but not Explorers. These types can adapt to new situations with minimal regret or second-guessing. In fact, they often enjoy change and appreciate breaks from routine.

Socially dynamic. Because of their openness, many Explorers enjoy meeting new people and trying out new social experiences. This helps them to build a network of diverse and interesting friends and acquaintances.

Getting things done. Explorers don't overthink things. Instead, they leap into action and get the job done. These types spend their energy on taking concrete steps, only pausing to consider abstract ideas or nitty-gritty details when it's absolutely necessary.

Picking up techniques. Utilitarian in their way, Explorers love to master new tools and techniques. Whatever their hobbies and passions, these types enjoy the challenge of building their skills and picking up new ways of doing things.

Explorers enjoy being free of obligations, where they can indulge themselves or their interests on their own time. Like most traits, this has its upsides and its downsides. Here are some tendencies that Explorers may need to counteract:

Losing interest. We all lose interest in our activities from time to time. But Explorers often run out of motivation as soon as a project no longer feels fun, novel, or exciting.

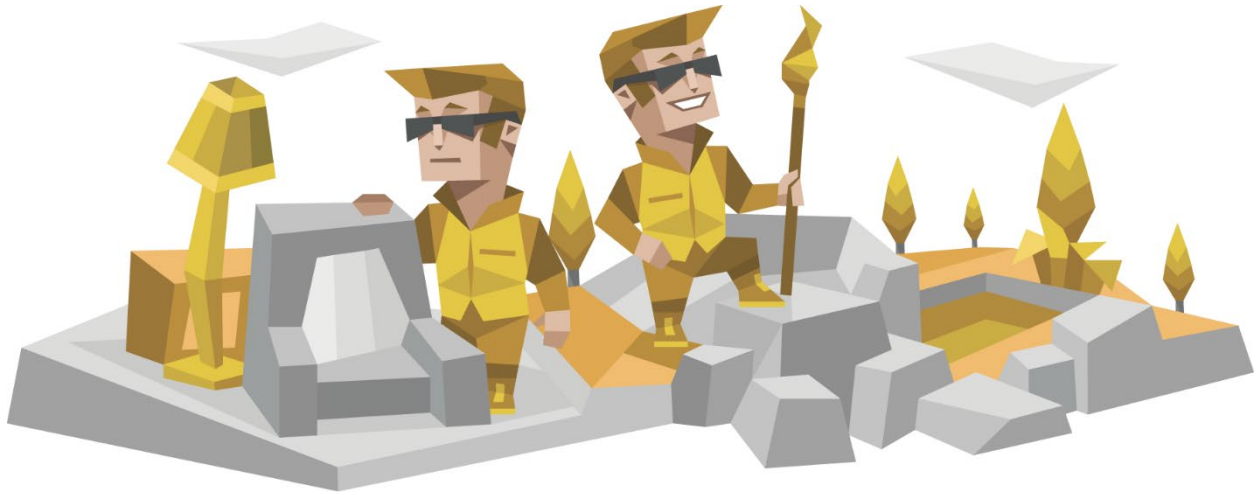
What planning? Explorers prefer to deal with challenges on the fly rather than plan ahead. Alas, sometimes an ounce of planning really is worth a pound of cure.

Risky business. Explorers are drawn to pleasure, risk, and – sometimes – risky pleasures. As they grow and mature, however, they often learn that some risks simply aren't worth taking.

Explorers connect with the world in a way that's almost childlike in its wonder and sheer fun. It can be a challenge for them to work for things with a distant or unexciting payoff, but when they harness their passion and administer just enough self-discipline, they can move heaven and earth.

Now, let's talk about you.

Personal Growth



Personal growth isn't the one-size-fits-all affair that some self-help books would have readers believe. For Entrepreneurs, personal growth is always about balancing spontaneity with responsibility, independence with intimacy, and desire for novelty with an appreciation for things as they are. The goal is never about changing individual Entrepreneurs' essential characteristics but about them expanding to acquire a greater array of tools that allow them to operate beyond just their trait-based impulses alone. Personal growth is always about defying the boundaries of one's comfort zone while simultaneously not losing one's true self.

For Entrepreneurs to grow, they must first develop self-awareness, assessing themselves and their behaviors. Are these behaviors pleasant in the moment but harmful in the long run? Entrepreneurs should then ask themselves what they want from life, both now and in the future. This thinking need not box them into rigid plans which can be uncomfortable for them. Considering the future can open new and more fulfilling possibilities. The final step of growth involves replacing unhealthy behaviors with new behaviors that bring Entrepreneurs closer to what they want in life.

However, not all growth is the product of deliberate effort. Sometimes it emerges gently from the subtle shifts caused by age and maturity, and sometimes life harshly demands growth through hard times and crises. No matter the method, as the saying goes, “You’re either getting better, or you’re getting worse. There is no staying the same.”

Motivation and Development

Entrepreneurs can consider personal growth in three closely related, but distinct, areas that relate to internally developing self-regard:

- **Self-esteem** speaks to how much Entrepreneurs like themselves. Accepting both their flaws and strengths creates a base of internal appreciation that enables change motivated by desire instead of shame.
- **Self-respect** speaks to their sense of worth. People with this personality type value rational logic, and when they live their beliefs and values, a balanced sense of pride in who they are follows.
- **Self-confidence** is the energy source that moves Entrepreneurs forward in life. When belief in their abilities is confirmed using their skills, Entrepreneurs are driven to make steady progress.

If these three core aspects are properly balanced, they can promote a successful and fulfilling life. Should elements become unbalanced, however, they become a source of overwhelming difficulty. For example, when Entrepreneurs feel a lack of self-confidence, they might behave in certain ways to boost their confidence. Problems arise, however, when they overcompensate to do so and consequently throw their lives out of balance.

Moving Forward

In the following sections, we'll first examine Entrepreneurs' characteristics in their ideal, balanced, and fully developed form. Using these motivational aspects in balanced ways helps Entrepreneurs lead fulfilling, productive, and happy lives.

Next, we'll describe the tendencies that emerge if these aspects become unbalanced. These represent departures from healthy, productive motivational strategies and explain adverse effects Entrepreneurs experience when they disconnect from their true selves.

Finally, we'll discuss what can be done to improve balance in each of the motivational aspects.

Self-Esteem

It's common for rational people to struggle to reconcile their emotions with their intellect, which Entrepreneurs often apply to their mastery of skills. Those who maintain harmony between the two create strong foundations in their lives that bring stability and satisfaction. The conflict between their drive and the rest of their lives can inhibit happiness and dry up inspiration, while a sense that they've balanced the two allows good things to happen. Entrepreneurs must decide how to satisfy their self-esteem fueled drive while appreciating the other parts of their lives.

Balanced Self-Esteem

For Entrepreneurs, a sense of competence and mastery enhances their sense of self-esteem. In endeavors that matter to them, these individuals aim to constantly hone their skills, innovate, and improve. Unwilling to settle for the status quo, they feel

driven to experiment thanks to their natural curiosity, their extraordinary perception, and their creative edge. This willingness to try new things and push past old limits naturally leads to mastery of a skill or a situation.

Entrepreneurs always want to improve, but they also appreciate how far they've come. Although they love "impossible" challenges, they accept that not every experiment can work out. They recognize their strengths and their weaknesses, and neither self-adulation nor self-criticism hinders their doing a good job.

Unbalanced Self-Esteem

When their self-esteem is unbalanced, Entrepreneurs are likely to believe that dominating their field can restore their self-worth. They may sacrifice important aspects of their life – such as their relationships – in pursuit of mastery. Alas, pursuing perfection is never-ending, and external accomplishments aren't a stable foundation for self-esteem.

When Entrepreneurs focus almost exclusively on their area of expertise, it might delight their employers, teachers, or coaches. This intense, narrow focus can cause collateral damage in other areas, however. Sometimes Entrepreneurs must choose between pursuing their goals and caring for others' needs. When this happens, some choose their goals over their relationships.

It's important to note that Entrepreneurs don't do this because they dislike people. However, because they don't want to be distracted from their work during these times, Entrepreneurs can sideline other people's needs, whether it means canceling a call with a friend who's having a hard time or not taking the kids to soccer practice. In extreme cases, Entrepreneurs might achieve mastery but alienate their spouses, friends, and family.

Rebalancing Self-Esteem

When the quest for mastery becomes an obsession, Entrepreneurs must step back and see the bigger picture – specifically, what areas of their lives they're neglecting. To do so, they can look to their calendars for clues on how they spend their time. Specifically, Entrepreneurs should note how much time they devote per week to each of these areas: work or school, family, friends, self-care, sleep, hobbies, and downtime.

Once they see this breakdown, Entrepreneurs can ask themselves whether the way they spend their time reflects their values. Are they shortchanging their health or their relationships? How can they redistribute their time and attention to move toward an ideal schedule?

As they change their lives, Entrepreneurs can take heart by reminding themselves that self-esteem built on a single area of accomplishment isn't sustainable in the long run. By focusing on competence and growth rather than perfection, Entrepreneurs can leave room in their lives for the other things that matter.

Self-Respect

For Entrepreneurs, self-respect comes from their ability to think on their feet and solve problems on almost an improvisational level. Their self-respect doesn't involve deep deliberation. They prefer the action encompassed in assessing a situation and providing a hands-on solution. It doesn't matter which discipline they master – the dynamic is the same. They like to think of themselves as individuals who can manipulate the different parts of their specialties to provide results.

Balanced Self-Respect

Predictability and stability bring no sense of fulfillment to Entrepreneurs. Instead, these individuals like themselves best when they see themselves as flexible and able to deal skillfully with the unexpected. People with this personality type assess themselves by how well they solve problems. In striving for self-respect, Entrepreneurs hone and exercise their skill at handling sudden predicaments.

While most personality types want stability, Entrepreneurs find no satisfaction in metaphorical “solid ground.” They want to navigate choppy waters, taking pride in their ability to steer through even the toughest storms. Entrepreneurs’ ability to think on their feet is the one trait they like best about themselves. When they’re able to tackle time-critical situations, people with this personality type recognize the gifts and strengths they bring to the world.

Unbalanced Self-Respect

To enhance their self-respect, some Entrepreneurs may take on needless risks, seeking out crises, emergencies, or even dangerous circumstances to prove their value. The people in their lives – including partners, friends, and coworkers – are often alarmed by this unbalanced desire to seek out problems and precarious situations. They may see these Entrepreneurs as careless, unstable, undependable, or even dangerous.

Entrepreneurs with such an unbalanced approach tend to tune out other people’s guidance – even advice from those they trust – when they find themselves “on a mission.” Think of Don Draper on the television series *Mad Men* and the unpopular, bold risks he took to solve problems at his ad agency. These maneuvers are generally single-minded, ignoring other people’s needs, feelings, and preferences.

Entrepreneurs whose self-respect is fueled by adrenaline and risk may inadvertently hurt or push away the people they love.

Rebalancing Self-Respect

To rebalance their self-respect, Entrepreneurs can write out a list of things they like about themselves. This should include several other traits besides their ability to solve problems on the fly. Do they appreciate their curiosity? The way they introduce friends and loved ones to exciting new experiences? Their ability to find joy in travel, exploration, or stimulating conversation?

Entrepreneurs have *many* strengths. By learning to appreciate themselves for everything they are, they won't need to seek precarious circumstances – or ignore other people's needs – to feel genuine self-respect.

Self-Confidence

Many credit German writer and statesman Goethe with saying, "Boldness has genius, power and magic in it. Begin it now." This quote is music to the ears of Entrepreneurs. A sense of boldness gives them the confidence and energy they need to move forward in life.

Balanced Self-Confidence

Entrepreneurs tend to have little regard for traditional standards or rules, which are too confining for their creative imaginations. Spontaneous experiments and explorations energize people with this personality type, who always want to find the "next new thing." Where other people dread change, Entrepreneurs typically embrace it.

Unbalanced Self-Confidence

We admire boldness in our culture, and our typical hero is likely to be bold and act in bigger-than-life ways. Entrepreneurs can take this too far, making unbalanced, audacious, and dramatic decisions whether or not the situation calls for them. These Entrepreneurs may rashly disregard plans, agreements, or even good sense. Every now and then this recklessness may pay off, inflating their self-esteem, but at other times the results are disastrous.

When Entrepreneurs make unfounded decisions that affect other people, they risk disconnecting themselves from their colleagues, their social network, and their loved ones. If they don't balance their actions with common sense and consideration of other people's needs, then the people around them may just shake their heads at what they only see as erratic behavior.

Rebalancing Self-Confidence

Mission statements have become a staple for goal setting and self-improvement – for a good reason. These statements help people and organizations identify what matters to them and how they can act in alignment with these values. Entrepreneurs might not love long-term planning, but mission statements can help them recognize and explore the possibilities available to them – something they find intensely gratifying. In addition, when they recognize their core values, they're less likely to sacrifice them for adrenaline highs, erratic decisions, or confidence boosts.

To identify their values and priorities, Entrepreneurs should ask themselves these questions:

- “If I had one day left to live, what would I do?”
- “If I had one year left to live, what would I do?”

- “If I had unlimited financial resources, how would I use them to make a difference in the world?”
- “What would an ideal romantic relationship look like to me? How about an ideal social life? An ideal family life?”

Once they’ve answered these questions, they can organize their insights into personal mission statements, which can serve as types of treasure maps in their pursuit of the lives they want.

Pursuing Personal Growth

Entrepreneurs embody a curious paradox. Gregarious and charismatic, they draw people to them. At parties, people flock around them, trying to edge in on their conversations – which are, more likely than not, fascinating. Romantic partners may fall head over heels for Entrepreneurs, attracted to their adventurous, passionate spirits. These influences can come with some pitfalls, however. Although Entrepreneurs are logical and utilitarian, they must balance their persuasive powers with consideration of others’ feelings.

Another area where Entrepreneurs may struggle is planning and consistency. Spontaneous to the point of thrill seeking, these individuals like to live in the moment and leave their options open. This mindset can create problems, however, preventing them from reaching their full potential in their careers, their relationships, and their daily lives.

Let’s explore these areas further and consider how Entrepreneurs can make use of their strengths while counterbalancing their weaknesses.

Interpersonal Effectiveness

Balanced Interpersonal Effectiveness

Outsiders may think that Entrepreneurs are very empathic and sensitive. In reality, they're using their observation and improvisation skills, instinctively knowing how they should react to what other people say or do. This usually leads to their becoming quite popular in many professional and personal circles.

Entrepreneurs can leverage their interpersonal strengths in balanced ways and approach all their relationships – whether they're intimate relationships or business partnerships – with integrity. By cultivating balanced awareness of other people's needs, feelings, and desires, Entrepreneurs can pursue their own interests without steamrolling over the people in their lives.

Unbalanced Interpersonal Effectiveness

If they wish, Entrepreneurs can exploit other people's weaknesses, manipulating or convincing them to do things that go against their best interests. They're likely to have the potential to become outstanding innovators or brilliant con artists. It's up to them to decide where to draw the line.

Used to getting what they want through subtle manipulation, some Entrepreneurs may exploit people, casting aside any scruples or consideration of others. Deeply utilitarian at heart, these individuals worry little about external rules or guidelines. They may take this an unbalanced step further, advancing their own self-interest through selfish or even antisocial activities.

These manipulations can take on more subtle manifestations. Entrepreneurs have a sensation-seeking personality, and they cherish variety and unpredictability. They

may engineer dramas in unbalanced ways, convincing other people to perform inadvisable acts just for the excitement. For example, they might persuade friends to commit misdemeanors or colleagues to say something inflammatory to their bosses. When acting in an unbalanced manner, Entrepreneurs have only a superficial appreciation or awareness of other's feelings, so they have few qualms about using people for their benefit.

Rebalancing Interpersonal Effectiveness

Entrepreneurs can honor their integrity and deepen their relationships by developing their emotional intelligence. This doesn't come easily to them, even though their Extraversion and their observational skills help them enjoy sociable, well connected lives. Beneath the surface, Entrepreneurs may have significant difficulties expressing how they feel and recognizing other people's emotions – something that proves limiting in their close relationships. If such skills are left underdeveloped, their friends and partners are likely to feel as if something is missing.

Because Entrepreneurs can infer so much about people through their interactions, it might not occur to them that the simplest way to discover how someone feels is to ask. With reflection, Entrepreneurs might realize that they're viewing the people in their lives as pawns to be influenced or managed. In these situations, these individuals would do well to ask these questions:

- “What are you feeling or thinking right now?”
- “What do you need from me?”
- “How can we proceed in a way that is good for both of us?”

Once Entrepreneurs hear the answers to these questions, they can use the resulting insights to channel their interpersonal abilities in positive directions, striving toward mutual benefit rather than personal gain.

Planning

Balanced Planning

Entrepreneurs, with their nerves of steel, epitomize grace under pressure and can often save themselves through their highly developed observation skills and willingness to do everything and anything to achieve their goals. Some of their favorite memories may involve close scrapes or unexpected adventures.

However, Entrepreneurs at their best recognize that true freedom requires planning – whether this means setting up a retirement account, seeing the doctor for a physical, or getting routine maintenance for a car. The adventures they crave rarely entail going broke, getting sick, or waiting on the side of the road for a tow truck. By doing enough planning to get by, Entrepreneurs leave room in their lives for the experiences that matter to them.

Unbalanced Planning

Alas, even Entrepreneurs sometimes run out of luck. Those who approach their lives in an unbalanced manner may be spontaneous to the point of carelessness, unwilling to make or stick to plans. It's true that optimism enables these types to notice and take advantage of various opportunities, but they may take this too far. Prioritizing quick action over research or analysis, they may make unbalanced snap decisions and hope for the best.

In their professional lives, this leaves Entrepreneurs vulnerable to critics, who might emphasize mistakes they've made or matters they have left unattended. In their unbalanced private lives, Entrepreneurs may neglect longer-term endeavors, such as financial planning, home maintenance, or even managing their health.

Rebalancing Planning

Let's face it: Entrepreneurs aren't likely to stick to complicated action plans or spend hours each day maintaining their calendars. Instead, they can incorporate planning into their lives by recruiting friends, colleagues, and professionals with expertise in such relevant areas. For example, Entrepreneurs might ask meticulous coworkers to collaborate on projects, hire accountants or financial planners to ensure they manage their finances, or ask savvy friends to help them identify what improvements they must make to their homes. By getting assistance with planning, Entrepreneurs can save time and energy to focus on their true strengths.

Making Good Use of Entrepreneur Traits

Entrepreneurs have many gifts and talents, particularly their spontaneity and adaptability. They may find themselves with too much of a good thing, however. Let's investigate how Entrepreneurs can use their strengths – and avoid being used by them.

Spontaneity

Balanced Spontaneity

Entrepreneurs' most impressive trait is their ability to "think on their feet" – people with this personality type can make snap decisions, staying cool in stressful situations. They're excellent troubleshooters, especially where there's a need to act quickly and ignore the established procedures. Entrepreneurs are fiercely utilitarian, willing to do what it takes to get the job done, even if it means breaking with existing traditions or dismissing people who disapprove of their sometimes-renegade action.

If the circumstances are right, people with this personality type shouldn't be reluctant to embrace their spontaneity, which enables them to notice and seize opportunities that other personality types might miss. Entrepreneurs are well equipped to make the most of difficult situations, dealing with unexpected challenges and succeeding with scarce resources. This enables them to excel in unfavorable environments, knowing exactly how far the limits can be pushed, what tactics can be pursued, and which resources can be utilized.

Unbalanced Spontaneity

In their younger years, Entrepreneurs' spontaneity may have been discouraged by authority figures who told them to be methodical, honor tradition, and follow well-established paths. This is most likely to occur in such highly structured environments as schools or public institutions. Young Entrepreneurs may often feel as if their strengths are undervalued and may even repress their spontaneity and desire for excitement.

When Entrepreneurs discover the value of their spontaneity, they may go overboard and take it to the extreme, refusing to commit to a course of action even when necessary. They may move on from jobs and abandon half-finished projects in an unbalanced manner whenever fresh challenges present themselves. This roving approach can even extend to their personal lives, with Entrepreneurs refusing to assure their loved ones of their constancy. To justify this unbalanced lack of commitment, they might argue that life is unpredictable, and they want to live in the moment.

This unbalanced attitude fails to take other people's needs into account. Romantic partners, family members, and even friends may pull away or become hurt if they feel they can't depend on Entrepreneurs to be there for them. Unless these types recognize the validity of other people's needs – including reassurance, devotion, and loyalty – they won't be able to enjoy strong, lasting relationships.

Rebalancing Spontaneity

Flexibility and adaptability are among Entrepreneurs' greatest strengths, and people with this personality type should seek careers, academic paths, and hobbies that leverage their abilities in these areas. When their personal lives are balanced, however, Entrepreneurs pay attention to other people's needs and expectations, including the need for commitment when appropriate.

To rebalance their spontaneity with demonstrations of loyalty to the people who matter, Entrepreneurs can make a list of their most important relationships, including friends, family members, and romantic partners. With this list in mind, they can use their flexibility to their advantage, looking for spontaneous ways to demonstrate affection, care, and support for these people. For example, they might take their partners on spur-of-the-moment weekend trips, swing by to visit friends

with takeout from a new restaurant, or pull off the road and pick wildflowers for their children. These unexpected gestures can reassure people of Entrepreneurs' care and support.

Conclusion

Entrepreneurs find acting in ways that bring about effective and immediate results gives them meaning and purpose, and they always seek to develop on that level. They hone their very lives to be fine and effective tools. Such refinement of themselves, as craftspeople in all senses of the word, is their medium of preferred growth. It's the easy way for them to grow.

The harder way that Entrepreneurs can grow involves stopping long enough to thoughtfully plan and create consistency in their lives. It's taking the time to see how other people are doing during their flurry of activity. This can bring them more satisfaction. Most people need others to comfortably fit into their lives – and there's happiness for Entrepreneurs who figure out how to do this well.

There are classes everywhere called "life skills classes," verifying what everyone already knows. Life is a skill. It involves skill building. It's something to tinker with. It's something to polish. Developing a life and attaining personal growth fits the Entrepreneurs' foundational skillset perfectly.

Additional Tools and Tests

Want to dig even deeper into your personal growth? If you have access to the toolkits area of the website, we offer a variety of additional tools and tests to help you explore.

Locus of Control Test

Dig deeper into who or what you feel is responsible for your life satisfaction, happiness, and level of fulfillment.

Emotional Intelligence Test

Find out how good you are at understanding your own emotions as well as paying attention to the emotions of others with this test.

Confidence Test

How much do you believe in your competence and ability to successfully follow through on the choices you make? Let's find out.

Dark and Light Side Test

Your moral choices may not be as simple as you think. This test asks you to go deep and take an honest look at your attitudes.

Resilience and Grit Test

Some people are hard to knock down; some find it easy to get back up; and some are both or neither. Which group do you belong to?

Coping Styles Test

There are four primary ways to cope with crisis. This test explores the dominant and secondary techniques you're likely to turn to.

Optimism and Pessimism Test

This simple test measures your levels of both optimism and pessimism in a novel way. Find out where you fall in each of these areas.

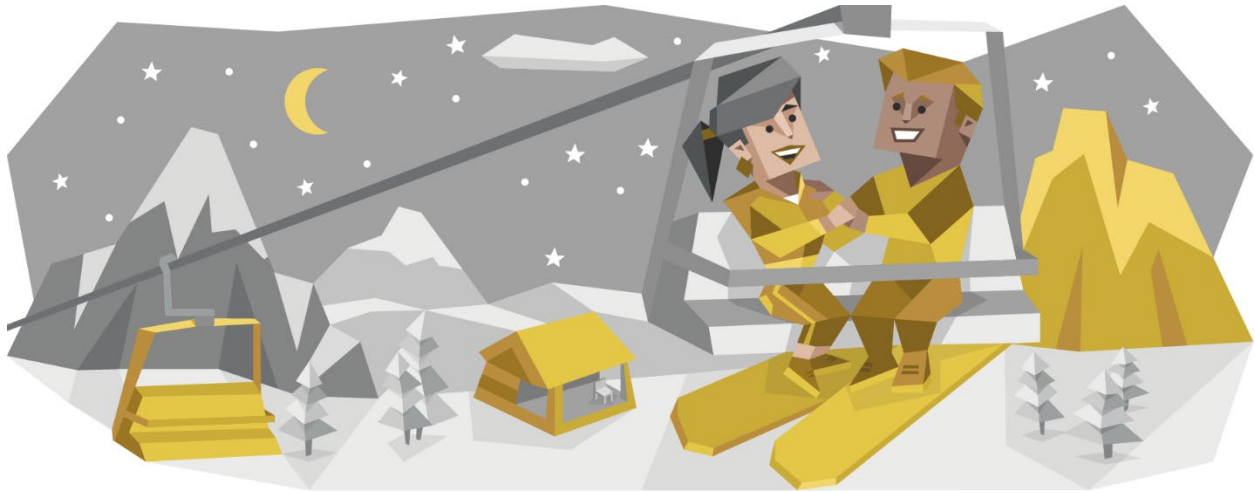
Imagination and Magic Beliefs Test

How does your imagination work? What is your belief about magic? Explore the role of imagination, magic, and belief in your life.

Traveling Preferences Test

This simple test delves into your preferred choices during those times when you leave home to explore the world.

Romantic Relationships



Entrepreneurs tend to be enthusiastic, often unpredictable individuals who know how to enjoy the present moment and have fun regardless of what they're doing – this applies to their relationships as well. People with this personality type are very good at improvisation, and this trait is usually clearly visible, especially when Entrepreneurs are still dating. Whatever happens, their partners can never complain that their relationships were boring.

Dating and Single Entrepreneurs

Entrepreneurs enjoy practical, fun activities and encourage their partners to explore them as well. It's very unlikely that someone with this personality type enjoys long conversations revolving around philosophical topics – rather, they'll come up with yet another little hobby or an interesting idea. However, every stick has two ends and the Entrepreneurs' need for excitement can also endanger the stability of their relationships. If they get bored, they're prone to seek other sources of excitement – and this may result in them looking for new partners. As Entrepreneurs also tend to be very charming and popular, this is rarely a daunting task for them.

This doesn't mean that all Entrepreneurs are unfaithful in romantic relationships. While they're more likely to engage in risky behavior than most other personality types, they're also rational thinkers, able to control such urges if they so choose. Besides the thirst for excitement they're known for, people with this personality type also dislike long-term planning and prefer dealing with things as they come, taking everything day by day. This attitude permeates their relationships as well – they simply reevaluate their commitments daily and adjust their behavior accordingly.

Entrepreneurs are very perceptive and able to notice even the slightest change in their partners' moods or behaviors. Even though they aren't very sensitive or emotional, this impressive perceptiveness makes it easier for Entrepreneurs to recognize their beloveds' needs and desires. And, since Entrepreneurs always know how to surprise their partners, their unpredictability and curiosity are likely to keep the romantic flames burning – if they're willing to put in the effort.

Entrepreneurs in the Bedroom

From a sexual perspective, Entrepreneurs tend to like to have fun and enjoy the physical bond with their partners. People with this personality type also tend to be very sensual and willing to experiment. They usually find it easy to separate sex and love, which can also cause tension in their relationships. Many other personality types see intimacy as one of the best ways to express their love and expect their Entrepreneur sweethearts to verbalize their feelings or at least express them in non-verbal ways in such situations. In contrast, Entrepreneurs tend to approach intimacy from a purely physical perspective.

Potential Role Pairings

Let's now look at the relationship dynamic between different type Roles and see how those combinations work in romantic relationships. Each combination brings different things into romance, sometimes positive and sometimes negative – knowing what to expect can help further down the road. However, everyone is unique, and what's true for one may not be true for another.

Entrepreneur-Analyst Relationships



Both Entrepreneurs and Analysts prefer rationality, and neither is very comfortable in the realm of emotions. This combination can create compatible couples who savor each other's logic, or it can hinder the deepening of their emotional lives, depending on their overall needs and desires. Though in different ways, both types are oriented toward finding solutions, and this enhances this relationship combination.

Balanced Entrepreneur-Analyst Relationships

Analysts are Intuitive Thinkers. When these types begin relationships with Entrepreneurs, who are Observant Prospectors, it can be one of the most challenging, yet potentially most rewarding combinations.

Analysts have heads full of ideas, visions for the future, and complicated systems. They seek and absorb knowledge. There's a constant deconstruction and reconstruction of ideas on a higher order going on all the time with Analysts.

Entrepreneurs live fully in the present. They're curious about everything – except long-winded conversations based on abstractions and ideas. Always looking for what's new and exciting, they often seek challenges of a material and physical nature they can master or conquer, such as a musical instrument or a craft. However, both types enjoy solving things: for Analysts, it's theoretical puzzles, and for Entrepreneurs, it's finding solutions to real and immediate problems.

So, what happens when Entrepreneurs and Analysts get together on dates? Starting from an optimistic place, Analysts might impress Entrepreneurs with their theories for a while if they can connect them to something practical. Technically-oriented Analysts who are talking about writing computer code, for example, may excite Entrepreneurs who typically appreciate tools and devices. Analysts, on the other hand, may enjoy Entrepreneurs' spontaneity and the practical perspective they bring to conversations.

Should Analysts and Entrepreneurs become serious and commit to each other, each type might appreciate the other's lack of concern for social convention. There won't be as much pressure as there might be with Sentinels. They can go through life together nearly oblivious to social expectations if they so choose. They may also appreciate the breathing room likely to be granted by their partners. Analysts can seem almost entirely detached from their home lives when in the middle of a project. This could work out well for Entrepreneurs, as it gives them ample time to discover more about their world in their way. Nobody is likely to accuse pairs made up of these types of smothering each other.

Unbalanced Entrepreneur–Analyst Relationships

Sometimes the schism between the Intuitive and Observant traits is too great to bridge, and these romantic partners may spend time wondering what they're doing wrong, why their significant others seem to misunderstand them all the time, and why they just don't listen.

While Entrepreneurs aren't exceedingly sensitive to others' opinions, Analysts should always be aware they can strike others as being condescending. Analysts can easily convey to Entrepreneurs that their work or contribution to the world may not be as "deep" and, therefore, not as important. This may come across in subtle ways, but it also wouldn't be too far-fetched to imagine Analysts announcing it out loud. Coming across as superior can cause a lot of hurt in relationships, and Analysts must learn to take care of their lovers' feelings.

Analysts may also be attracted to Entrepreneurs' looser, fun-loving nature and see this characteristic as something that could balance their own more serious lives. Too much spontaneity, however, may color Entrepreneurs as too frivolous in their Analyst partners' eyes.

Entrepreneurs may become impatient with Analysts' constant hunger for more knowledge and their need to theorize about everything. Entrepreneurs might look at their partners as stodgy or out-of-touch with anything the least bit interesting. Should Analysts go on too long and slip into the theoretical, as they often do, they may quickly lose their Entrepreneur love interests.

Finally, small details aren't likely to interest Analysts, nor are they usually involved with a lot that's hands-on and mundane. This may leave Entrepreneurs to deal with such matters in their shared household in their somewhat casual fashion. While it

may sound like a small issue, things like this can take on exaggerated importance when the clothes are piled high in the middle of the bedroom floor.

Rebalancing Entrepreneur–Analyst Relationships

Luckily, all isn't lost for Entrepreneur–Analyst lovers. Both types can acknowledge their differences and turn them into strengths that neutralize each other's weaknesses.

Let's begin with taking a deeper look at Analysts' seeming lack of emotion. While Analysts may appear at times as if they're without feelings, the truth is they often feel quite deeply. They just don't necessarily feel comfortable expressing their emotions. Entrepreneurs may learn in time that it's just as possible to hurt their Analyst partners' feelings as it is anyone else's. Analysts need to come out of their cloud of concepts occasionally, and there's no better way than being invited to play in their Entrepreneur lovers' playgrounds of discovery. So, rather than becoming irritated at what they perceive as Analysts' stodginess, Entrepreneurs can encourage Analyst partners to come along on their adventures and to learn to appreciate their perspectives as well.

To build better balance into these relationships, Entrepreneurs can try to:

- Bring them into their world – occasionally. Entrepreneurs might want to invite their Analyst partners, who typically overthink everything, to try experiences that involve a more hands-on and spontaneous approach, such as introducing them to an artisan craft or a physical skill like rock climbing or dancing. Physical intimacy is a great way to lure Analysts away from their preoccupations. However, such calls to action should be done in moderation. “Fixing” Analysts to make them more like themselves may be tempting for

Entrepreneurs, but there's nothing to fix. They are who they are. But occasional excursions into each other's worlds may help build balance into these relationships.

- Save spontaneity for the right time. Entrepreneurs can remember that Analyst partners don't share their love for the present moment; in fact, their constant spontaneity may exhaust Analysts. Entrepreneurs can prioritize and store their spontaneous impulses for use later if necessary. They may want to occasionally make it a priority to skip a beat so that Analysts they love have the room they need to deliberate without the distraction of the Entrepreneurs' constant busyness. "There's no reason to do this right now. Let's think about it for a bit," may be all Analysts need to hear occasionally from Entrepreneurs to feel more at home in various situations. Look for opportunities to indulge their preferences.
- Set some ground rules about communication. This should be easy for two such problem-solving types. Neither type is particularly sensitive to feelings, so a communication construct that, for lack of a better word, "artificially" protects feelings may be helpful. For example, they can take an inventory of communication that feels hurtful or demeaning. From that list, decide what's out of bounds, what isn't, and why. Rules, such as using "I feel" statements to take responsibility and avoid directly placing blame, can be helpful. ("When you do that... I feel...") These sorts of rules not only cue their partners that they're entering hurtful territory but also deliberately identify when something touches an emotion. In this way, they can also help each other access their feelings more.

Both Analysts and Entrepreneurs can benefit from taking the time to understand each other's personality types. These types can suspend judgment and consider that

both styles are legitimate – one approach isn't better than the other. Accepting that each type serves a purpose in their relationships can help them to appreciate each other's differences – and, most importantly, help both Analysts and Entrepreneurs resist the temptation to try to change each other.

Entrepreneur-Diplomat Relationships



Thinking and Feeling types make decisions in markedly different ways. Throw in the Observant and Intuitive trait differences, and Entrepreneur-Diplomat relationships are potential messes – or glorious examples of when two very different people come together and create something wonderful. They have so much to offer each other. Entrepreneurs add their bias toward practical action, and Diplomats add a deliberate humanistic and visionary counterbalance. When they go beyond tolerating each other's differences to valuing them, great things are likely to happen for these couples.

Balanced Entrepreneur-Diplomat Relationships

Diplomats are Intuitive Feelers with a huge emphasis on Feeling, which is why this pairing can be difficult for Entrepreneurs (Observant, Thinking) who champion

practicality over emotion. However, when differences are accommodated, Entrepreneur-Diplomat love affairs can be dynamic.

Diplomats have heads full of creative ideas and dreams, and they see things through their human values lens. They approach other people with an eye for bringing out their potential and strive to find opportunities for both individual and community growth. They're also romantic and sometimes idealize their relationships, placing the objects of their affection on pedestals.

Entrepreneurs live fully in the present. They're always looking for what is new and exciting. Rather than focus on people, as their Diplomat partners do, the human factor can come in second for Entrepreneurs when they have a problem to solve or a skill to master. It's not that they're amoral or that they don't care about people. People usually fascinate them in an objective sort of way – but tinkering with the tasks and problems before them fascinates Entrepreneurs even more.

When dating, Entrepreneurs' free spirit and enthusiasm for living in the moment may enthrall Diplomats, who may project romantic qualities onto these clever "bohemians," fascinated by their desire for freedom and novelty and their virtuosity in their chosen interests.

Similarly, Entrepreneurs may, at first, be curious about the almost mystical essence that surrounds Diplomats, and their approach to life that feels foreign to this earthbound type. When these two types date, it can be an exciting time full of energy and anticipation. Entrepreneurs are playful and enjoy novelty. Diplomats have a fondness for metaphors and symbolism. This combination almost makes these couples perfect candidates for role-playing in the bedroom.

Unbalanced Entrepreneur-Diplomat Relationships

Perhaps the biggest issue for this type combination is that Diplomats may see Entrepreneurs' behaviors as cold-hearted and shallow at times, while Entrepreneurs may view Diplomats as too soft and unrealistic. In time, these lovers could revert to their core preferences. Entrepreneurs are likely to complain that their partners are too emotional or irrational, and Diplomats tend to respond that Entrepreneurs are cold and heartless.

Diplomats may try unsuccessfully to help reluctant Entrepreneur sweethearts go deeper into themselves to discover greater potential. They may grow tired of what they see as their lovers' superficial need for novelty and good times. Entrepreneurs, meanwhile, may find Diplomats' fuzzy world of ideas and feelings annoying and try to bring them down to earth. Diplomats' tendency to live inside their heads may become a major turn-off for their experience-oriented Entrepreneur partners. And, just like that, the exciting and interesting may become a source of frustration and resentment for both types.

These two hold very different values, and this even translates to the bedroom. Entrepreneurs can hold little attachment when it comes to sex, while Diplomats may consider it a spiritual experience. This can lead to pain, as Diplomats expect some sort of metaphysical connection between them, and Entrepreneurs who just want their romance to be light-hearted and fun may find it easy to leave once they sense Diplomats are taking things too seriously.

With less serious relationships, Entrepreneurs would rather flee than try to fix problems. However, when deeply committed relationships are in danger, both personality types must come together to decide if their romance, despite all its differences and foreign aspects, is worth fighting for.

Rebalancing Entrepreneur-Diplomat Relationships

With all romantic relationships, it's recommended that partners take the time to learn about each other, and this goes doubly so for Entrepreneur-Diplomat relationships. These couples can thrive if they choose to practice acceptance and flexibility. However, they first need to work hard to find common ground and allow themselves to embrace and understand each other's differences.

For Diplomats, it's pertinent to understand that though Entrepreneurs have the Thinking trait, it doesn't mean that they're unemotional. Both Thinkers and Feelers are capable of profound emotions – however, Thinkers tend to hide those feelings from the outside world. They want to stay in control and not lose their heads regardless of the circumstances. This creates their aura of indifference.

Likewise, Entrepreneurs should realize the dominance of the Feeling trait doesn't mean that their Diplomat sweethearts are irrational – they're simply using a different set of criteria, putting harmony and sensitivity above cold, hard facts. Feelers tend to show their emotions quite clearly, as opposed to containing them as Thinkers do. However, their decision process may still be rational.

Both these perspectives are valid, and this is one of the most important lessons for those in Entrepreneur-Diplomat relationships. If both types of partners are tolerant and open-minded, Thinker-Feeler relationships like theirs can be very inspiring and successful, with Entrepreneurs making fact-based decisions and Diplomats bringing warmth and harmony into their romance.

More than just accepting each other's emotional outlook, here are things that Entrepreneurs can do to improve their relationships.

- Be tolerant. Remember that Diplomats may not prioritize facts as much as Entrepreneurs do – they’re likely to prioritize harmony, values, and morals instead. It’s not a wrong decision-making method, just a different one.
- Be careful with criticism. Feelers like Diplomats are often vulnerable to criticism, and Thinkers like Entrepreneurs are sometimes excessively blunt, so be careful when pointing something out and try to do it in a calm, non-confrontational manner. It’s okay to be honest, but honesty works just as well with a shot of kindness and gentleness most of the time. And remember, if a line is crossed occasionally and damage is done, a sincere apology is a good place to start repairing hurt feelings.
- Slow down occasionally. Remember that Diplomats don’t share Entrepreneurs’ love for the present moment. Entrepreneurs’ bias toward action may exhaust these visionaries, who tend to prefer to stop to consider the consequences before acting, and then take some time to reflect afterward. Understanding this difference and honoring it adequately can make Diplomats feel more comfortable in their romances with Entrepreneurs.
- Learn what’s important to Diplomats. Entrepreneurs’ pragmatic, *laissez-faire* attitudes toward life may often clash with their Diplomat partners’ deeply-held values. Adopting an “ends justify the means” approach in morally ambiguous situations may make their lovers very uncomfortable. They should be aware of that and try to find the middle ground between utilitarianism and idealism. Remember how important their values are to Diplomats. In relationships with them, these things aren’t to be trifled with.

Entrepreneurs’ traits are the opposite of the Diplomats’ core traits. However, this doesn’t mean they can’t fall in love and share their lives with one another. Tapping into the powerful perspectives of empathy and justice Diplomats bring can help

Entrepreneurs add those elements to their crafts and solutions. Diplomats who embrace Entrepreneurs as partners are likely to experience new practical energy in their lives that may bring them closer to realizing their dreams. There is, beyond a doubt, much potential for great romance when these types become couples.

Entrepreneur-Sentinel Relationships



While Sentinels and Entrepreneurs might share many of the same preferences, their contrasting Prospecting and Judging traits are likely to make all the difference. Like the small rudder on a large ship decides its direction, these tendencies turn Sentinels right and Entrepreneurs left.

Starting with what they have in common, both types enjoy practicality that comes with living in the “here and now.” In their shared love affairs, they don’t have to put up with all the theories and abstractions that they might with Analysts or Diplomats. Each likes to live in a practical, real world where they manipulate material things. In sharing this focus, they speak the same down-to-earth language.

Balanced Entrepreneur-Sentinel Relationships

Sentinels are Judging individuals and enjoy planning and committing to things as opposed to keeping their options open. Entrepreneurs, on the other hand, like to

keep things free and easy, and they're always looking for alternatives and opportunities. Relationships between Judging individuals and Prospecting individuals may often be rocky and challenging, but there's a lot of potential for strong and dynamic romance once these two types put in the time to learn about each other.

Sentinels and Entrepreneurs are likely to find common ground in their Observant trait. Both are likely to prefer relying on their senses over introspection – they'll spend more time keeping their feet on the ground instead of exploring the world of ideas.

Relationships between two Observant types are usually very straightforward, practical, and fun – these partners are usually able to handle practical tasks very well, focusing exclusively on real and tangible things. Their pragmatism, down-to-earth attitude, and a "Let's just do it!" approach are likely to be a great driving force in their shared relationships.

Sexually, both Role types have a no-nonsense approach to sex and see it as something very physical. Sex stays in the realm of the senses with these lovers and won't be laden with "deeper meaning" as with Diplomats.

For Entrepreneur–Sentinel couples, steady relationships are likely to come more easily than other pairings. They complement each other and provide a perfect yin to the other's yang. When Entrepreneurs mature and see the value of settling down, they often gravitate toward Sentinels who settle rather naturally and enthusiastically. Even Entrepreneurs understand that stability has its place in life and may look to Sentinels to provide more of it in theirs.

Sentinels find partners they can nurture and care for in Entrepreneurs. And even Sentinels crave a little excitement in their lives if it's not too disruptive. It should also

be mentioned that Sentinels and Explorers make up most of the population. Statistically, they're more likely to run into each other in the dating pool.

Observant types form most of the population (75–85%), and many traditions and social norms revolve around their traits. They're unlikely to have difficulties understanding each other or finding things to do. All Observant individuals enjoy things they can see, touch, and feel – therefore, such exciting activities are probably attractive to both these partners, and neither needs to worry about being misunderstood. This is a great advantage both in the dating phase and later in their shared relationships.

Unbalanced Entrepreneur–Sentinel Relationships

The differences most obvious in this type pairing involve decision-making and certainty. True to their name, Entrepreneurs are ever-curious and often reluctant to commit easily if something feels like it's going to be too restrictive. It's all right with them if everything is a little ambiguous. They like to see where things are going, and they navigate the flow of life instinctively and with great enthusiasm.

Sentinels, on the other hand, prefer to know that things are going the way they've determined they should (mostly through tradition and habit.) They prefer certainty with little room for ambiguity and often declare their truths in absolute terms. On a date, Sentinels may say, "Let's go to our favorite restaurant for dinner and then a movie. Here are the movie listings. Let's pick a movie before we go." Entrepreneurs might say, "Let's try that new club downtown. I know nothing about it. I'd love to see what it's like." Should their romance grow into something serious, these differing attitudes can come to be very important. Inflexibility and favoring only one's own way is likely to be detrimental to such relationships.

Another issue is that some Sentinel and Entrepreneur couples' relationships begin to mimic those of parents and children, with Sentinels acting the part of the grown-ups and Entrepreneurs taking the role of rascally children. This can work – until it doesn't. At some point, having all the responsibility of holding the ship steady may cause Sentinels to become resentful, especially if Entrepreneurs don't express appreciation for their efforts. Entrepreneurs, in turn, may come to resent being managed like infants – and may suddenly demand to make their own decisions based on their need for adrenaline and action.

Once Entrepreneurs become the “rebellious children” in their romance, there's a great deal of conflict potential. Sentinels may feel their stability is threatened, and they, in turn, may double down on the aspects of life that make Entrepreneurs feel confined. It can all get very messy if these couples don't understand these situations and work with each other to correct them.

Entrepreneurs' and Sentinels' combined pragmatism and focus on the concrete are very useful in everyday life, but they may have difficulties with imagination, reflection, and growth as individuals and as couples. This doesn't mean that Observant types are unimaginative – quite the contrary, they're often brilliant artists. However, their tendency to rely on the sensory world and undervalue abstract and philosophical thoughts often lead their relationships to stagnant places that lack meaningful dimensions. They may lack a sense of purpose unique to each in their relationship. Each performs in their own style, and yet neither is sure why.

Should one of the partners think too much about it, it can disrupt everything in their relationships they've grown accustomed to. Midlife and similar crises are the product of such disruptions. And, like most Explorers, Entrepreneurs may feel a pull to move

on to something new and different, regardless of which type disrupts the comfortable flow of their relationships.

Rebalancing Entrepreneur–Sentinel Relationships

Entrepreneurs and Sentinels, if they're willing to compromise, can turn their differences into major strengths, covering each type's respective weaknesses. To achieve this, they need to make conscious efforts to meet each other halfway. Entrepreneurs should resist the urge to always seek something new and exciting, even when it's very difficult to stick to the plan or manage all the chores. Meeting their Sentinel partners halfway or more can make a difference in their relationships.

Here are some things Entrepreneurs can do:

- Show appreciation. While Sentinels may not ask for it, they're energized by receiving recognition for what they do. Considering the amount they do to keep things running smoothly, showing them a little appreciation is a small price to pay.
- Help around the house, even when the chores are boring. While precise and diligent with the things that interest them, Entrepreneurs likely have a much higher tolerance for general disorder when compared to their Sentinel partners. To make Sentinels more comfortable, Entrepreneurs can keep a close eye on their housekeeping duties, such as making sure to wash their dirty dishes without having to be asked.
- Be imaginative. Observant couples often focus too much on routines or physical things. Don't be afraid of exploring ideas without knowing whether they're practical or implementable.

- Keep the flame alive. Remember what the attraction was in the first place. This may be essential for Entrepreneurs who are always looking for something different.

Entrepreneurs must understand and fully use the complementary nature of their relationships with Sentinels. By recognizing they voluntarily joined with partners who value structure and stability, they can strive to be aware of the importance of “playing by the rules” within their relationship. They can also show appreciation for all their Sentinel lovers offer them in the diligent and giving ways only Sentinels can.

Entrepreneur-Explorer Relationships



Someone to explore with – at least, that’s what one might assume is the draw when two Explorers fall in love. But even such a match made in heaven can have nooks and crannies that make them less than perfect under the right circumstances. The Observant and Prospecting combination produces much energy and movement that, when multiplied in couples, can be exciting. But doubling these characteristics in romantic relationships can also drain and subject them to impulsive changes. Both partners may need to understand what commitment means to them and be honest with each other.

Balanced Entrepreneur–Explorer Relationships

Old saws would have us believe that “opposites attract,” as though human hearts were magnets. So, what happens when two people within the same personality role group take on romance? What happens when Entrepreneurs and other Explorers meet and fall in love?

Fortunately for those who do, no two people are alike, even if they share the same basic personality traits. There are adaptations and nuances that prevent relationships between Entrepreneurs and other Explorers from being the same as looking into a mirror. Degrees of other traits, such as Introversion and Extraversion, can also come into play. But it can be exhilarating for Entrepreneurs to be with those who are like themselves and share the same typical need for novelty.

When Entrepreneurs and other Explorers come together romantically, the emphasis is more likely on the playful and the exciting. This is perhaps the most mercurial of type Roles when it comes to romance. Explorers are more likely than any other type to play the field before they settle down. They may resist being “tied down” in favor of being stimulated by new partners and conquests. They can be flirtatious and enjoy the hunt as much as the catch. Should Entrepreneurs find themselves in committed relationships with other Explorers, they’re likely to find a level of flexibility not seen among any other paired types.

Also, emotions can run high with this combination – even Explorers with the Thinking trait are highly influenced by their passion. But while Entrepreneur–Explorer couples sometimes engage in heated exchanges, they’re short-lived and probably won’t have much impact on how they respond to each other in the long run. Since life is a constant whirl of changes for them, that fight last night is likely “so yesterday” and something to be shrugged off.

Sexually, Entrepreneur–Explorer lovers may indulge in experimentation and, should things feel too dull in the bedroom, one or both may seek what they regard as more interesting activities elsewhere. Finding ways to spice up their sex lives while staying home may be crucial to their relationships depending on their arrangement. However, these types bring all their senses into play during their more intimate moments, and this can make finding novel approaches to sex easier.

Unbalanced Entrepreneur–Explorer Relationships

The biggest potential problem for Entrepreneur–Explorer couples is burnout. These couples often live the philosophy behind the line of the Neil Young song: “It’s better to burn out than to fade away.” Even the most energetic Entrepreneur–Explorer sweethearts can only bear such intensity for so long before it becomes too much. They may tire of too many risks and too much excitement and need to take measures to create stability and “down-time” within their relationships. Failure of these romances is more likely to come from fatigue and lack of novelty rather than incompatibility. A feeling of constant restlessness can get old, even for the most die-hard Entrepreneurs.

When in love, both these types are likely to orchestrate large romantic gestures and “wow” their partners. However, once their relationships become routine, they also may quietly slink out the back door, never to be heard from again. At some point (usually with age), most Entrepreneurs become more domestically inclined and commit to creating homes and families. However, they don’t necessarily date with such long-term plans in mind. Their decision to settle down may be spontaneous and almost impulsive. Multiply these behaviors by two, and it’s easy to see how romances between Entrepreneurs and other Explorers would be intense – perhaps even the stuff of soap operas.

Both these types tend not to pay so much attention to either the criticisms nor the concerns of others, as they're often immune to both. They base marriage on the "here and now," and the rules and standards within their committed relationships may be lax. While "I do" means something to them, there may always be a feeling that such a commitment is too final and too ironclad for their comfort.

Rebalancing Entrepreneur-Explorer Relationships

However, love affairs between Entrepreneurs and other Explorers don't have to be just about turmoil and uncertainty. There's plenty of opportunity for shared experiences for these seekers of novelty. Exploring common interests in the arts, crafts, and even business can keep such couples connected and in tune with one another. Entrepreneur-Explorer couples can create stimulating social lives filled with interesting people. The trick for their cohesion is to find as many adventures in which they both can join as possible. Such bonding of interests can provide creative stimulation and strong romances that last for lifetimes.

Here are some tips for Entrepreneur-Explorer couples:

- Give partners space. With Entrepreneurs and other Explorers, familiarity breeds contempt. If too confined or things become too routine, they may feel a need to escape. It's better to allow a little fresh air into these relationships by providing elbow room than to allow perpetual sameness to stagnate into what Explorers might see as dreary house arrest minus the ankle bracelet. Leave enough room so there isn't the panicky need to flee.
- Don't forget the future. Explorers in committed relationships can get some outside help to tend to their future. For example, financial advisers who manage money can be helpful for relationships focused almost exclusively on

the present. There are all manner of professionals who can be of service to couples who would rather someone else take care of that stuff, anyway.

- Find an anchor, but one with a long chain. Try to find some downtime together for relaxing and quiet fun. Create some custom-made family traditions to help anchor the relationship, such as sitting down regularly to a Sunday dinner together – and take turns adding an interesting new dish to the menu each week. This much consistency typically goes against the natural grain of most Entrepreneurs and other Explorers but expanding their comfort zones can build some structure into their relationships. Blending homegrown expressions of togetherness with opportunities for each to independently express themselves can help create a wholesome balance.

To non-Explorers, relationships between Entrepreneurs and other Explorers may sound chaotic and unconventional. But such couples aren't likely to be so concerned with what others think of them anyway. The trick isn't for them to defy their independent and exploratory natures and try to conform to prefab expectations when they enter relationships with each other. The trick is to learn how to bring those characteristics into a romance in ways that work for them and leave both partners happy. Think of it as another solution to find – and another avenue to explore.

Conclusion

The words “passion” and “romance” are close cousins, and we often find the word “passion” assigned to descriptions of Entrepreneur characteristics. While admittedly, in the context of this personality type, the word passion is mostly attached to careers and activities that Entrepreneurs enjoy, they can also extend that positive energy toward those they love, and, in doing so, form passionate romances. While they

choose rationality as their primary tool for making decisions, Entrepreneurs are far from cold, and they can be very effective soul mates.

Consider also how attractive devil-may-care people are, especially to those personality types who need a little relief from the structure and convention that may define their lives. This can be the challenge for such relationships. Sometimes one must be careful of what one asks for. Entrepreneurs can provide such relief with their fun-loving unpredictability. But the shine often wears off, and the other partner's preferences reassert themselves.

But, despite such dangers, love frequently finds a way. There is no such thing as a good or bad match for Entrepreneurs willing to put as much effort into nurturing their relationships as they do perfecting their other skills. One of the hallmark characteristics of Entrepreneurs is their willingness to change course if it leads to practical results. Nothing describes the compromise necessary for successful relationships better.

Additional Tools and Tests

Want to dig even deeper into your romantic relationships? If you have access to the toolkits area of the website, we offer a variety of additional tools and tests to help you explore.

[Get to Know Your Partner](#)

Would you like to get to know your partner a little better? Try this simple, but very fun and effective, game.

[Couple Analysis](#)

A great tool for couples. Learn how your personalities are likely to interact, and how you can connect on an even deeper level.

[Type Guesser \(Romance\)](#)

Are you trying to figure out what personality type your partner belongs to? You may find that this simple tool helps.

[Romantic Fulfillment Test](#)

Grasp the roles that confidence and optimism play in your relationships, as well as what makes someone a good match for you.

[Intertype Test](#)

Do you have a partner? Do you want to understand your relationship better? Learn more about it with our easy Intertype Test.

Loyalty Test

With this test, you will find out how you build relationships and loyalty in four major areas: Romance, Work, Friendships, and Family.

Friendships



People with the Entrepreneur personality type are the life of the party. With an enviable imagination and invigorating sense of spontaneity, they're never boring. They love exploring interesting ideas, both in discussion and by seeing things for themselves, so Entrepreneurs always seem to have fun activities hidden up their sleeves. At the same time, people with this personality type are easy-going, tolerant, and charming, making them naturally popular.

Hands-on physical activities like team sports are Entrepreneurs' idea of fun, and these environments give them plenty of chances to make new friends. There's little difficulty for them here – they seem to get along with just about everyone and make new connections wherever they go. Entrepreneurs live in the moment, and as a naturally confident personality type, they worry little about what others think of them. This tends to attract friends who share their attitudes and zest for life.

While not opposed to long philosophical discussions – they often enjoy the intellectual exercise – Entrepreneurs are unlikely to develop friendships based solely around one-on-one discussions about European economic challenges and the role of religion in politics. Straightforward to the point of being blunt, these types call it

as they see it, and an honest opinion in a debate is a sure thing. But at their hearts, Entrepreneurs are people of action, preferring to do what can be done rather than talking about what might happen someday. Sitting idle, especially in boredom, is the bane of their existence.

Exploration, excitement, adrenaline, and risk – Entrepreneurs' friends should prepare for all these things. Often enough they're happy to perform for the crowd, but they also tend to encourage their friends to join in. Most personality types might take "thanks but no thanks" personally, but Entrepreneurs are comfortable with who they are, and are more likely just to shrug their shoulders and move on with those friends who are game for adventure.

Entrepreneurs and Friends of Other Types

We'll now go through the main Roles, discussing the challenges and joyful moments that Entrepreneurs are likely to face in their friendships with other personality types.

Entrepreneur–Analyst Friendships



Entrepreneurs and Analysts relate to each other well through their Thinking preference. These friends have the same bias toward the rational, even though they express it differently. Stark honesty comes with that approach, which might not be present with friends who are more emotionally inclined. They're likely friends who can be blunt and open with each other if the bluntness isn't applied too thickly. All things in moderation.

Balanced Entrepreneur-Analyst Friendships

Clever Thinkers Get Along

The best thing about having Analyst friends is that they act as rational, insightful, and strategically-minded advisors to highly practical but sometimes impatient Entrepreneurs. Analysts pride themselves on being objective, even with their closest friends. Those belonging to this type group would have few qualms about criticizing Entrepreneurs' latest ideas or specific actions. Being direct and blunt themselves, Entrepreneurs are likely to feel right at home when it comes to such an approach. Analysts' penchant for conceptual thinking may sometimes frustrate Entrepreneurs, but having friends who are able and willing to look at things from different angles can be invaluable in many situations.

Entrepreneurs and Analysts also share a desire for logic and efficiency. If a challenge interests them, otherwise impulsive Entrepreneurs may spend hours trying to tackle it. With Analysts trying to understand the principles behind the functionality, and Entrepreneurs experimenting with what's in front of them, their partnership can be mutually rewarding. Their principles and perspectives may not always overlap, but there should be enough common ground for both types to benefit from opportunities to share their thoughts with each other.

Unbalanced Entrepreneur-Analyst Friendships

Deficits in Understanding

Entrepreneurs and Analysts also have their fair share of differences that may cause tension in friendships between the two types. The most important of such differences is the way these types take in information. Entrepreneurs are highly practical, live-in-the-moment individuals – as far as they're concerned, it's the real, tangible things that matter most. Analysts mostly focus on what they can imagine and deduce, taking pleasure in coming up with various concepts and ideas. While there are ways to combine the two approaches – for instance, while working on projects that require both planning and execution – these two thinking styles can, nonetheless, turn out to be major barriers with communication and mutual understanding.

Another issue these types may face is that neither of them is likely to find it easy to provide emotional support. Both Entrepreneurs and Analysts can have very strong feelings, but they're neither comfortable with nor experienced in coping with other people's emotions. This may not be a major issue with day-to-day matters, but nearly every friendship has ups and downs occasionally – bottling up frustration isn't the best long-term strategy.

If these friends don't resolve the underlying problems, sometimes even a simple miscommunication can lead to longstanding disappointment. In such a scenario, either Entrepreneurs or Analysts, being as rational as they are, may ultimately decide that their friendships are just not worth the trouble.

Rebalancing Entrepreneur–Analyst Friendships

Practical Logic

While these types may have drastically different ways of exploring, expressing creativity, and thinking about the future, they can rely on their common rationality to resolve any differences within their mutual friendship. One very strong thing that Analysts and Entrepreneurs share is an appreciation of effectiveness – they both love to see practical solutions in place and functioning. This shared appreciation isn't limited to technical areas but also applies to the social realm. Especially in matters of pure preference (where to eat, for example), it's only rational to conclude that occasional compromises might be the way to go. Why? Because their friendship is worth it.

When these types experience more serious friction with each other, both can dial down their frustrated sense of superiority and instead focus on finding practical solutions together. Resolving their differing methods and preferences can be as easy as each type opening their minds to see the merits of another perspective and trying it.

Likewise, instead of just arguing for their own way, these friends can respect each other's minds enough to justify those arguments with some facts. Telling friends they're wrong about something only carries hurtful judgement, but showing them better ways that work is a respectful form of disagreement these logical types can handle.

Entrepreneur-Diplomat Friendships



Entrepreneurs and Diplomats often approach things from different angles: Entrepreneurs from a rational, practical level and Diplomats from an idealistic, humanistic level. With effort and acceptance, these differences can be complementary and help each type grow – or they can set up conflict, as each looks askance at the other’s position. But some of the best friendships are between those who have enough in common to connect and enough differences to keep it interesting.

Balanced Entrepreneur-Diplomat Friendships

Differences That Inspire

For Entrepreneurs, having close Diplomat friends can be both very rewarding and very perplexing. They may not always understand each other, and yet they may experience mutual wonder as they come to appreciate their very different viewpoints and what they can offer each other.

Diplomats are enthusiastic, passionate, and imaginative individuals – their energy often inspire Entrepreneurs, especially initially, perhaps even giving them exciting

new ideas to follow. Diplomats are rare compared to other personality types, and their unusual thinking may be very intriguing to Entrepreneurs. However, that fascination may also include confusion – just like Analysts, Diplomats primarily live in their minds, and this attitude can be foreign to practical-minded and hands-on Entrepreneurs.

Regardless of these issues, Entrepreneur-Diplomat friendships can be inspiring. Empathic and insightful, Diplomats can pull more realistic Entrepreneurs away from their daily concerns, encouraging them to develop their thoughts and ideas. Diplomats have a knack for making people feel relaxed and comfortable, and restless Entrepreneurs can benefit from such company.

On the other side of the fence, idealistic and often absent-minded Diplomats also benefit from friendships with highly practical and efficiency-oriented Entrepreneurs. They put their ideas into action, and this amazes Diplomats, inspiring them to do the same with their own dreams. As rewarding as brainstorming can be, often there's just no substitute for some positive shared experiences.

Unbalanced Entrepreneur-Diplomat Friendships

Very Different Priorities

While both friends are likely to share a certain excitement about discovering and experiencing new things (although their definitions of what makes something interesting are likely to be very different), they may also remain enigmas to each other for a long time. This is probably the most challenging combination of all for several reasons. Diplomats' nearly constant soul-searching is as meaningful to them as experiencing things is to Entrepreneurs. These differences can lead to numerous misunderstandings.

Another issue that Entrepreneurs and their Diplomat friends may come across is their shared tendency to neglect day-to-day matters and necessities. Whether it's Entrepreneurs going on unplanned road trips a week before their tax returns are due, or Diplomats forgetting to transfer the rent money amid their volunteer activities, both types sometimes deal with unpleasant surprises – especially if these matters affect them both. Meticulousness isn't always their strong suit. Both types may suffer the consequences of a lack of attention to any mutual responsibilities, or any promises they might make to each other to handle shared tasks.

Rebalancing Entrepreneur-Diplomat Friendships

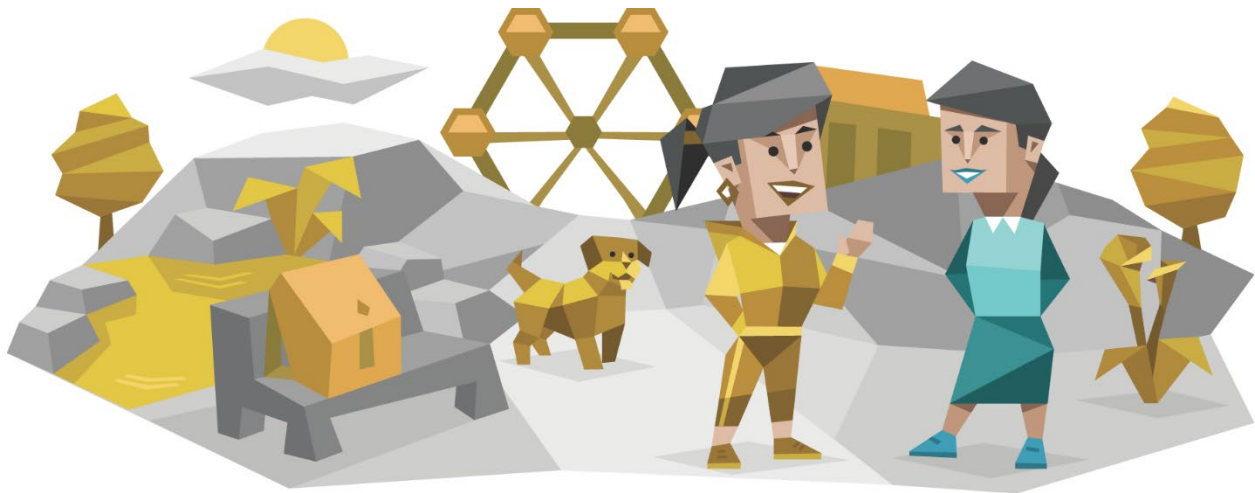
Taking Time to Help Each Other

While these types may not have perfect compatibility in the focus of their day-to-day lives, they find they can enhance the richness of each other's existence with a little flexibility. Diplomats maintain a remarkable principled sincerity that can beautifully balance Entrepreneurs' sometimes-cynical approach to life. Among Diplomat friends, Entrepreneurs can connect to social rewards that come from thinking about more than just their own lives. Always seeking exciting challenges, Entrepreneurs may unwittingly pass right by warmer human connections. But with Diplomat friends along for the ride, even such energetic and logical types find time to stop and share a smile.

When it comes to rebalancing neglectful attitudes toward everyday life, these types are both far from mastery but can still counterbalance their respective weaknesses. When it's time to focus on necessities all too unexciting for these types to find pleasant, their friendship can provide the missing element of enjoyment. Doing chores and running errands may not be fun alone, but when these friends offer each

other their company – and helpful ideas – they can turn anything into a fun adventure.

Entrepreneur-Sentinel Friendships



Entrepreneurs and Sentinels may look very similar glancing at the personality type letters, but what a difference a single letter can make. Where Entrepreneurs are spontaneous, Sentinels foster stability. Where Entrepreneurs are pragmatists not always concerned with the rules, Sentinels uphold every jot and tittle of established standards. These differences, however pronounced, don't necessarily make friendship between the two types impossible. There is much potential when these opposites attract.

Balanced Entrepreneur-Sentinel Friendships

Everyday Companions

Sentinels are numerous and are likely to form a significant part of Entrepreneurs' social circles unless Entrepreneurs are particularly selective. These personality types are likely to be loyal, practical, and down-to-earth friends, always eager to offer

advice and support. Sentinel friends help Entrepreneurs stay focused and realistic when necessary – for instance, when they get so caught up in their hobbies or social obligations they find it difficult to spend time on more mundane yet important matters. Sentinels' patience, stability, and sense of loyalty can be invaluable when Entrepreneurs feel confused or uncertain about their chosen paths.

Both Entrepreneurs and Sentinels tend to be practical, with their feet planted firmly on the ground – both friends are likely to focus on activities that engage their senses, such as participating in sports, going on hikes, or working on otherwise tangible things together. As more adventurous and spontaneous individuals, Entrepreneurs may convince Sentinels to let go of their serious, composed attitudes and simply have fun occasionally. Similarly, the structured, orderly style embraced by Sentinels can counterbalance the occasional devil-may-care approach of Entrepreneurs.

Unbalanced Entrepreneur–Sentinel Friendships

Clashing Senses of Responsibility

The main point of contention in Entrepreneur–Sentinel friendships is likely to be their different understanding of freedom and individualism. Entrepreneurs are famous for their unyielding spirit of independence, seeing many rules and traditions as stifling and redundant limitations. To them, freedom of expression is more important than social cohesion or security.

Sentinels scoff at thinking about someone ignoring social conventions in favor of individualism. From their perspective, stability and security are topmost concerns, and these types are likely to argue that the needs of the many outweigh the needs of the few. These differences may lead to some heated discussions revolving around flexibility and responsibility.

Rebalancing Entrepreneur–Sentinel Friendships

Truly Respecting Differences

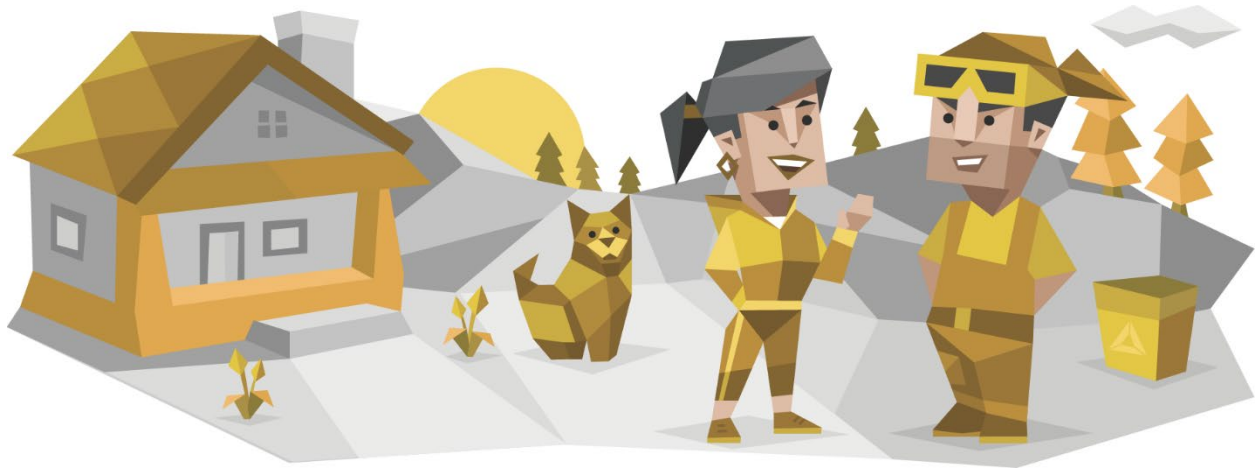
There's little these types can do to rebalance friction in their mutual friendship unless they're both willing to acknowledge the virtues of the other's perspective. This doesn't mean they must adopt those viewpoints as their own, but recognizing that different lifestyles can work for different people give these two types a chance to bridge their differences.

Entrepreneurs can appreciate how Sentinels enjoy the sense of security stability brings, and respect that what may seem limited or restricted in the short term may create strong long-term success. In turn, Sentinels can appreciate that while a spontaneous, risk-taking approach may not be for them, Entrepreneurs can – and do – make it work in their own lives.

In true friendships, seeing chums happy and successful is more important than being right. Sentinels can view their Entrepreneur friends with supportive amazement instead of dismay, knowing that win or lose, they're likely to be able to pick themselves up and begin anew.

These friends also do well to accept input from each other, as they're both exceedingly proficient in their own ways, and equally capable of giving each other some balance. Sentinels who learn to take measured risks by following in their Entrepreneur friends' footsteps can undoubtedly increase their opportunities in life, and Entrepreneurs who listen to the wise advice of Sentinel friends may sidestep some of their own worst mistakes.

Entrepreneur-Explorer Friendships



“Live for the moment” could be the motto for Entrepreneurs who strike up friendships with other Explorers. The exhilaration of such spontaneous and active relationships is likely to be heady for both since they’re probably asked to conform and slow down in so many other facets of their lives. However, there is no perfect friendship and even this seemingly seamless match has hazards to avoid – mostly because there can be too much of a good thing.

Balanced Entrepreneur-Explorer Friendships

Lively Compatibility

For Entrepreneurs, having other close Explorer friends is like looking into a mirror. All Explorers are practical and inventive individuals, so it’s very unlikely that such friends would ever run out of things to do. Furthermore, all Explorers prefer to bond over shared activities, so it’s likely that such friends find it easy to maintain their relationships regardless of the difficulties, often pushing each other to explore new hobbies or put more efforts into existing ones.

While such free-thinking types as Entrepreneurs and other Explorer types may have minor differences, it's likely that such friends feel as if they've found true "mind mates." Explorers' spontaneity, boldness, and willingness to push limits make them fun, interesting friends, and give them plenty of opportunities to bond with each other. The main challenge for Entrepreneurs, however, is often finding other Explorers (especially with similar hobbies) to befriend. Keeping such friendships alive once formed is relatively easy for them.

Unbalanced Entrepreneur-Explorer Friendships

Shared Chaos

A key challenge for Entrepreneurs and their Explorer friends is likely to come from the same source that fuels their connection – their similarity. Having friends who think similarly can be fun and reassuring, but it can also put these types in a bubble, isolating them from criticism and growth. There's a risk that they'll convince each other that their behaviors and attitudes are fine, even when some obvious issues need to be addressed – such as dealing with mundane yet necessary tasks. A shared love of spontaneity with little emphasis on responsibility can leave these friends mired in disorder.

Another issue that Entrepreneurs and their Explorer friends may face is that they both are likely to place more importance on practical and tangible things than on imagination and mental exercises. It may be a good idea for both types to encourage each other to find time for intellectual growth and discussions about the past or the future. While Entrepreneurs and their Explorer friends enjoy living in the moment, failing to stop and think about the long-term picture occasionally can cause problems.

Rebalancing Entrepreneur-Explorer Friendships

Embracing New Ideas Together

Entrepreneurs and their Explorer friends tend to be very open, and one of the best ways for them to avoid being limited by their similarities is to be open to including different kinds of friends in their social circles. Entrepreneurs are great at figuring out how to fit unusual pieces together and can apply this cleverness to social relationships. Seeking new friends with very different points of view – for example, from other Role groups – can be an exciting adventure with many possible gains. One of the greatest things that Entrepreneur-Explorer friends can get from diverse people is a new perspective on their own lives.

This can help these friends develop beyond just living for the moment and its pleasures and become better strategic thinkers, dreamers, and responsible doers. Entrepreneurs and Explorers benefit from friendships that encourage them to take fresh approaches to things now and then, balancing out their focus on immediate desires. Such friends may find that not only does this make their lives more secure, but it also can enable them to plan and experience new adventures together. Forethought can reveal even more amazing opportunities than spontaneity can because it allows these types to inject some of their own preferences into an outcome – instead of just making do with whatever happens.

Conclusion

Entrepreneurs are Extraverts, which generally means they know plenty of people. However, not all those people are destined to become true friends. But for those who are, the benefits are many. The Entrepreneurs' bias toward action is likely to

bring an extra measure of energy into the lives of those they befriend, and their rational practicality is likely to broaden or shift their friends' perspectives. Friendship with unique Entrepreneurs can be something to treasure.

Entrepreneurs who try to develop friendships are likely to be more anchored and balanced because of those relationships. They aren't always comfortable with their feelings, and bonding platonically with others can help them increase their emotional intelligence. If they find someone who shares their interests, such a partner is likely to be prized. Entrepreneurs may have to give up some of the independence they hold so dear, but the tradeoff may be well worth it.

Additional Tools and Tests

Want to dig even deeper into your friendships? If you have access to the toolkits area of the website, we offer a variety of additional tools and tests to help you explore.

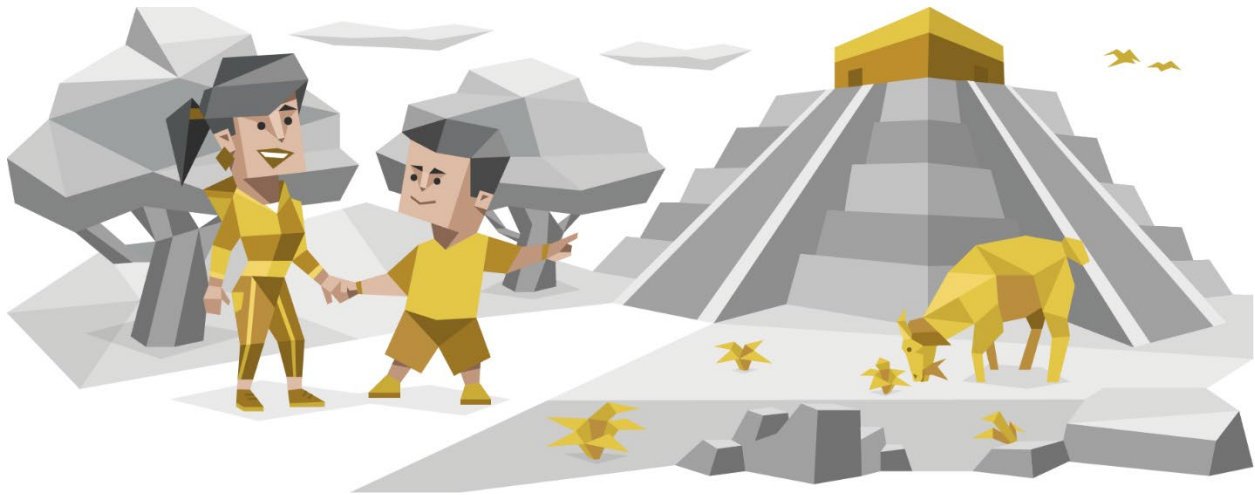
Type Guesser (Friendships)

Are you trying to figure out what personality type your friend belongs to? You may find that this simple tool helps.

Personal Authenticity Test

Can you be your true self with your friends and family? Let's explore how you feel about your authenticity in those circumstances.

Parenthood



Playful and Curious

In a lot of ways, Entrepreneurs are what many children would consider the perfect parents. Fun-loving and playful, flexible and understanding, people with the Entrepreneur personality type genuinely enjoy spending time with their children and know how to make sure everyone's having a good time. Entrepreneurs have a natural curiosity and spontaneity that's a perfect match for young children's wonder and insatiable desire to learn.

Entrepreneurs love hands-on activities, and their kids are likely to have someone to play catch with or to help them build a model for school. These parents welcome and encourage sports, hiking, and other practical, proactive hobbies. Given their aversion to rules and schedules, they aren't likely to force their children into clubs and teams. If their kids want to play softball, great – if not, well, they'll just find something else to do. Maybe the greatest thing about Entrepreneur parents is that they see their children as equal members of the family.

Entrepreneurs with a balanced approach to parenting give their children freedom, encourage them to use their own judgment (especially with the minor stuff), and to follow their hearts – to heck with what other people think. Using their knack for picking up on even the slightest changes in others' behaviors and habits, Entrepreneur parents keep a close enough eye on their kids so that they can step in with extra guidance when things go wrong.

Insensitive to Emotional Needs

Entrepreneurs have one significant parental challenge, though: emotional bonding. As with any Thinking type, feelings tend to be seen by these parents as irrational distractions, rather than tools for expression and connection. If their children are Feeling types, this can be a source of tension in these families. Frank honesty isn't always the best way to support children.

This lack of sensitivity, combined with their sometimes-brash behavior, can be especially overwhelming to Introverted kids who tend to bristle in the presence of overbearing behavior. Entrepreneurs have no qualms with spontaneous socialization or getting up in front of large groups of people. But Introverted children are likely to be intimidated by any spontaneous socialization, especially if it involves large groups or strangers. Entrepreneur parents, especially when they take an unbalanced parenting approach, may take their children's hesitation or quietness as a serious lack of social skills – a problem they need to resolve.

It can be a struggle for Entrepreneurs to address some of these potential issues as they're often unaware of their own emotional needs. This can cause a lack of self-awareness and inappropriate emotional expression, which may be both confusing and hurtful when it affects their sons and daughters.

Entrepreneur parents stressed out about work situations may snap at their school-aged children who ask them for help with their nightly homework. They may not realize that their frustrations stem from their situations at work and aren't a result of their kids' requests. Angry Entrepreneur parents may berate their children for not getting their homework done, or even accuse them of not being smart enough to do their homework on their own. Their own emotions can cloud their judgment and create unbalanced, negative behaviors and attitudes they take out on those around them.

Bridging the Emotional Gap

Insensitivity can create a significant emotional gap between parents and their children but, with the right focus and motivation, Entrepreneur parents can build positive, lasting bonds. Thankfully, even though they aren't necessarily empathetic or compassionate, they're sociable and enjoy connecting with other people.

While they may view feelings and emotions as irrational, they're exceptionally good at picking up shifts in behavior or attitude that can provide clues about their children's feelings. Whether or not they believe those feelings are valid, at the very least, they can use their abilities to acknowledge them and show they care. Just knowing that their parents acknowledge their emotional needs can make kids feel understood and accepted for who they are. This is especially true for Introverted and Feeling children, who often feel misunderstood or criticized for their more sensitive natures.

Entrepreneurs can also benefit from having more sensitive parenting partners to help them out, and the healthy bonds they form through their shared activities can help to bridge the gap. These parents also have the added benefit of direct,

understanding relationships – their children won't feel so much like they must hide their mistakes and challenges, the holy grail of parent-child communication.

Parent–Child Type Pairings

Talking about personality types and children is always an interesting proposition. While most see personality as something that is at least partly genetic and inherent, those influences may only lightly touch a child or only be softly apparent during childhood. Childhood is about experimenting, learning, and adapting. This means their behavior is often exploratory rather than permanently defining. There may be hints of a personality type, but with so much adapting going on, it may be hard to pinpoint their consistent traits exactly. And since children aren't self-aware enough to take a personality test, they don't have the same advantages as adults who can answer questions describing their preferences.

Therefore, when we talk about the Analyst child, for example, we are referring mainly to children who may show a preference for a rational approach – even if it's a sporadic preference. But we urge caution toward labeling children until they're older and can tell us their preferences themselves. Childhood is all about discovery, and we advocate giving them a chance to do that on their own and in their own time without the confines of labels.

But for the sake of our discussion, we'll describe things that Entrepreneurs may want to notice when parenting children who engage in certain trait behaviors – whether those behaviors are a phase or prove to be more consistent.

Entrepreneur Parent and an Analyst Child



Curious and Driven

Analyst-leaning children are likely to be intellectually-minded, curious, and very imaginative. Their creativity and open-mindedness are likely to delight their Entrepreneur parents, who tend to be intrigued by their children's willingness to explore the unknown, which is in a way like their own penchant for improvisation.

Entrepreneurs and Analysts share an interest in discovering how things work, which is why it's unlikely these parents have major difficulties communicating with their children or coming up with interesting activities. Furthermore, Analyst kids are focused and motivated once they find something that interests them. Entrepreneurs share this trait, and they'll probably be delighted to see that their daughters and sons are as determined as they are.

Practicality versus Theory

The core engines that drive this exploration and curiosity are different for Entrepreneurs and Analysts. Entrepreneurs usually enjoy exploring things simply because they present a challenge, and then either move on to something more

interesting or spend time honing their skills. Like other Explorers, Entrepreneurs focus on the tangible and the real. Analysts are less concerned about practical applications and more about why something works the way it does, from a mostly intellectual perspective. They want to understand the hidden principles, systems, and patterns behind things, even when they offer few tangible benefits.

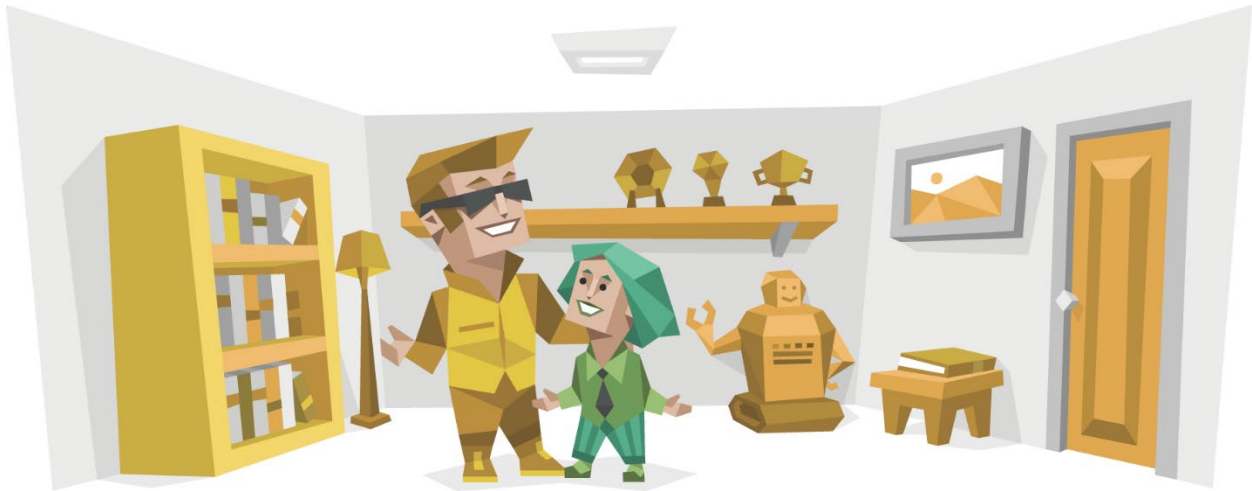
Analyst children may not hesitate to question their Entrepreneur parents' suggestions or conclusions, often because they're interested in why their parents think the way they do and not necessarily because they don't trust them. However, such questions may also frustrate Entrepreneur parents, who may likely see them as a waste of time and wonder why their sons and daughters just don't give something a try or focus on experimenting instead. Analyst children aren't likely to be persuaded by statements such as, "Because it works," or, "This is the best way."

Finding Shared Interests

Analyst children are unlikely to require much emotional support, which is a relief for direct and rational Entrepreneurs. Analysts are more self-sufficient than Feeling types, although this may also cause problems when there's a genuine need to open up and discuss something.

Often, Entrepreneurs bond with their Analyst children through shared activities and hobbies rather than heartfelt discussions about principles and values. It may be a good idea for Entrepreneur parents to make conscious efforts to encourage their kids to partake in something they're doing, such as a shared hobby or sport. In this way, they can develop mutual appreciation and understanding.

Entrepreneur Parent and a Diplomat Child



Inquisitive and Open-Minded

Even though Entrepreneurs and Diplomats are complete opposites on many fronts, there's also some overlap among their traits. Diplomat-leaning children are likely to be inquisitive and willing to explore new things. This inborn desire for freedom and creativity is likely to delight their Entrepreneur parents.

However, while Entrepreneurs tend to have an excellent grasp of reality, impressive practical skills, and the ability to focus completely on what's in front of them by immersing themselves fully in the present moment, their Diplomat kids may have difficulties recognizing and understanding such traits due to their detachment from the practical world. Luckily, Entrepreneurs' ability to implement their Diplomat children's ideas can create a multitude of opportunities for building bonds.

It's likely that Diplomat kids can always find something to focus on, even without their Entrepreneur parents' help. This is likely to delight Entrepreneurs – however, parents with this personality type should ensure that their daughters and sons have available activities that offer enough mental stimulation. Diplomats are idealistic and even

somewhat poetic individuals, and these characteristics may baffle practical and rational-minded Entrepreneurs. For example, while these parents may see planting trees as a fun physical exercise, their Diplomat children may ponder what would happen if everyone in their city did the same – and then cheerfully present that idea to their parents.

Impulsive versus Idealistic

Just like Entrepreneurs, Diplomat children are also likely to understand the importance of personal responsibility and the need to be able to make their own decisions. However, Entrepreneurs with an unbalanced approach to parenting may confuse this with their own tendency to experiment and push limits. Diplomats seek to develop strong inner principles and tend to pick noble, often too-idealistic goals, and may respond better to arguments based on values and principles than to rewards and practical benefits. It's worth remembering that Diplomats tend to be much more sensitive and empathetic than Entrepreneurs. Parents belonging to this type are likely to need to make conscious efforts to connect with their children emotionally.

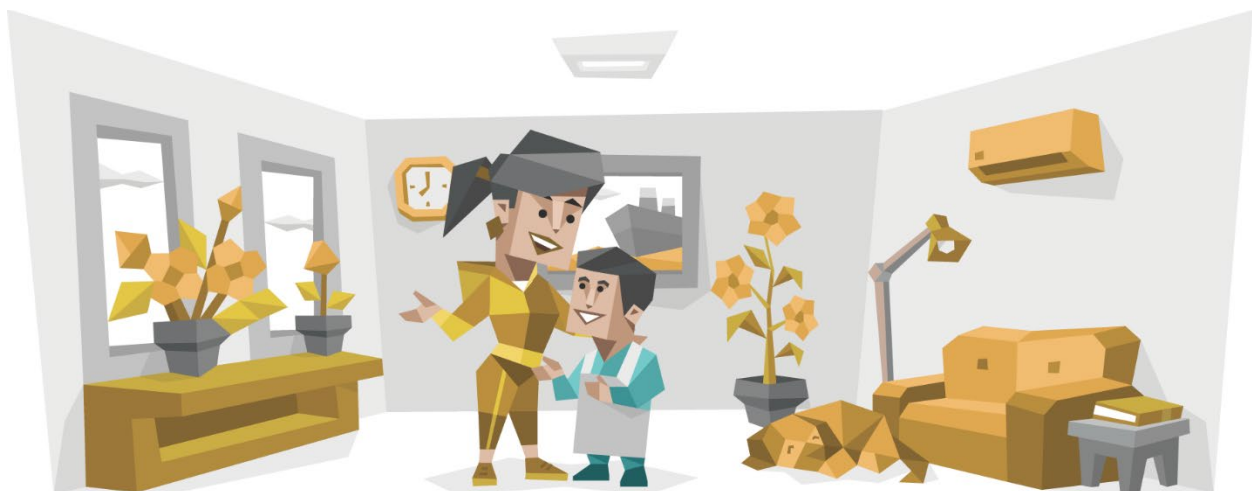
This aspect is likely to cause most of the tension between Entrepreneur parents and their Diplomat kids. Like other Explorers, Entrepreneurs tend to be very selective about what interests them and have little patience for things that don't fall into that category. However, Diplomats prefer to dive deep and try to find something fascinating in everything they encounter, even when it promises few tangible rewards. Entrepreneur parents may need to at least pretend to be interested in their children's musings or find activities to share that combine opportunities for personal growth with real-world experiences.

Accepting and Encouraging Differences

Entrepreneur parents should remember their Diplomat sons and daughters require a different approach compared to what is natural for them, and they shouldn't attempt to "fix" their children's idealism or occasional naïveté. Rather, these parents should try to appreciate (and learn from) their children's enthusiasm, open-mindedness, and creativity.

Diplomats' abilities are often underappreciated and rejected as offering little practical value, so a little encouragement can go a long way. Such issues are even more important during the teenage years. Thankfully, being nonconformists themselves, Entrepreneurs are likely to encourage their Diplomat children to pursue something that inspires and motivates them, and then help them along the way, instead of criticizing their habits or pushing them to look for more conventional career paths.

Entrepreneur Parent and a Sentinel Child



Practical and Perceptive

Entrepreneurs share the Observant trait with their Sentinel children, which means that communication is likely to be relatively uncomplicated in these families. Both types focus on practicality and facts, preferring to leave theoretical and abstract conversations to Intuitive Analysts and Diplomats. Expectations tend to be straightforward, and Sentinel children always know exactly where they stand with their Entrepreneur parents.

The Observant trait also effects how these types experience their environment, and both Entrepreneur parents and their Sentinel kids are perceptive and focus on what's happening around them in the moment. Entrepreneurs notice even subtle changes in their children's behavior, allowing them to respond quickly and efficiently to prevent situations from escalating to an unmanageable level. This perceptiveness also promotes a connection between these parents and children, which is especially important when their approach to parenting is unbalanced – Entrepreneurs can be insensitive and lacking in empathy.

Not Enough Structure

Sentinel children are likely to be very dutiful and obedient, trying hard to meet their parents' expectations. They're likely to respect family hierarchy and traditional roles and expect their parents to set up a structured environment with well-defined rules. Sentinels don't like to discover what's acceptable through trial and error the way Entrepreneurs do – they must clearly understand what's okay and what isn't in advance. This is rarely the main goal of freedom-minded Entrepreneurs, although these parents are likely to appreciate their children's willingness to cooperate and listen to what they have to say.

Sentinel children seek a safe, stable atmosphere above all else – spontaneity and fun can come *after* their parents meet these needs. Entrepreneurs should recognize these different requirements and remember that their Sentinel kids are likely to be far more careful, traditional, and methodical in their exploration of the world. When caring for Sentinel children, their somewhat *laissez-faire* approach to parenting may not be ideal.

Respecting the Need for Stability

Sentinel children – and many young children in general – need stability to build trusting relationships with their parents. Sentinels desire steadiness and structure more than any other personality type, and they'll struggle to connect with parents who don't provide such environments for them. Although they thrive on spontaneity and adventure, Entrepreneur parents must modify their behavior to best meet the needs of their children, especially in their early years. From keeping a consistent feeding schedule to creating a bedtime routine, Entrepreneurs can create the sense of security and dependability that their Sentinel children crave.

It's also important for Entrepreneurs to respect their kids' aversion to risk-taking. Sentinels aren't the thrill-seeking type, making them less likely to be interested in riding roller coasters or trying new foods. And, while they benefit from moving outside of their comfort zone every so often, it's important to do so slowly and with their approval – breaking Sentinel children's trust is one of the most harmful mistakes parents can make.

Start by adding new spices to food they already like rather than forcing them to try a foreign food. Take them for a ride on the carousel and then gradually introduce them to more intense rides. Entrepreneurs tend to find that Sentinel children who trust

them and can take their time trying new things are usually much more willing partners for future adventures.

Entrepreneur Parent and an Explorer Child



Adventurous and Independent

Naturally, Entrepreneur parents find it easiest to communicate with their sons and daughters if they belong to one of the Explorer types. Explorer children are very adventurous and practical, often able to come up with exciting activities on their own if they're encouraged and given enough freedom to express themselves. Entrepreneurs are likely to be fascinated by their children's curiosity, finding it easy to relate to and communicate with them.

Furthermore, Explorer children tend to feel very in tune with the present moment and the world around them, and often enjoy sports and nature, even from a very young age. Nature-related activities are likely to form a large part of Entrepreneur parents' repertoire.

Like Entrepreneurs themselves, Explorer kids are also likely to place a lot of importance on freedom and independence, often insisting on being allowed to experiment and do things in their own way. Entrepreneurs are likely to cherish seeing their curious and enthusiastic children discover something new or exhaust themselves while spending hours on recently acquired hobbies.

Such an improvisational and hands-off attitude is, however, a double-edged sword. Knowing that their children love freedom of action, Entrepreneurs may be reluctant to discipline them for overstepping their boundaries with all those experiments, or to be firm in telling their kids that time for play is over and they should get back to studying.

Missing the Big Picture

Tangentially, Entrepreneur parents may also have difficulties teaching their Explorer children to find time for introspection and personal development. All Explorers tend to be far more interested in real and tangible matters than internal discussions or abstract ideas, but both approaches have valuable things to offer. It's way too easy for these types to both forget to find time to stop and think about the direction their lives are going if they each live mostly in the present.

Finally, as Entrepreneurs focus more on improvisation and thinking on their feet, they have difficulties with purely administrative and practical tasks. Their Explorer daughters and sons are likely to share this weakness, which is why parents with this personality type should make conscious efforts to teach their children the importance of being economical, to make fact-based decisions, and to combine their restless curiosity with practical needs and responsibilities.

Consider the Future

As pleasant as it can be to live in the present moment, Entrepreneurs do their Explorer children a disservice when they neglect to consider the future. Encouraging their Explorer kids to view life as an adventure seems harmless enough, but children who lack direction or the ability to form well-thought-out plans can venture into some unsavory situations. Going to college with absolutely no direction can cause frustration and some heavy student loans with no degree to show for it. Buying their first cars without the know-how to budget for payments, insurance, or fuel can result in repossessed vehicles and badly-damaged credit scores.

To prevent these potential long-term issues, Entrepreneur parents should be intentional about helping their children understand how their present actions affect their future. Kids of all ages (even adolescents) aren't cognitively capable of fully understanding the potential consequences of their behaviors, and it's their parents' job to help them until they develop that ability.

As impulsive individuals themselves, Entrepreneurs must explore how their lack of planning or direction may have affected their lives. An anecdote about a poor decision they made as a child ("I decided to try some beer at a friend's party my sophomore year in high school.") and the negative outcome that resulted from that decision ("I got really sick, and my parents grounded me for two months when they found out.") can help to illustrate the importance of considering future consequences.

Conclusion

Balancing their refreshing spontaneity and somewhat *laissez-faire* attitude with the responsibilities that come with parenthood can be a challenge for Entrepreneur parents. But if they master the right approach, they not only raise children who are capable and responsible, but there is also an element of whimsy and adventure built in. It doesn't matter what personality type their children turn out to be. Smart discipline and the teaching of responsibility paired with the unique personality style of the Entrepreneur can help kids experience the best of both worlds.

Responsible parents always adapt themselves, regardless of their own core inclinations, to raise their children compassionately and intelligently. If Entrepreneurs see parenting as a skill to acquire and try to do so, they're likely to be marvelous, conscientious parents who open unique doors in sometimes unconventional ways.

Additional Tools and Tests

Want to dig even deeper into your role as a parent? If you have access to the toolkits area of the website, we offer a variety of additional tools and tests to help you explore.

Parenting Styles Test

Whether you have children already or hope to become a parent in the future, this test offers you useful insights into your parenting style.

Type Guesser (Parent)

Are you trying to figure out what personality type your parent belongs to? You may find that this simple tool helps.

Type Guesser (Child)

Are you trying to figure out what personality type your teenage child belongs to? You may find that this simple tool helps.

Academic Path



Entrepreneurs are naturally curious individuals with a passion for learning new skills, especially those with practical benefits. True to their name, they see education as an opportunity to gain information and proficiency they can then apply to their interests. Rock climbing enthusiasts, for example, may pursue degrees in geology to learn more about the formations they're coming in close contact with.

Whatever paths they take in their lives, Entrepreneurs benefit from embracing education and looking for learning opportunities. Whether they're learning about medieval history in the classroom or teaching themselves how to build websites in their own home, Entrepreneurs can benefit from expanding their minds and increasing their skills.

In these paragraphs, we'll discuss how Entrepreneurs learn best throughout their academic career, what struggles they may face in educational environments, and how they can improve their learning habits.

How Entrepreneurs Learn

Balanced Learning Habits

Hands-On and Spontaneous Experiences

Learning opportunities that involve hands-on mastery and allow for spontaneous learning experiences interest Entrepreneurs. They learn best in unstructured environments with loosely structured curricula with an emphasis on the experiential. Entrepreneurs react positively to personal involvement in their learning, especially if they're focused on mastering the topic.

While they're usually restless in a lecture hall setting, if they discover a niche – like athletics or mechanics – they're likely to respond well. Entrepreneurs dislike just sitting still and absorbing information. But give them something practical to do, and they become engaged. Allow them to express themselves in an interesting and amusing fashion, and they shine. Ask them to recite a historical timeline, and they're instantly not interested.

Entrepreneurs, at their best, enjoy coaching and feedback on their performance. While nobody likes criticism, these students are serious about mastering what interests them and appreciate any honest observations that can help them do that. The optimal learning style for Entrepreneurs is modeling: they like to watch a technique performed, immediately perform the same technique themselves, and then receive feedback on their performance. Once they gain confidence in their mastery, they're likely to put their own spin on their work.

Unbalanced Learning Habits

Loathing Traditional Structure

Entrepreneurs can struggle in an overly-structured, traditional classroom setting. Unfortunately, most academic settings focus on providing structure for students, approaching education as if everyone learns in the same way. Since most of the population is made up of Sentinel personality types, the idea that structured curriculum works best is consistently reinforced.

This system doesn't work well for Explorer types such as Entrepreneurs, who are, ostensibly, anti-Sentinels. This doesn't mean they don't like Sentinels or are against them. Rather, they work in an almost opposite manner. Sentinels are rules-based and prefer upholding tradition. They're orderly and think in linear ways, and traditional classrooms cater to their love of the predictable and routine. Entrepreneurs, however, tend to struggle in such restrictive environments.

Unfortunately for Entrepreneurs, Sentinels dominate our society and set the standards for what is generally accepted as good pedagogy in most educational systems. Many teachers and school administrators are also Sentinels. Generally, this sort of stability through standards-setting is an essential service Sentinels offer society. However, it can present real challenges for Entrepreneurs.

Rebalancing Learning Habits

Seeking Opportunities for Spontaneity

Parents and instructors who want to reach Entrepreneurs and engage them in the learning process must help them find their niche and provide them with opportunities to be spontaneous. Giving these students something to do on their

own provides some much-needed freedom to express themselves. Always looking for something new and novel, they tend to respond to instruction that has a feeling of boldness and spontaneity to it. Entrepreneurs like to reach decisions or conclusions in their own time based on what they discover. However, once they make such discoveries, they may not wait around for others before they implement them. Instructors should include enough flexibility in their lesson plans to accommodate this.

Still, it's important to remember that Entrepreneurs are likely to only take so much spoon-feeding before they go off on their own. Parents and instructors must allow them plenty of time to work on projects on their own schedules and in their own ways.

However, it's also worth pointing out that Entrepreneurs also enjoy working with others and need a wide range of activities rich in personal involvement. Too much seclusion or time spent working on assignments alone can cause impatience and boredom. Group activities are more stimulating for this personality type, especially those that model the skills they're learning. Working with a group dissecting frogs for biology provides much more significant learning outcomes for this type than labeling the frog's anatomy on a worksheet or writing a report about a frog's major organs.

Entrepreneurs in High School

If you've been to high school, you don't have to watch even one of the thousands of films about teenage angst to know that there's more to it than just classes. Most would agree there are as many lessons in schoolyards and hallways as there are in classrooms. So, let's take a moment to consider high school as a place where some critical social lessons unfold.

Balanced Entrepreneurs in High School

Energetic and Sociable

Entrepreneurs in high school can use their considerable charm and sociability to ensure they're never without a group of friends or dates to the prom. They're fun, energetic, and always looking for novel experiences. They love drama and excitement. They're aware of – and excited about – the world around them and appreciate it for what it is. Entrepreneurs in high school tend to be invited to the best parties and are likely to go to them just to see what's new.

Regarding a balanced approach to learning, Entrepreneurs understand the necessity of attending classes and getting passing grades. They may struggle with the class structure but are likely to excel at anything that allows them to use their creativity to pursue unique ideas or to practice their leadership skills in group activities. Hands-on activities, from building a birdhouse in shop class to participating in a model United Nations project, lead to greater interest and increased learning for these perceptive and practical students.

Extracurricular activities often pigeonhole modern teens into stereotypical niches: Cheerleaders are the popular kids, Latin Club is for the nerds, and so on. Entrepreneurs are usually athletic and, if involved in extracurricular activities, probably gravitate toward football or basketball. They tend to get to know people through shared activities rather than sitting down and talking with them. If Entrepreneur students are involved with clubs or groups to enhance their social lives, they prefer them to be something both active and productive.

Unbalanced Entrepreneurs in High School

Out of Sync with the System

If they take an unbalanced approach to education, Entrepreneurs often have a difficult time in high school. As discussed above, typical classrooms aren't a great fit for them. Their learning preferences may be so at odds with what happens in the average classroom they can come across as troublemakers or as not being bright. Within the system, it's easy to miss a genius of another type lurking below the surface in such students. Unfortunately, too many teachers and parents lack this perspective, and they often view Entrepreneurs as uncooperative or incapable.

Let the other students memorize cold, hard facts or play with ideas – but make sure Entrepreneurs have something practical to do. In high school, point Entrepreneur students toward anything social, athletic, or any hands-on skills that need mastery. If left to struggle within traditional education, Entrepreneurs aren't only likely to suffer poor grades, but the emotional and psychological distress can also be painful for them. The constant message they receive from their school environment is too often that they're out of sync with everyone else. While popular among their peers, there may still be a sense they don't fit in that can cause a great deal of damage to their self-esteem.

Rebalancing Entrepreneurs in High School

Relating Learning to Personal Interests

Entrepreneurs enjoy a wide range of interests. When they find activities they can connect with, they're likely to not only put in a great deal of effort to master them, but also tolerate the passive lecture halls a little better, too. Entrepreneurs settle

down and apply themselves more in school when they find their niche – or, in effect, find themselves.

When they're allowed to express themselves in ways true to their nature, they can sometimes find more patience for subjects that don't fit their interests. With a sense of fulfillment, it won't feel like they must deny themselves to do so. Once Entrepreneurs feel able to commit to something, they're passionate and loyal people, and that can spread to other less exciting parts of their lives – like the traditional classroom.

Work or College?

While many reasons are involved in deciding whether to go to college other than personality types, they can have a role in the equation. Most people over the years thought of attending college or university as the quickest path to success and security. Now some of these same people are vigorously arguing against higher education for everyone, having seen college dropouts succeed on a grand scale in our technological age – Steve Jobs and Bill Gates being the two most famous examples.

There's a niche for everyone and college is just one possible path to finding it. However, individuals who don't obtain college degrees may struggle to find work and aren't as likely to generate the same income as those who obtain those magical slips of paper. So, what might Entrepreneurs consider when deciding between attending university or going to work?

It's easy to see action-conscious Entrepreneurs wanting to get out into the world quickly to perform and produce. However, their need to master their craft can be just as insistent as their need to perform. They're the two things Entrepreneurs must

weigh and balance when thinking about college. If they have an image of it as a place with a lot of lecture halls and books, it may not appeal to them.

However, if they see it as a place with a vibrant social life, studios, workshops, and practice rooms, these may attract them to higher education. Balance can be attained just by choosing the right major at the right college. These types could find apprenticeships in the nonacademic world, but college provides “ready-made” opportunities to learn from others. (Occasionally, Entrepreneurs go into occupations that need certification. In those cases, they have no other choice than pursuing higher education.)

Entrepreneurs in College

Balanced Entrepreneurs in College

Free to Find Their Way

Those Entrepreneurs who choose to go to a college or university most likely feel set free. No longer bound by the rules of high school life, these students may finally find educational models that fit their style of learning. For many Entrepreneurs, leaving home and high school for college tends to be a liberating experience.

Entrepreneurs' course choices tend to be like the subjects they connected with in high school. Athletic or engineering-type disciplines in all their forms are a primary interest for many Entrepreneur college students, as well as some other active professions. Entrepreneurs should cautiously avoid pressure to choose majors and courses that present the same difficulties they faced in high school. Sometimes parents and guidance counselors, with all the best intentions, can send high school graduates in the wrong direction in college. If Entrepreneurs didn't embrace more

abstract, theoretical coursework in high school, the chances aren't any better for doing so when they go to college.

Unbalanced Entrepreneurs in College

Too Focused on Enjoying the Moment

Some feel that college and university are only about getting the tools necessary to make a good living. Most Entrepreneurs reject this as the primary reason to get a degree. Mastery and creativity tend to be the primary motivation for typical Entrepreneurs. Rightly or wrongly, they usually believe their passion can see them through. Not being too risk-averse, Entrepreneurs emphasize picking up skills in the “here and now” with only slight regard for the future.

Do Entrepreneurs look for “party schools” to strengthen their university experiences? Like most young people, they'll delight in the autonomy that going away to college offers. For many students, this is the first significant taste of life apart from their families and their families' rules. Some even choose their universities based on their distance from home.

It's no different for Entrepreneurs who are just as interested in coming into their own. They tend to fit nicely into campus party life. Their thirst for novelty and outgoing nature may lead them from party to party, with little downtime in between. They must be careful not to allow their social lives to overshadow any other reasons they may be attending college. This is an area in which Entrepreneurs must exercise caution.

Rebalancing Entrepreneurs in College

Learning to Deal with Difficulty

College is a time for Entrepreneurs to consider and exploit their strengths and talents in real ways. They can customize their courses of study to enough of a degree that they can feel fulfilled. However, everyone must take those courses most of us don't want to – the foundational, prerequisite courses. Entrepreneurs may want to embrace the idea that into every life a little mundane must fall. While there's often an option to "test out" of these courses, there are tremendous benefits to participating in these classes – and a little tolerance toward them may render some surprising material that proves more interesting than imagined.

Learning to cope with dull or overly challenging courses is good disciplinary practice for Entrepreneurs. This isn't the only time that they'll run into necessary tasks that feel meaningless and boring to them. College can help Entrepreneurs gain tolerance for such things and prepare them to approach the adult world in more balanced and realistic ways.

Conclusion

In aiming toward the ambitious creativity that even the name "Entrepreneurs" suggests, this type almost naturally embraces the role of lifelong learner. The initial trick in promoting learning for them won't involve directly motivating them or pushing them to improve skills, hoping their interest will ignite after the fact. The trick is to help them find an interactive discipline that grabs and inspires them up front. On discovering an interest, Entrepreneurs are likely to throw themselves into the process. Typically, when they find their niche, they look for ways to increase their skill

levels on their own. With that focus in place, they may even find education, in a broader sense, more appealing.

Entrepreneurs can help themselves get ahead in education by understanding how learning and training work for them. Nurturing and indulging their tendency toward curiosity can be beneficial as they search for their passions. Exploring with a purposeful emphasis on discovery can help start them on their educational – and perhaps professional – paths.

Additional Tools and Tests

Want to dig even deeper into your academic path? If you have access to the toolkits area of the website, we offer a variety of additional tools and tests to help you explore.

Thirst for Knowledge Test

What is your interest in gaining knowledge? How does your desire for learning affect your life? This tool will help you explore that.

Academic Exploration Test

Do you ever wonder what areas of study might suit your personality? Find out which subjects might be the most satisfying for you.

Perfectionism Test

Perfectionism is a desire to be remarkable and outstanding in everything you do. Let's see what role it plays in your life.

Type Guesser (Academic)

Are you trying to figure out what personality type your classmate belongs to? You may find that this simple tool helps.

Professional Development



Entrepreneurs' primary challenge is finding careers that are in line with their style and independent nature. While there's no one line of work that's best suited to them, it may be essential to find jobs that fit their unique temperament.

This section explores how Entrepreneurs can use their traits to maintain balance and excel in their professions. We'll look at what frustrates them and throws them off-balance at work – as well as strategies to repair unbalanced situations. Ultimately, the goal of this chapter is to provide tools to help Entrepreneurs succeed in the workplace.

Entrepreneurs do best when they remember to listen to themselves, especially when deciding on a choice of career. This advice may come easily to most of them. They know what they want and don't let social pressure force them into positions that are bad fits for their unique personality type.

This advice doesn't mean they should avoid entry-level positions, which may start as unsatisfying or uninteresting initially. When all is said and done, it's Entrepreneurs' responsibility to find jobs that allow them to feel happy in their professional

environments. They need enough room to breathe – and such space is unlikely in incompatible fields where they must struggle to get a foothold using someone else's methods.

Hands-On, "In the Moment" Workers

Entrepreneurs live in the moment. They look for the results of their actions immediately instead of thinking about or projecting things into the future. This style makes them "hands-on" workers, whether literally or just in the sense they involve themselves in their tasks from start to finish.

People with this personality type are less interested in building extensive systems or planning for contingency scenarios. They're happy to leave that to more technically-oriented Analysts. Instead, Entrepreneurs fare well where they must do unfamiliar work under time constraints.

Social – and Sociable – Employees

Entrepreneurs are charming, popular individuals with excellent networking skills – social characteristics they can apply to any work. Their calmness in stressful situations can be comforting to clients, coworkers, and supervisors; however, they aren't too interested in diplomacy or empathy. They may bypass such things if they believe doing so can still bring the results they desire. While these Extraverts clearly connect with others, there is likely to be a sense that doing so is more of an important option than an absolute necessity. This can make them powerful negotiators.

Practical and Persuasive

Entrepreneurs do best when they embrace front line roles, such as selling cars or running businesses. Their intrinsic desire to persuade others is likely to be a priority

for them in their workplace. While they would rather deal with practical matters over the more theoretical, it wouldn't be unusual for Entrepreneurs to do the unexpected – perhaps becoming politicians despite having little curiosity about political theory. Their energy and charisma are likely to help them succeed in such career paths.

Entrepreneurs are likely to be down-to-earth individuals, which helps them to remain calm when situations become difficult. These types don't care about superfluous information when it comes to making actual decisions. They focus on reality rather than theories and abstract concepts. Consequently, they tend to succeed in careers that reward practicality and efficiency – and, most importantly, focus on concrete, factual data.

Risk Takers

It's hard to imagine Entrepreneurs choosing a secure, boring job over a less stable but more exciting career path. People with this personality type are decisive and able to keep a cool head in critical situations. They feel comfortable making decisions on the go and take risks where others would falter – and usually come out as winners. In the right place and at the right time, taking effective chances can help push Entrepreneurs up career ladders (if they're climbing them), and can contribute to their being brilliant entrepreneurs (note the small “e”) and freelancers. Their boldness and improvisation skills can be formidable advantages in competitive environments.

Entrepreneurs aren't interested in the stability and security that are so dear to Sentinels. Instead, they live and breathe adrenaline, seeking excitement and novelty, and pushing limits further and further. Entrepreneurs are unmatched when it comes to exploring the unknown and in reaching the heights of human ability. It drives and motivates them, and this is what they should be focusing on – positioning themselves

in ways that allow them to concentrate on using their improvisation and problem-solving skills. They also must retain enough freedom to choose their methods.

Hidden Leaders

Their more free-form, risk-taking style can make it hard to see the leadership qualities Entrepreneurs possess. They may not appear disciplined enough. However, as hardened front-line soldiers, Entrepreneurs acquire an excellent ability to lead, even if such skills lurk beneath the surface. This quality can supercharge their careers if these potential leaders are in the right place at the right time.

People with this personality type should always keep their eyes open if the organizations they work for are prone to experiencing unexpected turbulence occasionally. There may be leadership opportunities close at hand.

Impatience

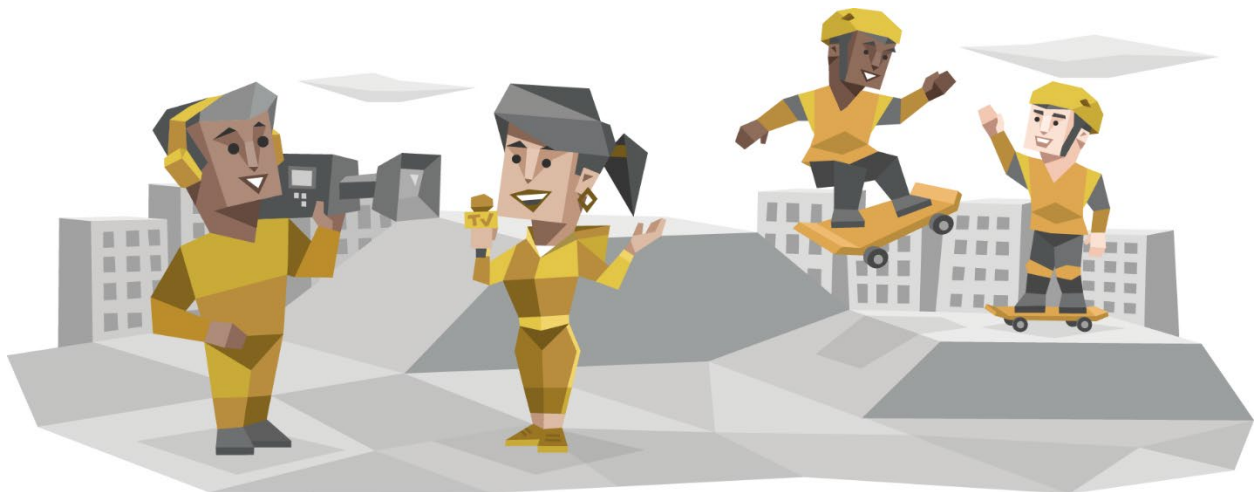
Entrepreneurs can be impatient, so careers or roles involving meticulous research or repetitive tasks aren't likely to be a good fit for them. Unfortunately, there are very few jobs where periods of slow, detailed work aren't occasionally part of the work week.

Entrepreneurs can rely too much on the practical and that which is happening in the moment. They may not always spend enough time expanding their knowledge or developing solid plans if they don't see current uses. They may disregard anything that doesn't provide them with immediate benefits or coax them to take immediate action.

Low Tolerance for Structure

Entrepreneurs dislike restrictive rules and highly structured environments. They prefer to trust their abilities and ideas instead of waiting for someone “at the top” to tell them what to do. This sometimes lands these types in trouble if unchecked. Their need for independence may challenge the established hierarchy, and some managers may not approve of their renegade ways. Ideally, Entrepreneurs would do well in careers where there’s little structure and a great deal of room for independent expression.

Career Options for Entrepreneurs



Balanced Career Options

Below is an offering of jobs consistent with Entrepreneurs’ traits. It’s by no means comprehensive – that would be impossible, and the list would grow daily. Hopefully, the descriptions below can serve as guidelines for Entrepreneurs just beginning to explore potential careers.

For those already employed, this may serve as a confirmation or explanation of why they might be happy or unhappy where they are. This offering doesn't presume to be a firm prescription of what they must do to be successful or happy. Rather, it's intended just to provide insights and broad guidelines.

Business and Sales

Entrepreneurs hold many qualities that make business careers a perfect fit for them. They're practical and not afraid to take risks. They're friendly, smooth, and persuasive. They have a natural flair for storytelling, and "branding" comes easily to them because of this skill. Entrepreneurs also tend to be powerful networkers, a skill useful in building businesses. People with this personality type seek the new and the innovative, and this puts them on the cutting edge – a potent characteristic to have in competitive business fields.

If there's a "glitch" discovered there's no better personality type to fix it. In fact, Entrepreneurs occasionally put problem-solving over the feelings and concerns of others. This can do damage to a team, but they get the job done, and bosses often overlook their occasional renegade ways – especially if they do away with troubling problems.

This ability to make trouble disappear is usually the reason Entrepreneurs climb corporate ladders fairly quickly. The dues they pay aren't about faithful compliance as much as about solving spectacular problems. This skill is how they get noticed.

Some possible business positions for Entrepreneurs include:

- Business management and administration
- Insurance sales
- Investment banking

- Entrepreneur
- Money management
- Real estate
- Non-profit fundraising
- Sales of any kind
- Advertising and public relations
- Event management

High-Octane, Active Jobs

When it comes to careers, Entrepreneurs have a long and diverse list of jobs from which to choose. They're quick decision-makers who are excellent candidates for roles that require thinking on their feet, such as sales, emergency services, crisis management, military, police, and anything of that nature.

Entrepreneurs are all about getting the job done and rarely let emotional distractions get in the way. This is useful during catastrophic crises that need cool heads. First responder jobs also provide them with new, exceptional experiences. Novelty energizes them, and emergency work provides an opportunity to master unique problems in real time. Since nothing is boring or mundane about helping somebody in real physical danger, such opportunities clearly speak to Entrepreneurs.

Their energetic natures push them toward action-oriented positions rather than highly analytical roles. People with this personality type are often excellent athletes. They're competitive, energetic, and are thrilled by action – pursuing careers as athletes or sportscasters may be right up their alley.

- Ambulance medic (EMT)
- Emergency room physician or nurse

- Police
- Firefighter
- Military
- Correction officer
- Investigator
- Disaster management
- Athlete
- Sportscaster

Law and Politics

Both law and politics involve a certain amount of putting out metaphorical fires. Entrepreneurs tend to be comfortable facing down opponents in courtrooms or political debates. They energetically apply themselves to solving legal or government problems and find fulfillment in creating satisfactory solutions for their clients or their constituents.

Charming, popular, and being great storytellers are advantages for lawyers and politicians, and Entrepreneurs are often equipped with all three characteristics. While politicians are supposed to have vision, Entrepreneur politicians are more likely to have solutions. They're likely to be more "bread and butter" candidates than those who profess to lead others to some ideological Promised Land.

Unbalanced Career Options

In modern society, individuals not only spend a great deal of time at work, but they also tend to allow their careers to give their lives meaning. Entrepreneurs must be careful not to get stuck in situations that don't suit them, or they may risk all manner of difficulties in the workplace.

Working Alone

Entrepreneurs won't be comfortable in cubicles doing solitary work unless it involves phone sales or other outreach. But even then, they'll yearn for more solid human interaction. Being stuck in cubicles working with a lot of lifeless data or paperwork is downright deadly to Entrepreneurs. They need people and often like to be the person in the front of the room.

Mundane and Repetitive

Entrepreneurs are most comfortable with activities that involve novelty and spontaneity. Repetitive work of any kind tends to fall short for them. They're great improvisers and easily get bored without challenges related to their skill sets.

Restrictive Environments

Entrepreneurs like to experiment and explore new ideas. If the structure and rules of their workplace are too rigid, they'll more than likely feel stifled and unfulfilled. These problem-solvers and innovators aren't happy when they can't exercise those passions. People with this personality type also like to take risks which may be frowned upon in offices that strongly emphasize rules.

Alternative Options

Self-Employment

Many people find the notion of self-employment scary. However, the days when someone would spend twenty years or more working for the same company are over. Job security and guaranteed prospects are a thing of the past, except in specialized fields such as the military or medicine. Working for oneself may be a

more secure and viable option, which also comes with a range of other benefits such as the ability to plan one's time, seeing the tangible results of one's work, and obviously being one's own boss. Entrepreneurs value freedom and self-reliance and being self-employed gives them excellent opportunities to enjoy these things.

Self-employment also side-steps one of the major hurdles that Entrepreneurs are likely to encounter in the corporate environment – forced compliance with numerous rules. While nobody is ever completely free from obligatory tasks, as self-employed individuals, Entrepreneurs have more flexibility to choose which tasks they want to perform and which they want to delegate or outsource.

This self-determination can relieve them of performing some mundane administrative work or having to follow others' irrational, unnecessary orders. Self-employment offers many major benefits to Entrepreneurs, especially in today's global and constantly connected environment. People with this personality are likely to succeed as their own bosses.

Entrepreneurship

Entrepreneurs may feel comfortable with a career that shares their name. Their willingness to take risks shines when they explore building their own enterprises. Plenty of "entrepreneurs" (small "e") give up after trying and failing because they were too afraid to jump into a pool full of what they see as sharks. Entrepreneurs (capital "E") are comfortable with risk and trust in their ability to find practical solutions quickly. They're likely to take risks, see what happens, and then deal with the consequences. They know what it means to be entrepreneurs because they've been trying new and dicey things all their lives.

However, without the right idea, a business goes nowhere. Entrepreneurs wishing to open the doors of their own businesses must think of interesting ways to fulfill existing needs (or create them) and do it better than their competitors. This wouldn't be difficult for them, given their amazing ability to improvise. Give Entrepreneurs strong ideas from the start, and they'll likely manage the rest easily.

Climbing the Career Ladder

Entrepreneurs tend to be very adaptable. Even at school – which is a source of frustration for many of them – they're likely to improvise and experiment in ways that perplex other types. They typically make decisions on the spot and refuse to plan or prepare for contingencies. However, Entrepreneurs are unstoppable when they find niches that give them the freedom to choose their preferred courses of action or to manage and influence other people. However, getting such opportunities may be challenging.

Making Contact

Entrepreneurs are likely to have no problem when it comes to socializing and networking. Their social natures can enhance any job hunting efforts, especially in tough job markets where their energy and outgoing natures can distinguish them from the herd. These individuals are likely to possess a keen eye for detail, a solid grasp on reality, and the gift of persuasiveness – skills that can help them get their foot in the door.

Relating Outside Interests

People with this type are likely to have plenty of outside activities to highlight on their resumes or during interviews. Entrepreneurs' hands-on nature doesn't just appear

overnight. Whether it's hobbies or sports, they probably have plenty of examples of their skills and energy to draw on.

Some relevant activities that Entrepreneurs entering the job market can use to enhance their applications include volunteer work, competitions, local neighborhood initiatives, small businesses, or a Web presence such as a blog or a social media presence.

Also, the more activities in Entrepreneurs' history, the more likely they can use them to provide breathing space during interviews. Answering a question like, "Describe a situation where you used your problem-solving skills," is much easier if there are plenty of real-life experiences to choose from for the answer.

Preparing for the Interview

Entrepreneurs may find it easy to show their prospective employers that they're very dedicated, capable, and trustworthy. However, before interviews, these types may want to make sure they've covered all the bases and planned things to highlight during the conversation. The danger in their tendency to "wing it" may be in not presenting a comprehensive enough picture of what they have to offer. They need to present their skills in the right way to distinguish themselves from other candidates. While it may not be their first impulse, taking the time to plan can be truly beneficial.

Entrepreneurs may rely too heavily on their social skills and enthusiasm to put them ahead of the other applicants. In addition to stressing their experience, it never hurts to prepare for common interview techniques and questions so as not to be caught off guard. In fact, some interviewers find it easier to go through a litany of typical questions, such as, "What would you say is one of your weaknesses?" Entrepreneurs

tend to be very good candidates in certain fields, but if they fail to prepare and don't get their message across, they risk losing out to less-qualified but better-prepared candidates. It's better to overprepare than underprepare.

Workplace Cooperation Between Types

It's useful to have something in common when speaking with someone else. It can make the rest of the conversation more productive if you start with a resounding "yes" rather than a stubborn "no." This section discusses possible pairings of Role groups, including brief overviews of potential synergies and obstacles, and some tips that may help Entrepreneurs navigate these tricky waters.

Entrepreneur-Analyst Cooperation



Entrepreneurs and Analysts both like to search for answers but their style and scope of doing so are different. However, if they both recognize that they're looking for "better and more efficient ways," it can make any discussion more productive. If they can grasp this and work with their different approaches, they may find that their motives are like enough. Bonding by using the things they have in common while

learning the value of their differences can go a long way in these business relationships.

Balanced Entrepreneur–Analyst Cooperation

Different Paths to the Same Goal

While Analysts want to play with ideas and systems, Entrepreneurs would rather solve problems in a hands-on fashion. While Analysts may not always see their ideas through to the end, it's hard to get Entrepreneurs to wait long enough to check with others before they carry out theirs. Analysts are more deliberative; Entrepreneurs are somewhat rash. Entrepreneurs work with the "here and now," focusing on the practical, while Analysts work with overarching systems that are more conceptual than tangible and often extend into the future. To solve real-world problems, there's nobody better than Entrepreneurs. If you want to know how to understand a system, deconstruct it, or build it better on paper, there's nobody like Analysts.

When Entrepreneurs and Analysts work together, they must understand that they're each part of a two-step process. Entrepreneurs can put together the pieces to make the Analysts' models work. Analysts are notoriously weak at implementation, while Entrepreneurs specialize in it. However, Entrepreneurs sometimes don't pay enough attention to the big picture and instead focus specifically on the details. This can put them out of sync with their organizations' overarching visions – and perhaps into some hot water. As long as each type realizes they both have good things to stir into the same pot, Entrepreneurs and Analysts can create powerful working relationships.

Consider *Apollo 13*, the movie and real-life event that brought us the iconic phrase, "Houston; we have a problem." After a mechanical mishap, three US astronauts were

in danger of not making it back to Earth alive in their crippled space capsule. In this scenario, Analysts can be compared to Houston's ground control who calculated all the numbers and worked out a trajectory. They created the system to get the astronauts home.

However, the astronauts (the Entrepreneurs in this analogy) were the problem-solvers who did the hands-on work and manipulated the details to swing their capsule around the Moon and bring it home safely. Communication between ground control and the astronauts was vital to the success of the rescue. This analogy loosely demonstrates how different functions and styles can work together to fulfill the same goal – particularly between theorists and craftspeople.

Unbalanced Entrepreneur–Analyst Cooperation

Diverse Focus

Analysts may become annoyed at Entrepreneurs' focus on details, while Entrepreneurs may feel that Analysts' ideas are too vague and impractical. (It's likely that they're not, but sometimes theory can appear that way to these types.) It can be tempting for Entrepreneurs to dismiss Analysts as having their heads in the clouds and not understanding the practical side of anything.

On the other hand, Analysts may declare that Entrepreneurs are reckless, have no vision, and think too narrowly about things. When either or both refuse to see the value of the other's style, communication is likely to shut down.

Analysts can be condescending if they don't feel someone can play skillfully in their playground of lofty notions and complex systems. They may wrongly react to Entrepreneurs' focus on detail and simply write them off as uninspired. Meanwhile, Entrepreneurs are just as likely to ignore Analysts' "nonsense" as they move ahead

and complete their preferred hands-on solutions. The result can be that both types quit talking to each other, and that's a pitfall these coworkers may wish to avoid.

Rebalancing Entrepreneur–Analyst Cooperation

Sharing New Perspectives

Analysts become bored with too many minute details, but this doesn't mean they have no use for them. They need not line up detailed facts in the same way Entrepreneurs do. But it's important for Entrepreneurs to understand their Analyst coworkers don't feel a need to dig into the minutia the same way they do. Entrepreneurs may want to ask their Analyst coworkers to give them feedback from their perspective. They may be surprised at how a bigger picture focus can help them define the tasks they're doing by providing a richer and broader perspective. In fact, a new point of view might save them from going off course. Analyst coworkers can be of immense help to them.

Entrepreneurs may want to be careful to avoid dismissing Analysts and their theories too quickly. They should remember that, despite all their lofty ideas, Analysts want the same thing they do – the successful resolution of problems and challenges. Both types are puzzle solvers, but each has a different technique. It may help communication if Entrepreneurs learn to ask their Analyst coworkers more “why” questions.

Entrepreneur-Diplomat Cooperation



Entrepreneurs (with their Observant, Thinking traits) and Diplomats (with their Intuitive, Feeling traits) as coworkers may appear at cross purposes. Entrepreneurs with their practical approach to life and problems and Diplomats with their more idealistic bent seem likely to conflict with one another. However, if, instead of thinking of these traits as opposite, they each see them as complementary, there may be much potential for Entrepreneur-Diplomat cooperation.

Balanced Entrepreneur-Diplomat Cooperation

The common ground between Diplomats and Entrepreneurs is somewhat intangible, but they share similar attitudes. Both enjoy a sense of moving forward and watching something become better. For Entrepreneurs, it's finding novel and interesting solutions to specific problems. They can look at a situation's tangled mess and figure out how to make it work, often in unique and interesting ways. For Diplomats, it's more about personal growth, moral development, and well-being. They love to flip a fixed idea and create a new perspective that contributes to humanistic improvement.

Despite their differences, both types share respect for flexibility; rules and traditions don't bind either too tightly. While Entrepreneurs tend to be much more practical and utilitarian when compared to Diplomats' idealistic pursuit of values, it's not hard to imagine both types sharing a common appreciation for innovation and change.

Combining Vision with Craft

If Intuitive types and Observant types are open to each other's differences, partnerships between them can offer a lot. Entrepreneurs excel at hands-on activities. They relish the mastery of objects within their physical environment. Diplomats, as Intuitive types, are great at grasping, creating, and transforming ideas. Details bore them, whereas Entrepreneurs are fascinated by them. Entrepreneurs want to know how they can manipulate each little piece and use it to create something new and better – especially if it meets a concrete need or feels like solving a puzzle.

If you want “visions,” call on Diplomats. If you want Diplomats' visions realized in down-to-earth but innovative ways, call on Entrepreneurs.

As an illustration, suppose Diplomat coworkers realize that their organization's problem revolves around a need to create a greater sense of community and camaraderie. Communication is poor, and Diplomats sense a lack of connection among their clients and coworkers. Entrepreneur colleagues might answer that realization by creating an email newsletter, a phone chain, a podcast, monthly coffees, or many practical methods for pulling all groups together. They could create a brand around the organization that says “community” and, in doing so, also create a team effort between the Diplomats and Entrepreneurs. While Entrepreneurs continue to contribute the mechanisms, Diplomats can constantly evaluate their progress – and the mood of the stakeholders.

Unbalanced Entrepreneur-Diplomat Cooperation

A False Dichotomy

While established standards don't bind either Entrepreneurs or Diplomats as tightly as they might Sentinels, Diplomats do have unique codes by which they live. Their values, usually connected to their sense of empathy and compassion, are strong forces in their lives. While Entrepreneurs aren't amoral as a rule, values aren't always as prominent in the way they handle business.

For instance, Entrepreneurs like people and are often friendly, outgoing, and fun. However, occasionally, they may see solving a problem as more important than taking care of their colleagues' or clients' feelings or welfare. They may take risks, cut corners, or cavalierly develop plans that might have a negative impact on others. They may trust their instincts a little too much, doing something on their own without taking other people's opinions or standards into account. Such occasions can create conflicts between Entrepreneurs and Diplomats.

The Doer and the Dreamer

Diplomats may see their Entrepreneur coworkers as shallow, while Entrepreneurs may regard Diplomats as impractical dreamers. Entrepreneurs tend to live in the "here and now," while Diplomats live in the infinite time of imagination and thought. They're more likely concerned with long-range results, while Entrepreneurs are more interested in immediate actions and solutions.

Let's use a hospital metaphor here. Diplomats would be case managers equipped to handle patients' long-term well-being and creating holistic treatment plans for them. Meanwhile, Entrepreneurs are down in the emergency room doing triage and reattaching limbs in their practical way. These two views can create difficulty in

communication between them. However, someone running a hospital wants both around if they're going to save lives in the long- and short-term.

Rebalancing Entrepreneur–Diplomat Cooperation

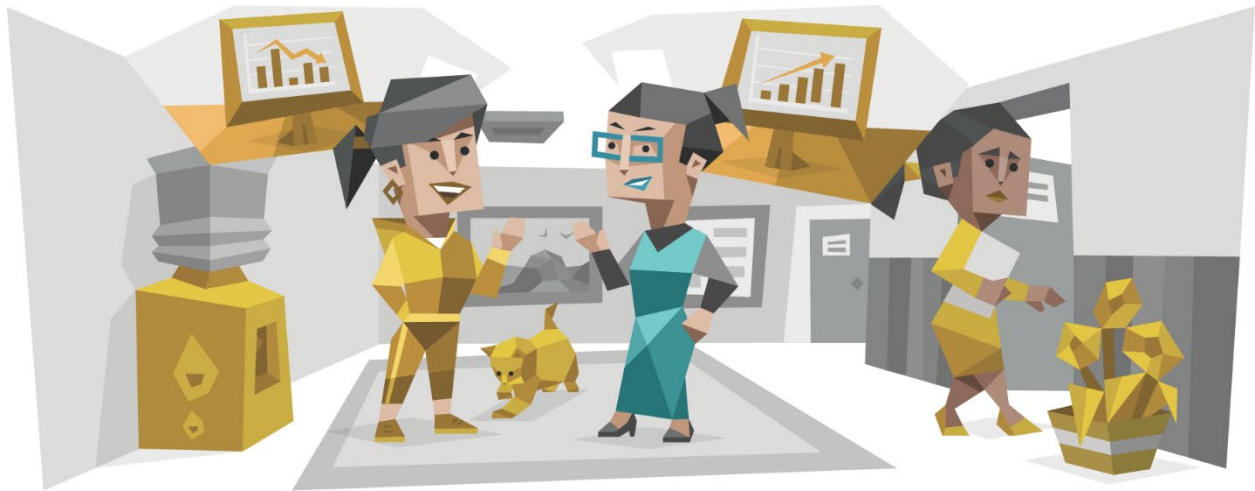
Discovering Motivations

If Entrepreneurs want to discover what motivates Diplomats, they should first try to find out their values. These coworkers are likely to extend their standards and ideals into their work lives as much as they reasonably can. The best way to communicate with them is to avoid bogging them down with many details or methods. These things are likely to be of little interest to Diplomats, who prefer talking about broader ideas. Entrepreneurs who want to find common ground with Diplomats may want to explore questions that start with “what if.” (In return, Diplomats may want to ask questions that begin with “how.”)

As with all pairings of distinct types, Entrepreneurs and Diplomats work together best when they learn to appreciate their differences. There's an economy among types which suggests that learning how to relate to different Roles in complementary fashion is likely to bring forth the most effective results.

For Entrepreneurs, this may mean allowing Diplomats to share their values and humanistic insights to give them a larger perspective. Entrepreneurs who accept such perspectives find their work takes on more value and is a lot more accessible to those they impact, such as supervisors and clients.

Entrepreneur-Sentinel Cooperation



It's easy to get the impression that Sentinels and Entrepreneurs are opposites since they often approach things differently. But they aren't without some commonalities. They both prefer to gather information directly from the world around them instead of filtering it through internal mechanisms – neither has much interest in theories.

While Entrepreneurs are more in touch with things directly and immediately, Sentinels usually judge their experiences by remembering how things have always been. They're generally sticklers for rules and structures that support a traditional perspective. Entrepreneurs relish the new and exciting, while Sentinels favor the stable.

Balanced Entrepreneur-Sentinel Cooperation

To the Rescue

Entrepreneurs and Sentinels most often complement each other when things go wrong. Sometimes even the tried-and-true ways of doing things fail. This can be disconcerting to predictability-loving Sentinels, but a compelling situation for Entrepreneurs. In this ever-changing world, there are times when old methods no

longer work. There may be no other choice but to develop new ways of doing things and there's no type better equipped to help when innovative things need to be done quickly than Entrepreneurs.

Known Places

Sometimes Entrepreneurs' impulsive drive to find solutions can get off track. Sometimes the best answer, when a situation goes bad, is to retreat to a known starting point. "Known places" are where Sentinels like to spend their time.

There are instances when boldly "winging it" can lead to effective solutions. However, there are also times when such approaches create more problems than they solve. Sometimes Sentinels can help Entrepreneurs "come home," figuratively speaking. Sentinels usually know how to repair situations, or they know someone who does. This can be of great help to Entrepreneurs who wander too far off in the wrong direction.

Unbalanced Entrepreneur-Sentinel Cooperation

Clashing Styles

There are things about Entrepreneurs that drive Sentinels crazy, and the other way around. However, Entrepreneurs have the advantage of usually going with the flow and not allowing others to bother them very much. For Sentinels, however, their problem with Entrepreneurs can be disturbing.

While Entrepreneurs have no problem cutting corners when necessary, Sentinels usually dedicate their lives to making sure those corners remain intact, just the way they've always been. Sentinels like things to be orderly and predictable. Entrepreneurs have a freer attitude and love things that are new and interesting.

Sentinels might prefer favorite restaurants they go to most of the time, and Entrepreneurs are likely to sample all the latest restaurants as they open. At work, Entrepreneurs can come across as reckless and undisciplined. To them, Sentinels might appear boring and uninspired. While their opinions of each other are usually more reactionary stereotypes than accurate assessments, such impressions can hinder trust and open communication.

Varying Regard for the Status Quo

While keeping the status quo strongly in place seems essential to Sentinels, Entrepreneurs have no problem doing what they feel is necessary to solve problems, regardless of “how it’s always been done.” Sentinels see tried-and-true means as the way to guarantee a predictable end. Only a successful end concerns Entrepreneurs, and they may use any means necessary to get there.

It’s easy to see how Sentinels can view Entrepreneurs as being at cross purposes with them. Sentinels may devote an undue amount of time trying to get Entrepreneurs to walk a straight line according to the rules. Meanwhile, Entrepreneurs may ignore Sentinel coworkers as they do whatever they feel they must, including going in a straight line, serpentine, or any other direction that helps them master a situation. The possibilities for conflicts between these colleagues are nearly endless.

Rebalancing Entrepreneur-Sentinel Cooperation

The Value of Protocols

As the Spanish philosopher and essayist Santayana wrote, “Those who cannot remember the past are condemned to repeat it.” Entrepreneurs can be too quick to dismiss Sentinels’ inherent attachment to the past and settled protocols. There can be much to learn from their adherence to tradition and set standards. But

Entrepreneurs shouldn't be afraid to ask why they must do something a certain way. Sentinels may want to avoid justifying acts or decisions by saying anything that resembles, "Because we've always done it that way."

Mutual Learning

Accepting Sentinels' counsel may help avoid problems. Entrepreneurs may feel Sentinels somehow limit their options. It may even be true. However, it's unlikely that Entrepreneurs can permanently lose their spontaneity and edgy creativity if they play by the rules on occasion. In fact, relying on their Sentinel coworkers' sensitivities to rules and standards may help them stay around to create another day. (When this happens, although Sentinels may never ask for it, they're always happy when someone shows appreciation. Doing so may be a way to create stronger work relationships between Entrepreneurs and Sentinels.)

Entrepreneur-Explorer Cooperation



Obviously, Entrepreneurs and other Explorers typically find themselves "speaking the same language." Theoretical and conceptual problems, which tend to thrill Analysts, are just annoying to both. They find no purpose in going there.

Conversations about solving problems or mastering a skill or situation are of great interest. They gain energy and motivation from topics that reveal how they overcame problems and saved the day.

Balanced Entrepreneur-Explorer Cooperation

Whatever Gets the Job Done

Whatever gets the job done is what interests Entrepreneurs and other Explorers who work together. They may bypass rules, standards, or traditions that hinder their focus and strategies. Because of this – and their pronounced spontaneity and independence – others often see them as risk takers.

Entrepreneurs are likely to be comfortable with other Explorers who also seek to do things their way. They like talking about the new and different if these discussions focus on tangible matters and don't wander into the arena of abstract theories. While people belonging to these types might appreciate discussing the capabilities of the new iPhone, they tend to show less interest in discourse about "the future sociological impact of constant digital communications worldwide."

They might share a sense of satisfaction if they figure out a unique use for the phone. The second topic, however, would be "just talk" to these action-oriented coworkers.

Practical Innovation

Entrepreneurs and other Explorers working together in a team are a likely brainstorming powerhouse within their company. They won't only resolve problems but also innovate and add to the growth of their organization – but only as it affects methods. The harnessed energy of Entrepreneurs and Explorers who bounce ideas off each other can be a formidable asset to any employer. Entrepreneur and Explorer

coworkers are likely to make any joint discoveries on the run and by applying their hands to problems, rather than drawing out diagrams and steps on a whiteboard.

Unbalanced Entrepreneur-Explorer Cooperation

Problems that arise when Entrepreneurs and other Explorers talk to each other likely have nothing to do with mutual understanding. Instead, they may become stuck in their shared style of thinking without the benefit of insight from those who think differently. In business and life, it's good to have varied personality types around to give balance.

But at What Cost?

On the off-chance that the workplace becomes too "Explorer-heavy," several factors can be problematic. Grace Hopper, the late computer scientist and United States Navy Rear Admiral, famously said, "It's easier to apologize than to get permission." Entrepreneurs and other Explorer types often take this quote to heart, resulting too often in their getting into trouble. Their willingness to take different paths and risks to find unique solutions can be an asset in the workplace. However, it shouldn't go unchecked.

Like risk-taking, the often-complex relationship Entrepreneurs and other Explorers have with their coworkers may also need tempering. While both types typically enjoy other people, they often put practical solutions ahead of the feelings and concerns of others. They may come across as having a brusque disregard for their coworkers.

It's not that they don't like their colleagues. But they tend to place people below solutions on their list of priorities. "It can't be helped," would be the shared excuse between Entrepreneurs and their Explorer accomplices – if they even discuss such matters – resulting in a gulf between them and other colleagues.

Solutions with a Small Perspective

Entrepreneurs and other Explorers may also find their actions don't align with their organizations' larger visions. Being detail-oriented and thinking in the present, these similar types may disregard the long view of their organization's goals and focus. Just as it takes one degree of a compass to send a ship hundreds of miles off course, so can a small misguided solution potentially disrupt a company's broader goals.

To Entrepreneurs who work with other Explorers, their solutions may seem reasonable. To their supervisors, it can appear as though they're thumbing their noses at the vision and values of their firms. If not adjusted for, the immediacy of the Explorer mindset can create a tunnel vision that ignores greater matters.

Rebalancing Entrepreneur-Explorer Cooperation

Appreciating Commonalities

It's always enjoyable when like minds work together. When Entrepreneurs and other Explorers have the opportunities to do so, they want to enjoy the camaraderie and consider using this time to brainstorm new and better ways of doing things. It's likely these coworkers may enjoy simply spending time talking to each other. The experience can be kicked up a notch if they find something to tinker with while they're chatting.

Getting a Second Opinion

When two types are so similar and comfortable with each other's great ideas, a second opinion from someone more "mainstream" can be useful. Every personality type can benefit from the balance provided by other types. Even Entrepreneurs and

their Explorer teammates can grow as individuals and as teams when they expand their comfort zones by exploring different approaches.

Asking “Why?”

Entrepreneurs and other Explorers who work together may find that they’re comfortable exploring the “how” questions involved in finding a solution. To rebalance their efforts to keep their contributions beneficial rather than harmful, learning to ask “why” may be just as essential. This may again require a second opinion from other types more in touch with the bigger picture.

Conclusion

Even from within the teams they so enjoy, Entrepreneurs must exercise independence and expression of their personal skills. Such autonomy is essential to their happiness and motivates them to produce and succeed. If a job feels like it’s overstructured and conformity-based, Entrepreneurs won’t be able to access that part of themselves that responds to challenges. They need some way to exercise their unique skills.

To thrive in a job, Entrepreneurs must find a niche that is their own. Most are good at this, having practiced it while dealing with school systems focused on more conventional things than they, as young people, could relate to. While not always adept at committing in life in any traditional sense, once they find their niche, they’re usually all in for the duration. This allows them to become highly skilled and often specialized – making Entrepreneurs valued workers and professionals in many fields.

Additional Tools and Tests

Want to dig even deeper into your professional development? If you have access to the toolkits area of the website, we offer a variety of additional tools and tests to help you explore.

Job Preferences Test

Among the most important things you decide in life is how you're going to make a living. Discover which job fields fit you best.

Job Burnout Test

We've all heard the term "burnout." But what does it mean to you? This test will guide you as you take a look at how burnout affects you.

Career Values Test

What should your job look like for you to call it "ideal"? What aspects matter most to you? This tool will help you answer these questions.

Leadership Styles Test

What is your leadership style? There is no right or wrong answer to that question. This test will help clarify your preferred approach.

Leadership Styles II Test

The second part of our Leadership Styles test will explore your desire to be a leader and willingness to delegate power.

Motivation Test

On average, we work for about 90,000 hours over our lifetime. With that in mind, it's helpful to figure out exactly what motivates you.

Ambition Test

How eager are you to succeed, and at what cost? Ambition can be a double-edged sword – explore how it works in your case.

Professional Authenticity Test

When at work, are you acting in a way that is consistent with your true self? Explore difficult questions about authenticity with this test.

Goal Orientation Test

What's the underlying motivation you feel when confronting a challenge? See which of the Goal Orientations influences you most.

Type Guesser (Workplace)

Are you trying to figure out what personality type your coworker belongs to? You may find that this simple tool helps.

Final Words



The excitement Entrepreneurs carry with them wherever they go is hard to match. Because they're so bold, passionate, and social, it's easy to leverage these qualities into successful lives that engage others and provide the energy that moves things forward. While they value rationality and use it in practical ways, Entrepreneurs may just as quickly bypass it if they believe a situation is becoming bogged down in endless academic exercises and cycles of theorizing. They prefer to jump into action and can happily sort out the deeper rationale after the fact. The moss of deliberation rarely has time to grow on this personality type.

But for all the excitement, Entrepreneurs also possess other tendencies they'd do well to notice and try to improve. While social and even charming, their people skills aren't always up to par. Hasty forward motion often comes with impatient bluntness and perhaps a tendency to trample over those in their way. Entrepreneurs take unnecessary risks, and they may do so apart from any purpose other than the adrenaline rush. Tedium is their enemy.

Yet sometimes persisting and following a slow routine is necessary to win. The challenge for Entrepreneurs is to maintain their valuable high energy while balancing

it against a more calculated approach. Slow is the pace at which people often discover purpose and perspective. Growth is the product of a willingness to change, and effortlessly shifting gears is part of who they are. If applied toward their shortcomings, all this can be useful for Entrepreneurs' growth.

What's Next?

We've covered many different topics in this profile, and we hope that the chapters have offered insight and answered questions about the Entrepreneur personality type. We hope that readers will now find it easier to understand other people and their perspectives. This profile isn't meant to be read just once. When trying to understand another person better, or struggling to understand oneself, another read-through can offer fresh insight.

Furthermore, spend some time on our [website](#) – for example, by exploring our [articles](#) or [additional assessments](#). If you lead a team, our [Team Assessments](#) can help you understand its unique dynamics. Consider lending us a helping hand by taking additional [surveys](#) or simply [sending us a message](#) and sharing your thoughts about this profile or the website in general. We would love to hear from you.

We wish the best of luck to all Entrepreneurs. What matters most in Entrepreneurs' lives is that their paths through life reflect who they are, deep within. Reflecting on values, dreams, and ideals often reveals the right path through life by clearing out superficial distractions. Our lives are often too full of troubles, conflicts, and worries. By working to better understand each other, we can make our relationships, communities, and world more aware, more genuine, and more peaceful.

Until next time.

Addendum: The Puzzle of Personality

Often the very first question people ask after completing our personality test is “What do these letters mean?” We are of course referring to those mysterious acronyms like INTJ-A, ENFP-T, or ESTJ-A. As you may have already learned from the Type Descriptions or articles on the website, the five letters of these acronyms each refer to a specific trait, with certain trait combinations forming various types and type groups. But before we discuss those traits in depth, let’s explore their historical foundations.

The Historical Detour

Since the dawn of time, humans have drawn up schematics to describe and categorize our personalities. From the four temperaments of the ancient civilizations to the latest advances in psychology, we have been driven to fit the variables and complexities of human personality into well-defined models. Although we are still some time away from being able to do that, the current models account for our most important personality traits and can predict our behavior with a high degree of accuracy.

Personality is just one of many factors that guide our behavior, however. Our actions are also influenced by our environment, our experiences, and our individual goals. On our website, we describe how people belonging to a specific personality type are likely to behave. We outline indicators and tendencies, however, not definitive guidelines or answers. Significant differences can exist even among people who share a personality type. The information on this website is meant to inspire personal

growth and an improved understanding of yourself and your relationships – not to be taken as gospel.

Our approach has its roots in two different philosophies. One dates back to early 20th century and was the brainchild of Carl Gustav Jung, the father of analytical psychology. Jung's theory of psychological types is perhaps the most influential creation in personality typology, and it has inspired a number of different theories. One of Jung's key contributions was the development of the concept of Introversion and Extraversion – he theorized that each of us falls into one of these two categories, either focusing on the internal world (Introvert) or the outside world (Extravert). Besides Introversion and Extraversion, Jung coined the concept of so-called cognitive functions, separated into Judging or Perceiving categories. According to Jung, each person prefers one of these cognitive functions and may most naturally rely on it in everyday situations.

In the 1920s, Jung's theory was noticed by Katharine Cook Briggs, who later co-authored a personality indicator still used today, the Myers-Briggs Type Indicator® (MBTI®). Briggs was a teacher with an avid interest in personality typing, having developed her own type theory before learning of Jung's writings. Together with her daughter, Isabel Briggs Myers, they developed a convenient way to describe the order of each person's Jungian preferences – this is how four-letter acronyms were born.

Of course, this is just a very simplified description of the Myers-Briggs theory. Readers interested in learning more should read *Gifts Differing: Understanding Personality Type* by Isabel Briggs Myers. As we define personality traits and types differently in our model, we will not go deeper into Jungian concepts or related theories in this article.

Due to its simplicity and ease of use, the four-letter naming model has been embraced by a number of diverse theories and approaches over the last few decades, including frameworks such as Socionics, Keirsey Temperament Sorter, Linda Berens' Interaction Styles, and many others. While the acronyms used by these theories may be identical or very similar, however, their meanings do not always overlap. One of the reasons behind such a lengthy introduction is that we want to make it clear that there is no single definition assigned to these type acronyms – each theory defines them in their own way and it is entirely possible that if you meet five people who all say “I am an INFJ”, their definitions of what INFJ means are going to differ.

Types vs. Traits

Regardless of its structure, any type-based theory will struggle to describe or characterize people whose scores lie near the dividing line. A different way to look at personalities is through the lens of a trait-based rather than a type-based model. What do we mean by that? Instead of creating an arbitrary number of categories and attempting to fit people within them, a trait-based model simply studies the degree to which people exhibit certain traits.

You may have heard the term Ambivert, which is a perfect example in this case. Ambiversion means that someone falls in the middle of the Introversion-Extraversion scale, being neither too outgoing nor too withdrawn. Trait-based theories would simply say that an Ambivert is moderately Extraverted or moderately Introverted and leave it at that, without assigning a personality type.

A trait-based approach makes it easier to reliably measure correlations between personality traits and other characteristics – for example, political attitudes. This is

why trait-based approaches dominate psychometric research, but that's more or less the only area where these approaches are dominant. Because they don't offer types or categorizations, trait-based theories don't translate as well as type-based theories into specific recommendations and takeaways. Assigned categories such as Extravert or Introvert may be limiting, but they allow us to conceptualize human personality and create theories about why we do what we do – something that a more scientifically reliable but colorless statement, such as you are 37% Extraverted, simply cannot do.

Our Approach

With our NERIS® model, we've combined the best of both worlds. We use the acronym format introduced by Myers-Briggs for its simplicity and convenience, with an extra letter to accommodate five rather than four scales. However, unlike Myers-Briggs or other theories based on the Jungian model, we have not incorporated Jungian concepts such as cognitive functions, or their prioritization. Jungian concepts are very difficult to measure and validate scientifically, so we've instead chosen to rework and rebalance the dimensions of personality called the Big Five personality traits, a model that dominates modern psychological and social research.

Our personality types are based on five independent spectrums, with all letters in the type code (e.g. INFJ-A) referring to one of the two sides of the corresponding spectrum. You can see where you fall on each scale by completing our free personality assessment, NERIS Type Explorer®. This approach has allowed us to achieve high test accuracy while also retaining the ability to define and describe distinct personality types.

Five Personality Aspects

This section will describe five personality aspects that, when combined, define the personality type: Energy, Mind, Nature, Tactics and Identity. Each of these aspects should be seen as a two-sided continuum, with the “neutral” option placed in the middle. The percentages you would have seen after completing the test are meant to show which categories you fall under, and how strong your preferences are.

Let us now go through the personality aspects one by one:

Introverted vs. Extraverted

More Than People Power

When considering people who are Introverts (I) and Extraverts (E), it's natural to go straight to the more social aspects of these personality traits. However, they are more than this. These traits are also defined by their broader response to their environments, which includes other people but isn't exclusively about them.

Introvert (I) Personality

Strength in Reserve

Introverts are well-suited to many situations. A tendency to be reserved helps these personality types to pace themselves. They're likely to listen to others more carefully. Very introspective, Introverts enjoy more focused “alone time” – leading to more and deeper insights. And, while sometimes too sensitive to their environments, this often helps them pick up cues more quickly, making them great at reading many situations.

However, this same reserve means that Introverts tend to find outside stimuli like noise, motion, or intrusive lighting frustrating. Some of this can be an invigorating change of pace – too much unsettles them and drains their energy. These personality types often prefer to be in their own space where they can adjust their environments. Add a human factor to this sensitivity – for example, insistent conversations where they're expected to be just as insistent – and it can exhaust them. They need time alone to regather their energy and restore their calm.

Introverts' reserved, more solitary nature presents challenges, as many societies favor Extraverts and their bolder approach. But it helps Introverted personality types to take things slowly, cautiously, and with less fanfare. Fortunately, if they're willing – and create the time to recharge on their own – most Introverts can handle society's strenuous demands.

In fact, many successful leaders and entertainers come from their ranks, often remaining humble and avoiding an unnecessary spotlight in fame. The Introversion personality trait never needs to disqualify those who possess it from pursuing a goal.

Extravert (E) Personality

The Power of Engagement

Extraverts are interested in engaging with their environment, and they feed off the responses of the people and events around them. They enjoy pushing limits and seeing what the world can do. This all depends on many other factors and life's natural limitations, but Extraverted personality types lean toward taking the initiative and relying on the world around them for validation.

While all of this is noble and often admired in society, it can also become unbridled. Extraverts may put too much value in their engagement with those around them. Being with others can be so important to these personalities that they often find it difficult if they're stuck alone. Boredom comes too easily. This can lead them to do things simply for excitement rather than thinking through more subtle but important considerations. Becoming the center of attention – at any cost – might be too appealing.

However, when they suitably address these challenges, Extraverts are forces to be reckoned with. People with this personality trait tend to advance projects important to them quickly, whether personal or professional. They often choose to lead when given a chance – and can be dynamic in that role. Their outgoing energy can be vital to a social gathering, and their liveliness can be contagious. And there always remains a sense that people are important to them.

Intuitive vs. Observant

Thought at Every Scale

Our second personality scale includes the Intuitive (N) and Observant (S) styles. These traits describe what people are more likely to do with the information gathered from the world around them. Intuitive personality types rely on imagining the past and future potential of what they see. Those with the Observant style are more interested in observable facts and more straightforward outcomes. They prefer to avoid layering too much interpretation on what they see.

Being Intuitive doesn't mean someone can't be practical, and being Observant doesn't mean a lack of imagination. They both use their minds and their physical

senses well. The difference is the spin they put on their experiences – it's where their thinking goes after an encounter with their environment. If Intuitive personality types appreciate Observant types' practicality, and Observant personality types appreciate Intuitive types' imaginative perspective, they can complement each other in ways that make for unbeatable partnerships.

Intuitive (N) Personality

Eyes on the Horizon

People with the Intuitive trait prefer to exercise their imaginations as they seek new ideas and possibilities. They live their day-to-day lives just like any other personality type. But while that's happening, their minds tend to point inward while at the same time gently focusing somewhere beyond the horizon. Their lives are ones of questioning, wondering, and connecting the dots in the "bigger picture," and they love the theoretical. They often ask, "What if?" and ponder the possibilities the future might hold.

But Intuitive people aren't always the most practical, preferring instead to give things deeper meaning. There may be a long wait as these personality types allow their imaginations free rein. They may also leap in too quickly to more complex matters. An entire theory can come together in moments, leaving others confused. In either case, they can appear out of touch to the Observant individuals in their lives. For some Intuitive folk, there may be some truth to this observation.

That said, when there's a need for innovation or a different perspective, people with Intuitive personality types can usually step up and provide a new direction. Practicality can sometimes be overrated, especially when a situation calls for serious change and "coloring outside the lines." This is where Intuitive people shine. They

bring interesting dimensions to life beyond everyday ideas – and take those who decide to go along with them.

Observant (S) Personality

Do What Works

The phrase “real-time” was created with Observant individuals in mind. They’re most in touch with what occurs in front of them, in the present. This doesn’t mean Observant personality types have no regard for the past and future. But they view both from the perspective of how each influences their present actions. This makes them focused and practical people. They mostly root their thinking in the actionable, tangible, and useful. But make no mistake, these personalities can be creative within that realm.

One challenge people with the Observant personality trait may face is a too-narrow perspective. They may reject far-reaching solutions in favor of something more obvious. By continuing something that appears practical at arm’s length but doesn’t fit the bigger picture, they might reduce their hard work to busywork.

People with the Observant trait are often a steadying force that tends to get things done. Their energy is very “hands-on” in the sense of working on real things in real-time. While they’re often smart people, spending a lot of time sitting around and pondering possibilities doesn’t cut it for Observant personality types. They want thoughts and talk to lead to action.

Thinking vs. Feeling

How to Think and Feel About the Thinking and Feeling Traits

Our third, Nature scale reveals the extent to which we value emotions or rationality more when considering options. Does a person tend to use the Thinking (T) personality trait, which relies on the head, or the Feeling (F) trait, which relies on the heart?

But let's not oversimplify. Think of it instead as you might your hand preference: A left-handed person leans more heavily on their left hand, but they still use their right hand, albeit less. We can apply the same approach to a person with a dominant Thinking trait or a dominant Feeling trait – they aren't without some qualities of the non-dominant trait.

Thinking (T) Personality

"How Does This Help?"

When presented with a decision, people with the Thinking trait typically lean on objective information. Knowledge is their indispensable tool. Once these personality types gather the facts, they test their alternatives against logic and reason to see which decision, by those standards, proves the most effective or realistic. They generally manage their relationships by employing fairness and effectiveness as their primary method of dealing with others. Their passions are born of respect.

Whatever value people with the Thinking personality trait place on relationships, they can still dismiss emotional responses, either their own or those of others. This is often because of their discomfort with emotions, which don't always follow the rational path they value. Sometimes, emotions just puzzle them. But that doesn't

mean they have hearts of stone. They often feel in deep, profound ways – they would just rather not decide matters from that place. And, perhaps unfortunately, they may see those who do as weaker decision-makers.

Personality types with the Thinking trait are likely to evaluate things almost relentlessly. This isn't as bad as it sounds. They aren't satisfied if they believe something is not well thought out – they revel in the brilliance of an elegant plan. This makes them great to have around when critical thinking and impartiality of any kind is the focus, and this makes them immensely helpful for sorting out ideas and methods. Their primary filter is, *"How does this help?"*

Feeling (F) Personality

"Who Does This Help?"

People with the Feeling (F) trait follow their hearts and emotions – sometimes without even realizing it. They may show it to different degrees and in different ways, but however they do it, Feeling personality types tend to be caring, compassionate, and warm. These concerned people can be highly protective of those they care about – whether that is their immediate family or remote populations in need.

However, people with the Feeling personality trait often find they become excessive in their concern for others. They may easily burn out – or cause others to – when they become too involved. These emotionally aware individuals can become depressed if they feel they haven't been as selfless in life as they imagine they should be, or if those they have helped seem to fall down regardless.

Feeling personality types' concern for others typically affects all their endeavors. This can be practical and close, as with family, friends, and colleagues. Or it can be broader, as with world peace, ending hunger, and giving the disadvantaged a boost.

But this reliance on feelings doesn't mean there is no logic – theirs is just a different logic. They see that emotions can't simply be waved away, so feelings and the welfare of others shape their lives more than stark facts and cold objectivity. Weighing things this way makes these personalities valuable to have around when the big question is, “*Who does this help?*”

Judging vs. Prospecting

Crossing the Finish Line (By Whatever Means)

The Tactics scale, which includes the Judging and Prospecting personality traits, reflects how people plan and deal with the options they have. But this definition doesn't just concern what individuals write in their day planners. It's much broader. These traits answer questions like, “Do you prefer spontaneity or certainty?” “Do you feel more comfortable acting only with all your ducks lined neatly in a row? Or does a certain amount of flexibility or chaos excite you and prove motivating?” “Do you need more choices or fewer?”

Judging (J) Personality

Making Things as They Ought to Be

People with the Judging (J) personality trait feel most comfortable when the course ahead is well-marked. They would rather come up with five backup plans than deal with events as they come. Preferring to consider their options ahead of time,

personality types with this trait prefer clarity and closure, sticking with the plan rather than going with the flow. It's as if Judging types always keep a mental checklist. When they cross something off their list – or even start an item on their list – they consider it complete and not open to reconsideration.

The downside is, if they take this too far, those with the Judging trait sometimes come across as rigid. However, most are not unreasonably stubborn. It's important to remember their need for structure always is a preference and reality often calls on them to respond in unforeseen ways. Too many surprises in a row can leave these personality types frustrated and stressed. When this happens, they can still be relied on to develop a plan (and a contingency plan), but however well they handle the unexpected, they rarely enjoy it.

Judging individuals tend to have a strong work ethic, putting their duties and responsibilities above everything else. To them, rules, laws, and standards are the key to success. They can be too dependent on these measures, whether applied to themselves or others. But the intent is almost always one of fairness and results.

Prospecting (P) Personality

Figuring Things Out as They Go

Prospecting (P) individuals are much more flexible when it comes to dealing with unexpected challenges. This flexibility helps them seize unexpected opportunities as well. These personality types tend to react to their environments rather than try to control them, helping them to make their own luck in whatever the world delivers. People with this trait hold that life is full of possibilities.

All this opportunism can lead to impulsive decision-making, though. At the same time, they can be overwhelmed by the sheer number of options on their radar. People with the Prospecting personality trait can be slow to commit to something because of uncertainty or the potential of everything else. If they don't moderate this trait, indecision or a lack of conviction can be a problem. They can seem unfocused. What was important to them one week may be forgotten the next.

Despite those concerns, this personality trait can offer a great deal of creativity and productivity. Theirs is almost a stream of consciousness quality. In many ways, it's like these types are constantly brainstorming as their minds create a web of options. This can be a powerful tool for finding solutions. And if they aren't satisfied with something in their lives, it's easier for them to let go of it and choose something else. This can lead to serial passions that keep Prospecting individuals stimulated as they explore the buffet of choices always before them.

Assertive vs. Turbulent

Confidence, Achievement, and You

The Identity scale, made up of the Assertive and Turbulent personality traits, affects all other scales and indicates how confident we are in our abilities and decisions. Identity triggers the way we react to the things life constantly throws at us. How do we respond to success and failure? Criticism or feedback from other people? Unexpected events that suddenly change many things or everything? Even the unknown future?

Assertive (-A) Personality

Calm in the Storm

Assertive individuals are self-assured, even-tempered, and resistant to stress. They don't worry too much, but this is different from apathy. They aim for goals and want successful results, but they typically won't let nervousness color the path to their accomplishments. They're unlikely to spend a lot of time thinking about their past actions or choices. According to Assertive personality types, what's done is done.

However, problems may arise for them if their confidence turns into overconfidence. Assertive individuals may gloss over problems or details that can interfere with their goals and desired results. They may lean toward assuming all will be positive. Assertive people also sometimes presume they are free to do much more than others would allow or tolerate. If overconfident, these personality types may come to believe their confidence overshadows what others want.

But their confidence remains. It can help them move forward where others might hesitate. People with this personality trait report more satisfaction with their lives. They feel more assured of their abilities to handle the difficult and the unexpected. Through this lens, they often create the kinds of success that matter to them.

Turbulent (-T) Personality

Power of Stress, Activate!

Turbulent individuals are success-driven, perfectionistic, and eager to improve. They are always trying to counterbalance their self-doubts by achieving more. Just as they push themselves to become better, they're as likely to push their projects or efforts

in the same direction. Turbulent personality types tend to notice little problems and often do something about them before they become larger ones.

There are potential downsides to all this attention and achievement. Always feeling the need to do more, to have more, and to *be* more, Turbulent individuals can also get caught up in endless thoughts of criticisms, slights, or regrets. This can either bog them down or motivate them to do better. Their sensitivity to potential problems can be useful – unless that’s all they think about and the problems clutter their attention. Turbulent personality types may compulsively scan for what might go wrong instead of keeping their eyes on more positive targets – on what could go right.

Careful and attentive people are always important to society and keep it safe. At the same time, a fear of stagnation can bring about great change. Turbulent individuals beautifully cover both. When these personalities balance their worries and concerns with positive action, they’re likely to prove themselves to be of great value.

Type Groups

Now you know what each type consists of. But how do they fit together?

Our system has two layers: the first (inner) one defines our Roles, the second (outer) one – our Strategies.

Roles

Personality theory is a study of similarities among people with shared traits and how these traits might be expressed through behaviors and attitudes. Traits are the most fundamental part of our framework and include characteristics like Introversion or

Thinking. The next level contains personality types, in which four of the traits are combined and sorted to create 16 personality types. Roles, simply put, are the next level. At the Role level, the 16 types are divided into four groups.

Which personality types belong to each Role depends on two shared traits that they have in common. While all traits influence behaviors and attitudes, the two traits that determine a Role are shared by only four personality types and instill in them some unique, matching characteristics.

Those with the Intuitive trait (Analysts and Diplomats) are paired with the Thinking/Feeling traits because the Intuitive trait focuses on internal processes like thinking and feeling. While they may ultimately play out in the external world, they are primarily inward-looking.

In like manner, those with the Observant trait (Sentinels and Explorers) are paired with the Judging/Prospecting traits. Judging and Prospecting, while they have their internal aspects, are more likely to be played out in the external, concrete world of action and doing. Sentinels with their Judging trait are likely to bring order to their worlds, while Explorers with their Prospecting trait are likely to instill spontaneity into all the actions they perform.

The four Roles are primarily used when they are more likely to explain concepts in a clearer, less complicated way than involving all 16 personality types might. Using Roles this way is particularly warranted if the topic consists of a trait or traits that are a prominent part of the core traits of the various Roles – such as when Intuitive or Observant have a greater influence. But use is not limited to just that. They're like shorthand when Role commonalities suffice in talking about a subject.

In summary, Roles are just another level of the same theory, with each of the four containing four personality types. Those within a Role share a combination of two prominent traits and, therefore, share some similar characteristics.

The Role layer determines our goals, interests, and preferred activities. There are four roles:

Analysts – Intuitive (N) and Thinking (T)

Thinkers, Not Robots

The personality types in the Analyst Role – Architects (INTJ), Logicians (INTP), Commanders (ENTJ), and Debaters (ENTP) – are known for their love of rationality. Because they share the Thinking trait, these types often aim to make decisions with their heads rather than their hearts. But Analysts are far from being robots. Their Intuitive personality trait energizes their imaginations, helping them to come up with creative strategies and motivating them to explore things deeply – whether that’s an intellectual pursuit, a new interest, or even a crazy scheme or thought experiment.

These personalities are driven to understand and create. They have no problem switching between speculative musing and tactical problem-solving. Of course, these broad abilities need to be honed – and, when appropriate, they need to lead to action. Otherwise, Analysts’ active minds can give them a false sense of accomplishment.

These types often love ideas and speculation more than the realities of follow-through. As a result, they risk being outpaced by those who simply sit down and do the work. This can earn these types a reputation for being “armchair analysts” – and,

at times, Analyst personalities may forget that they actually need to test their ideas in the real world.

Driven by Curiosity

Analysts are innately curious. This helps them to ensure that their ideas are workable, rather than just clever. These personality types have a strong drive to learn, and they want to find out things for themselves rather than accept received wisdom. These types may be found stockpiling books, questioning teachers, spurring debates, or driving conversations in forums across the Internet.

Analysts are also relentless self-improvers. Once they've recognized a flaw, they apply all of their rationality, imagination, and desire for results to make it right. Especially when it's balanced with self-understanding, this drive can enable Analyst personalities to push the boundaries of what's possible – no matter what anyone else may think.

Socially Selective

Analysts can have a reputation for being lone wolves. These personality types don't necessarily care about befriending everyone they meet, and they definitely don't surround themselves with random people just for the sake of having some company.

Given a choice between spending time with someone incompatible or spending time alone, many Analysts would choose the latter. And they may not be so subtle about it. 71% of people with Analyst personality types say they're good at shutting down unwanted conversations – far more than any other Role. This brusqueness can make Analysts seem rude, unapproachable, or antisocial, particularly to types that value social harmony.

That said, it's important to note that only 17% of Analysts actually describe their ideal social life as "mostly by myself." Much greater numbers – 30% and 41% respectively – say they'd prefer to have a few good friends or a partner and a few good friends. As a result, it's inaccurate to view these personality types as antisocial.

Instead, it makes sense to view Analysts as socially selective. Like other types, they crave social connection. But these personalities won't feel socially fulfilled by spending time with just anyone. They want to surround themselves with people who really get them – even if it takes effort to find those people. That might be why 46% of Analysts say they actively seek new friendships – which is more than any other Role except Diplomats.

Independent Minds

Analysts have little patience for following in others' footsteps. 58% of these personality types describe themselves as "very independent" – far more than any other Role. Independence isn't just a characteristic of these types – it's an important part of their self-image.

This mindset shows up vividly in how Analysts approach academic and professional settings. These personality types are questioners, reluctant to take anything on faith. And "anything" includes what their teachers or bosses say.

From the outside, this might look like a lack of respect. In our Teachers Survey, Analysts were far less likely than other Roles to say they admired their past teachers. And this mindset persists in the professional sphere as well. 43% of Analysts in the workforce say they would be better than their boss at their boss's job – again, far more than any other Role. Analyst personalities are also far less likely than other Roles to express admiration for their bosses.

But does this represent a lack of respect? Maybe – but this choosiness might well have other roots. Analysts tend to hold themselves to high standards, and they often hold the people around them (bosses and teachers included) to these high standards as well. In addition, Analyst personality types tend to care a great deal about learning and professional success. 85% of Analysts say they have a strong desire to be an important and successful person.

It makes sense, then, that these personality types hold their teachers and bosses to rigorous standards. After all, an Analyst with a poor teacher or boss may be less likely to become successful. Of course, Analysts – just like anyone – will almost certainly find themselves faced with a less-than-stellar teacher or boss. As a result, figuring out how to navigate these situations is an important part of their development.

Problems? What Problems?

You know who talks a lot about their problems? Not Analysts. In fact, 83% of Analysts say that most people complain too much about their problems.

But that doesn't mean that people with these personality types don't *think* about their problems, and they certainly don't shy away from challenges. 61% of Analysts say they're excited by the idea of being responsible for solving problems, and 85% say they enjoy tackling difficult challenges.

A core strength of Analysts is their faith in their problem-solving abilities. Analyst personalities tend to express the highest intellectual self-confidence of any Role, and this gives them the willingness to try their hand at things that may be hard. Taken too far, this can turn into cockiness – which is rarely an asset, whether in relationships or in other spheres. But as long as Analysts balance their intellectual self-assurance

with their innate curiosity, these personality types can find success and even enjoyment in the face of challenges both large and small.

Diplomats – Intuitive (N) and Feeling (F)

Longing for Connection

Diplomat personality types – Advocates (INFJ), Mediators (INFP), Protagonists (ENFJ), and Campaigners (ENFP) – care about helping and connecting with others. They prioritize being kind and generous, and in general, they'd rather cooperate than compete. Empathy seems to come naturally to these personalities. It can almost seem as if their hearts and minds resonate with other people's emotions.

These types aim to understand themselves and others. They often have deep insights into human nature, and they can use these insights to influence the people around them. Fortunately, Diplomat personality types tend to do this with care. They are sensitive to other people's feelings, and they want to nudge the people around them in positive directions.

Striving for Change

Diplomats have a deep belief in the ideals of humanism – altruism, compassion, and understanding. These personality types believe it is possible to create a kinder world, and they strive to do so every day.

The Intuitive trait fuels this optimism. Paradoxically, though, it also makes these types hyper-sensitive to wrongdoing. This sensitivity provides Diplomat personalities with the motivation they need to tackle injustice, which is important. If left unchecked, however, this personality trait can trigger self-righteousness or single-mindedness.

In general, Diplomats are motivated by principles rather than practicality. This helps them to stay true to their big dreams and ideas. That said, these types may have trouble enacting plans that are pragmatic rather than passion-driven. Diplomats can be tempted to ignore day-to-day tasks in favor of their big dreams and ideas. As these personalities mature, however, they often learn to balance these necessary tasks with the big-picture thinking they enjoy.

A Higher Purpose

Among friends and family, Diplomat personalities can range from quietly caring to brightly gregarious. Unfortunately, their open hearts can make them vulnerable when others are inconsiderate. That said, these types wouldn't have it any other way. Someone must trust first, and Diplomats will almost always volunteer.

These personality types see magical beauty where others see the humdrum of daily life. This trait attracts many Diplomats to creative expression. These types can be passionately inspired by music, writing, cuisine, theater – or many other creative pursuits.

Diplomats want to bring progress and beauty to the world around them. These types are led by a sense of higher purpose, and they care about serving the greater good. As a result, activism, spirituality, healing, and volunteering are common interests for these personality types.

The Need to Belong

For Diplomats, authenticity and connection aren't just buzzwords. These concepts – which might seem vague or wishy-washy to other types – form the bedrock of

Diplomats' lives. This explains why relationships matter so much to these personality types – and not just *any* type of relationship, but rather real, meaningful bonds.

When asked about their ideal social life, only 8% of Diplomats would like to spend most of their time alone. Instead, the majority of Diplomats express a desire for a partner and a few good friends. These personalities may also worry more about loneliness than other types, with nearly two thirds of Diplomats saying they worry about being lonely in their old age.

For many Diplomats, a central challenge of their lives is to balance their need for authenticity with their need to belong. More than any other personality Role, Diplomats say that the need to belong often motivates them to do things they otherwise wouldn't. This sort of behavior might not bother other types, but it poses a real dilemma for Diplomats. Being fake can feel literally painful to these types, who long to be loved and accepted for who they are, not for their ability to fit in.

For Diplomats, an important part of self-development is learning to be real – even if they fear that doing so won't make them popular. The irony is that many Diplomat personalities only feel a deep sense of belonging and connection once they learn to approach relationships as their whole, true selves.

What is Success, Anyway?

If your life goals are to earn pots of money, land an impressive job, buy a fancy car, and be better than everyone else – well, you're probably not a Diplomat.

But that isn't to say that Diplomats don't have their own type of ambition. 85% of Diplomats say it's important to them to make a lasting impact on other people, outside of their family and closest friends. In other words, these personality types

want to make a lasting difference in the world – which is no small feat. This might explain why Diplomats are second only to Analysts in saying that they sometimes set impossibly high standards for themselves.

Perhaps because they have such a lofty view of success, Diplomats are the Role least likely to consider themselves successful. It's important to note that the great majority of people with these personality types still say they'd be upset if they never became successful. As a result, many people with these types may feel as if they're constantly striving toward ideals and expectations that they'll never meet.

To address this sense of inadequacy, many Diplomats find they must let go of comparisons to other people. 79% of Diplomats say they consciously compare themselves to others either often or very often. By releasing these comparisons, Diplomats can free themselves to do things their own way, in their own time – rather than fretting over whether they're successful yet.

Time to Leap

You know that expression, “Leap and the net will appear”? Diplomat personality types can fall into the trap of thinking they've leapt – metaphorically speaking – when they're actually still perched at the ledge. Because these personalities have such active mental lives and imaginations, they can forget that thinking about starting a business isn't the same as actually starting a business, or that watching videos of dancers isn't the same as throwing themselves into a pirouette.

For many Diplomats, the secret to tackling their greatest challenge is simply to take action. Of course, that's easier said than done. The majority of Diplomats say they overthink simple tasks – so you can only imagine how much they might overthink major life decisions or their most precious dreams.

Fortunately, Diplomats tend to have a deep intuitive sense of what is right for them. Many of these personality types find that by tuning into this wisdom – and honoring it – they can find satisfaction and meaning in their everyday lives, no matter what challenges arise along the way.

Sentinels – Observant (S) and Judging (J)

Character and Competence

Sentinels – Logisticians (ISTJ), Defenders (ISFJ), Executives (ESTJ), and Consuls (ESFJ) – are cooperative, practical, and grounded. They feel comfortable with who they are, and they take pride in their good character and their competence. These personality types seek order, security, and stability, and they tend to work hard to maintain their way of things. This leads to a deserved reputation as the cornerstone of any group or organization, from family to church to the office and the factory floor.

Careful and consistent, Sentinel personalities tend to be self-motivated. This means that they rarely need external inspiration to be productive and focused. They work hard and aim never to let anyone down, and they expect other people to embrace this same ethic as well. Given a choice, these personality types prefer to collaborate within a clear set of rules. Following proven methods makes more sense to them than swanning around in search of innovation. Their motto is, “If it works, don’t break it.”

Steady Progress

That said, Sentinels are hardly unimaginative. They simply take inspiration from the past rather than the future. These personality types remain loyal to established best practices and traditions, whether that’s the best way to make a pizza crust or the

most efficient way to write an algorithm. This enables them to make steady, consistent progress – which is exactly what they enjoy. Sentinels would much rather guide a single project to completion than start (and abandon) a flurry of interesting ideas.

Sentinel personalities thrive in environments that have clear hierarchies and rules. Whether or not they're in a formal leadership role, they care about setting a good example, and they gain great satisfaction from guiding a well-functioning group. This can make them excellent teachers, managers, and community officials, as well as caring parents and hosts.

Guidance and Wisdom

In their personal lives, Sentinels want to offer stability and wisdom to others. They see it as their duty to give their families safe, happy lives that prepare them for the real world. An appreciation of strong relationships allows these personality types to share generously with those they respect and love. Sentinels feel bolstered by having reliable people in their lives, and they make sure they hold up their end of the bargain. Birthdays, dinner parties, and camping trips are delightful events under their enthusiastic direction.

These personality types are happiest without drama – though they can occasionally be stubborn. In particular, inconsistent people can test Sentinels' patience. It can be difficult for Sentinel personalities to accept people who lack their conscientiousness. Fortunately, they often serve as engaged and caring mentors to those who wish to grow in that direction.

Love and Care

Sentinels are the personality Role least likely to say they fall in love easily – but don't let that fool you. Sentinels may not spout love poems, but they do express affection and admiration – they just do it a little differently than other personality types. Sentinels often show their love in practical ways, such as checking the tires on their partner's car or making them a nutritious dinner. To other types, these actions might not look romantic, but Sentinels do these things with love and care.

In all of their relationships, Sentinels want to make contributions. This attitude informs how they treat not only their nearest and dearest but also their acquaintances, neighbors, and coworkers. These aren't the personality types who neglect their responsibilities or leave the office kitchen a mess – in fact, they're often the types who quietly clean up other people's messes, both literal and metaphorical.

Of course, Sentinels wouldn't *mind* being recognized for the ways they help others, but these personalities rarely demand attention. Instead, they work behind the scenes to make everyone's lives run as smoothly as possible, even if that means taking on unglamorous tasks like remembering to buy toilet paper or handling their family's income taxes. They may not be obvious with their feelings, but Sentinels do care and care deeply – you just have to know how to spot it.

Due Diligence

Sentinels have a core set of principles that they bring to their academic and professional pursuits. These principles include diligence, honesty, and respect. The result is that Sentinel personality types tend to work hard, striving to meet deadlines, and generally get things done. This can be seen even from a relatively young age –

Sentinels are far more likely than other Roles to say that they developed productive work habits in school.

These personality types have a clear vision of what it means to do things “right,” and they take great pride in living up to these standards. Sentinels are rarely willing to cut corners and do shoddy work – even if doing so would help them get ahead. They are less likely than any other Role to say that they could compromise some of their principles to advance their career.

Above all, Sentinels stand out for their ability to stick with their work until it’s done – even if the work is tedious or rote. These personality types are far less likely than others to say that they often abandon work in favor of doing something more interesting and fun, and they’re also less likely to say that they get distracted from what they’re working on. For Sentinels, productivity is a bit of a superpower – and they get great satisfaction from exercising their ability to get things done.

Planning Ahead

Sentinels know the value of a well-made plan. Compared to other Roles, Sentinel personalities are far more likely to say they’d rather prepare for problems rather than tackle them as they arise. And Sentinels aren’t afraid to think up every contingency that might arise – as long as they can do something to avert disaster, that is.

Of course, we can’t prepare for everything – although if anyone could, it would be a Sentinel. Like everyone else, these types must occasionally face unforeseen problems. Learning to roll with the punches, so to speak, is an important part of their personal development. Over time, Sentinels can learn to distinguish between when they should stick with their plans and when they’d do well to change course. And

when they do so, these personality types can press through even the most challenging of circumstances, bringing together determination and adaptability.

Explorers – Observant (S) and Prospecting (P)

On the Fly

Explorers – Virtuosos (ISTP), Adventurers (ISFP), Entrepreneurs (ESTP), and Entertainers (ESFP) – tend to be self-reliant and quick-thinking. These personality types don't mind handling uncertain situations on the fly – in fact, they live for those types of situations. Explorers' flexibility helps them to adapt to the moment, even if they don't feel particularly prepared.

These types tend not to be obsessed with precise detail – unless they're really in the zone, in which case they can muster a level of precision and focus that would make a seasoned engineer blush with envy. Usually, they prefer workability and usefulness to perfection. Explorer personalities enjoy learning different tools and techniques, from rotary saws to sheet music to emergency response strategies.

Living for Change

Explorers can change their minds with minimal regret or second-guessing. People in this Role dislike monotony, and they may stray from their obligations in order to try new things. If these personality types sometimes leave business unfinished, let clutter build up, or misplace important things – it's because they've moved on to something fresh.

These types enjoy being free of obligations, where they can indulge themselves or their interests on their own time. They love delving into something interesting, but their interest tends to wane as soon as something becomes "mandatory." An

Explorer personality might design and build their own dream house, but end up procrastinating on simple repairs after a few years.

Social Ingenuity

This free-form attitude can make Explorer personalities socially dynamic as well. Their spontaneity draws them to appealing strangers and interesting experiences. When things get in the way of a good time, they apply their ingenuity to get around it. Explorers want to see what happens next!

Explorers enjoy being on the leading edge of things – whether that means having the latest technology, trying out fashion trends, or checking out the newest restaurant in town. Many Explorer personalities enjoy sharing these findings with others, and they take pride in introducing their friends and loved ones to the latest and greatest things. The result is that time spent with Explorers is almost never boring or repetitive – and Explorers wouldn't have it any other way.

Explorers in Love

Explorer personality types have a reputation for constantly being on the move – and some people might wonder whether this restlessness applies to their romantic relationships as well. According to our research, however, relatively few Explorers (32%) say they're easily bored by romantic relationships that are stable and predictable. In fact, Analysts and Diplomats are significantly more likely to agree with this statement.

So, what *are* Explorers like in romantic relationships? First, Explorers are slightly less likely than other Roles to say that falling in love scares them. These personality types thrive in unpredictable situations, and what is falling in love if not unpredictable? The

early phases of a relationship are energizing for these types – full of new experiences and fresh discoveries.

It's true that Explorer personalities are somewhat more likely than other Roles to avoid commitment. Still, the majority of Explorers – 63% – say they usually seek commitment in their relationships. And overall, Explorers are slightly more likely than average to say that intimate relationships have increased their maturity more than anything else. So, while Explorers might have a reputation for being commitment-phobes, it's clear that these personality types see the deeper value of long-term relationships – and, more often than not, this is exactly what they're looking for.

Doing the Work

Explorers are highly spontaneous, connecting with their environment in a way that's almost childlike in its wonder and sheer fun. But when they need to work on something that's frustrating or unexciting – well, that can prove something of a challenge.

This may show up in how Explorer personality types approach their academic and professional lives. Explorers are slightly less likely than other Roles to say that they developed productive work habits in school. They're also less likely to say that it was easy for them to do well in school. Many school environments are relatively prescriptive, filled with required courses and standardized curricula. As a result, Explorer personalities often find themselves forced to sit through classes that just don't excite them – which, for these types, can be unmotivating. Unfortunately, this can persist in their professional lives as well – after all, most jobs require at least some degree of routine, unglamorous work.

This isn't to say that Explorers are slouches – far from it. When they're working on something they're passionate about, these personality types can move heaven and earth. And, over time, they often find ways to deal with the necessary evils – in other words, the unexciting tasks – that make work and life run more smoothly.

Perhaps it's most accurate to say that Explorers look for ways to balance work with leisure. They're the Role least likely to say they make themselves finish all of their tasks before they allow themselves to relax. While some personality types might brand this behavior as laziness, this isn't necessarily the case. Explorers' ability to balance work with fun can help them avoid burnout. Ultimately, this can help them to enjoy more fulfillment – and yes, a surprising degree of productivity – in their lives.

The Power of Risk

51% of Explorers say they take risks simply for the fun of it – far more than any other personality Role. This might sound reckless, and indeed it can be. But, done responsibly, risk-taking can be one of the best ways to learn new things, solve tricky problems, and grow as people. As Explorers know, we can only make so much progress in life if we stay in our comfort zones.

As long as they temper this trait with a degree of self-control, comfort with risk can be one of Explorers' greatest strengths. It can motivate them to open up in their relationships and empower them to seek out new academic and professional opportunities.

These personality types don't resign themselves to the "lives of quiet desperation" that Henry David Thoreau famously wrote of in *Walden*. Instead, Explorers can use their own brand of bravery to free themselves from conventionality and create lives that work for them.

Strategies

The word “strategy” suggests a course of action. In our use, Strategy describes how personality types act in response to the world around them and how they might choose to accomplish things.

Strategies express themselves primarily in two ways: social style and resistance to stress. Social style entails how other people factor into an individual’s Strategy and to what degree. One example might involve whether a person prefers working in a team or alone.

Resistance to stress includes the degree of impact that a stressful situation might have on an individual and their efforts, as well as how resilient they might be when trying to restore themselves after a challenging event. An example of this might involve whether a person quits after a jarring setback or presses forward.

The Energy aspect (Introverted/Extraverted) brings to each combination a social piece. When individuals pursue their goals or satisfy their needs and wants, to what degree will they involve other people? Do they want to achieve things independently, or are they collaborators and team players? Extraverted personality types often wish to have more people around, and Introverts tend to prefer doing things more independently.

But the Energy aspect also speaks to risk and taking leaps of faith. Extraverts tend to be more adventurous, and they are brimming with enthusiasm for the activities in their lives – especially if they involve other people. Introverts feel a pull toward lone activities and are usually calmer and quieter, preferring quiet and solitude or smaller, more intimate groups when possible. Introverted personality types are not as interested in adventures as their Extraverted counterparts.

The Identity aspect (Assertive/Turbulent) describes levels of confidence and resistance to stress. It helps us understand what might motivate someone. Are they being pulled along by their self-confidence, or are they pushed to excel because they are perfectionists focused on preventing mistakes and failures?

Assertive personalities are much less likely to worry about things – even results. Their motivation may involve boldly realizing the potential that they assume they have. They are less concerned with the opinions of others and may stand up to their critics – not to impress them but to “correct” them. Turbulent personalities are self-conscious, cautious, and perfectionistic. They may go one of two ways. They may push themselves to high levels of success to avoid disappointment in themselves, or they may opt out of doing something because of the potential for stress and the chance of failure.

In summary, Strategies combine the Energy aspect and the Identity aspect. Together, they describe how individuals respond to life and reflect their preferred ways of doing things. When merged, the Energy and Identity personality traits influence many areas of life, including social preferences, confidence, stress, and risk-taking, to name a few.

The Strategy layer shows our preferred ways of doing things and achieving goals. There are four strategies:

Confident Individualism – Introverted (I) and Assertive (-A)

Substance Over Superficiality

Confident Individualists tend to trust in themselves. They enjoy their own company and don't mind spending time alone to pursue their interests. Over time, this can give these personalities an impressive range of skills and interesting ideas.

But these types take pride in their skills for their own sake, not to impress others. They tend not to see the point in social displays and bragging. While they're proud of who they are, these personality types don't always feel the need to prove themselves to anyone else. They prefer substance to superficiality and personal honesty to playing along.

Confident Individualists are motivated by their inner world rather than outside expectations. They're opinionated, but they aren't excessively worried about what others think. These personality types express their thoughts unapologetically. They're rarely pressured into agreeing with others – even if agreeing would be more convenient.

Self-Assurance and Self-Reliance

If left unchecked, this relaxed self-assurance can lead to complacency. These personality types' live-and-let-live attitude goes both ways: They don't push others to change, and in return, they don't particularly want anyone to push them to change. At times, Confident Individualists may miss information and opportunities that challenge their views because they simply don't place much importance on others' approval.

In their personal relationships, these types tend to be strong and honest. Their loyalty and affection are genuine rather than forced. These personalities only express respect and care if they really feel them. Fortunately, if they do feel them, they see no reason to hide how they feel.

No matter how strong their relationships, these types also value self-reliance. They can handle difficult situations well because they tend to be emotionally secure and resistant to stress. Although these personalities rarely seek the spotlight, their quiet examples of determination and honesty can be nothing short of inspiring.

Confident Individualists in Love

Confident Individualists tend to be a bit choosy about their closest confidants. This is especially true when it comes to finding a romantic partner. Perhaps because Confident Individualists know how to find contentment and fulfillment even when they're single, they're in no rush to settle for a partner who's less than a good match.

These personality types may also be less likely to stay with a partner who lets them down. Confident Individualists are less likely than any other personality Strategy to say they often give second chances to those who fail to fulfill commitments to them. Again, perhaps because of their strong intrinsic sense of worth, these types don't necessarily feel compelled to stay in a relationship that isn't working out.

Confident Individualists are the Strategy least likely to say they believe in soulmates. They're also the least likely to say they know a lot of couples whose marriages they envy, or would aspire to have. And it might not come as a surprise, then, that they're the most likely to say they don't want to get married.

It would be inaccurate, however, to assume that Confident Individualists are lone wolves with no interest in committed intimate relationships. The majority of these personality types – 79% – *do* express an interest in getting married. A similar percentage say they're unafraid of being committed to a single partner for the rest of their lives. It's true that Confident Individualists are independent, and they probably won't get into a relationship just for the sake of being in a relationship. That said, these types often do have an interest in romantic connection – they just want to find the right person before they become attached.

Unlikely Leaders

Confident Individualists bring their love of independence into their academic and professional pursuits. They're more likely than any other Strategy to say that learning as part of a group is distracting rather than helpful. As you can imagine, group projects can be frustrating for these personality types – whether at school or in the workplace.

This isn't to say that Confident Individualists *can't* work well with others – far from it. But if given a choice, these types would prefer to operate independently and figure things out on their own. At school, these personalities may be drawn to independent study opportunities. At work, they may try to develop a specific area of expertise that allows them to make their own decisions and do most of their tasks on their own.

From this description, Confident Individualists might not sound like natural leaders, but that isn't necessarily the case. Just over half of these personality types say they're inclined to seek out leadership and management roles. This is well less than their Extraverted peers, but it's still a majority. In addition, nearly 70% of these types say

they have excellent leadership skills. A quick look at famous Confident Individualists includes real-life leaders (Bill Gates) as well as fictional ones (Gandalf).

Confident Individualists tend to hone their ideas and skills on their own, and they often prefer to work alone. That said, these personalities may be willing to take up the reins of leadership if that's what is necessary to turn those ideas and skills into real-world progress.

The Right Mindset

Confident Individualists are more likely than any other personality Strategy to say that control over their mindset is the most important factor in determining their happiness. On average, they rank their mindset as a more significant factor in their happiness than their financial situation, their friends and family, their job, or their health.

This statistic reveals a great deal about Confident Individualists. These personality types believe in their personal effectiveness and their individual worth, and they know how important it is to maintain this mindset. As long as they balance this self-conviction with a willingness to learn from others, Confident Individualists' positive mindset can become a self-fulfilling prophecy, helping these personalities to not only achieve great things but also find lasting happiness.

People Mastery – Extraverted (E) and Assertive (-A)

Bold and Confident

Personality types with the People Mastery Strategy are known for their ability to handle stress. This helps them to act boldly and maintain confidence, even in the face of challenges or criticism.

Thanks to this confidence, people with this Strategy feel energized and at ease in social situations. They seek social contact as well as stimulating and challenging experiences. These personalities like traveling to see things, people, and places, and trying something new – even things they don't end up liking can be exciting for them.

Nothing to Prove?

If they don't keep themselves in check, though, People Masters can become too confident. These personality types tend to be insulated against self-doubt and the need to prove themselves. As a result, they don't always test, or even consider, their own limits or ambitions.

Taken to the extreme, this can create a pattern of comfort-seeking. They may even roll their eyes at people who chase more intimidating goals. At the other end of the spectrum, these personality types can ignore sensible caution, landing themselves in extraordinary and dangerous situations.

At times, People Masters may not be considerate to those who aren't able to maintain such a comfortable boldness. But this doesn't have to be the case, by any means. By taking others into account, these personalities can actually help to draw other people out of their shells in a way that's energizing and empowering.

Finding Balance

Fortunately, most People Masters fall somewhere in the middle. Ideally, they embrace healthy ambition while finding social fulfillment and connection. Social interaction plays a big part in People Masters' happiness. Although these personality types are self-confident, they still appreciate praise and recognition. They don't need

people's approval, but they still crave friends and loved ones with whom to share their lives.

These types may be opinionated, but they don't always worry about having others agree with them. This can help these personalities to be moderate even in disagreements because their ego and confidence aren't at stake the way they often are for Turbulent Strategies. People Masters are not fond of grudges, and at heart, they want to bring people together to make things happen.

These types often stand out for their charisma and self-assurance. As long as they don't use their talents to steamroll or put down others, these personality traits can be quite appealing. These types have little fear of rejection, and they love including others. This can make these personalities wonderful friends, loved ones, and colleagues, who always aim to energize those around them.

People Masters in Love

According to our research, People Masters seem to fall in love a bit more frequently than the other Strategies. They're also less likely to say that falling in love scares them. It's easy to imagine why this is the case – People Masters' Extraversion leads them into situations where they're likely to meet new people, and their Assertive personality trait helps them to feel confident about the prospect of new relationships.

Some might wonder whether this would make People Masters less reliable than other personality types when it comes to being a good partner. Is it possible that these types' self-assurance would make them complacent or uncommitted once they're actually *in* a relationship? Not necessarily: About half of People Masters say it's necessary to go out of their way to please someone they love, and this response

puts them on par with other types. In addition, People Masters are the Strategy least likely to say that long-term commitments make them anxious.

In other words, although People Masters' confidence and social ease might make them sound like players, these types can be as committed and eager to please their partners as anyone else. And being in a relationship with a People Master can be a wonderful thing – even for people who are completely different. After all, People Masters' social energy and their can-do take on life can be infectious in the best possible way.

Speaking Up

People Masters don't tend to filter their opinions. These personality types say what they think, and they think what they say. As with nearly any trait, this can be a strength or a weakness.

People Masters are often seen as straight-shooters who can be trusted to speak honestly. In academic and professional settings, many teachers, classmates, colleagues, and managers appreciate this quality. After all, if used appropriately, candor is a powerful way to connect with other people. The “what you see is what you get” nature of a People Master personality can be refreshing, whether in the classroom or the workplace.

But there's a difference between being candid and being rude – and at times, People Masters may toe that line. In academic settings, this can put them at odds with their teachers and classmates. And in professional settings, these personality types may gain a reputation for being inconsiderate, arrogant, or even ruthless.

Learning to speak honestly *without* speaking over other people is a step on many People Masters' path to personal development. Fortunately, once they master this balance, People Masters can unleash the many gifts they bring to their schooling and their work. In particular, People Masters can excel at dealing with awkward or tense interpersonal situations – whether that's getting a group project back on track or delivering bad news to a customer in a straightforward but considerate way.

Going for It

79% of People Masters say they see problems as opportunities. These personality types trust themselves to tackle hard problems – *and* to gain insight and experience from the process. Ideally, this conviction becomes a self-fulfilling prophecy, with People Masters taking on ever harder challenges and learning important lessons along the way.

What sets People Masters apart isn't just their confidence, however. It's also their willingness to team up with others. These personalities know that we tend to be more effective when we collaborate and ask for help. People Masters can be especially good at creating opportunities for the people around them to use their strengths. And that may just be one of the secrets to People Masters' success.

Constant Improvement – Introverted (I) and Turbulent (-T)

Sensitive Souls

Constant Improvers tend to be sensitive and introspective. They are often deep individuals who enjoy having their own space and freedom. In general, these personality types feel more comfortable on their own than mixed up in the judgment of the real world.

This may be because they share the two personality traits most representative of sensitivity to their environment – Introversion and Turbulence. As a result, they may find it stressful to deal with tense environments or new situations. In these moments, Constant Improvers can be deeply uncomfortable – although they may not want to let on how they really feel. In reaction, these personalities might retreat inward, react defensively, or try to escape the situation altogether. Alternatively, they might give up their own wants or needs in an effort to keep the peace.

Driven by Doubt

Constant Improvers tend to experience self-doubt. They have a strong drive, but it comes paired with a strong fear of failure. These personality types invest a great deal of their identity in their successes. As a result, even a minor misstep or embarrassment can be crushing.

On the upside, this vigilance offers these personality types a knack for sensing trouble. This can be quite useful in situations that need to balance risk and reward – whether a financial investment or a romantic opportunity. When faced with a potential risk, these types look for ways to prevent problems. Although it slows them down in the short term, this approach can prevent longer-term issues.

Constant Improvers direct much of their attention toward their personal interests. They strive to master hobbies, careers, or new means of self-expression. This level of dedication can create impressive, beautiful results.

People with Constant Improvement personality types can be perfectionistic, dedicating tremendous time and energy to their pursuits. Unfortunately, if they put too much pressure on themselves, this approach can backfire. For example, Constant

Improvers may feel forced to abandon an endeavor because a single detail doesn't line up right.

Reality and Romance

At times, Constant Improvers may experience a nagging feeling that something is missing from their lives. It's worth noting that often this really is just a feeling, not a reflection of reality. These personality types have it in their nature always to be seeking something more – even if their lives actually are going just fine.

But as Constant Improvers assess their lives, wondering what might be missing, they may find themselves focusing on their romantic relationships – or lack thereof. These types are significantly less likely than their Assertive counterparts (also known as Confident Individualists) to say that they enjoy being single. And these personalities are more likely than Confident Individualists to say they often construct an ideal partner in their heads when they're single.

Although Constant Improvers may find themselves longing for romance, they don't necessarily find it easy to start up a relationship. They're less likely than other personality Strategies to say that they usually take the initiative in asking someone out. This makes sense, given that Constant Improvers can feel hesitant about putting themselves out there – and asking someone out is an incredibly vulnerable position to be in.

This might sound like bad news, but it doesn't have to be. As they grow and mature, Constant Improvers often learn how to transform their feeling that something is missing into positive energy – and by doing so, they not only discover gratitude for the good things in their lives, but also become proactive about making helpful

changes. This mindset shift can empower these personality types to find fulfillment in their relationships – as well as in every other aspect of their lives.

The “Right” Career?

Constant Improvers’ longing for “something more” extends to their professional lives. Just over a quarter of these types say that their career is a great fit for them – a rate of agreement that is less than the other Strategies.

This doesn’t necessarily mean that Constant Improvers are in the wrong careers for them – although they might wonder if they are. More than half of these personality types say they often think about switching careers, and they’re more likely than the other Strategies to say that they feel stuck in their current job.

This restlessness doesn’t have to be a bad thing. In fact, restlessness can be an incredible motivator to do great things. The trouble comes when Constant Improvers feel trapped: wanting to make a change, but suspecting they’re unable or helpless to do so. This feeling can have a number of roots, such as self-doubt or a general worry that other people don’t “get” them.

As in other areas of their lives, Constant Improvers who pursue personal growth often discover that their feeling of helplessness is exactly that – a *feeling*. This can be a powerful discovery. In its wake, these personality types are better able to harness their personal and professional strengths and deal with their feeling of “stuckness.” This may take the form of finding a new career, or it might involve advocating for themselves in their current workplaces so that they get more of their needs met. Either way, Constant Improvers often find that they have more agency in their professional lives than they’d realized.

The Strength of Sensitivity

In general, Constant Improvers care a great deal about what others think of them. This can trigger insecurity, to be sure, but when kept in balance, it can create some truly wonderful traits. These personalities are often curious about and sensitive to others' feelings. This can make them excellent listeners, friends, confidants, and partners.

Some types might think that sensitivity is synonymous with weakness, but Constant Improvers know that isn't the case. These personality types often exemplify how sensitivity and vulnerability can be hidden strengths. Their attunement to their own struggles and insecurities can help them to bond deeply with others. It can also motivate them to act with kindness and compassion.

Although they may not always realize it, Constant Improvers offer the world a wealth of gifts. Once they learn to trust themselves as much as they trust others' opinions, these personalities can shine.

Social Engagement – Extraverted (E) and Turbulent (-T)

Boldly Sensitive

Those with the Social Engagement Strategy are an interesting group. In some ways, Extraverted and Turbulent personality traits conflict with each other. Extraversion leads to risk-tolerance and boldness, and Turbulence leads to self-doubt and sensitivity.

This can mean that Social Engagers tend to do what comes naturally first and think about it later. In this way, they are almost an exaggeration of their underlying personality traits. This may sound like a bad thing, but it doesn't have to be.

Social Engagers venture into the world with enthusiasm. They enjoy being the center of attention and enjoy social status. At times, this may mean that they hide their true selves to impress other people, pretending to be someone else in order to be liked. Fortunately, Social Engagers' genuine interest in others often shines through, helping these personality types to create authentic connections with the people around them.

Social Engagers in Love

Romantic relationships aren't always the easiest – hence Shakespeare's observation that "the course of true love never did run smooth." You might think that Social Engagers' self-doubt would cause them to play it safe when it comes to the rough waters of love, but that isn't the case. These personality types tend to dive headlong into relationships – they're more likely than any other Strategy to say they fall in love easily. And they're also less likely to say they enjoy being single.

Social Engagers are far from passive about their romantic lives. These personalities care deeply about pleasing their partners – in fact, they're the Strategy most likely to believe they need to go out of their way to please the people they love. Social Engagers are deeply devoted, willing to pour all of their affection and care into their partner.

But not everyone is willing – or able – to do this in return. Social Engagers may feel it acutely if their partner doesn't seem equally affectionate or devoted. This can be especially challenging because these personality types care so deeply about receiving praise and admiration. As a result, they might feel hurt by a partner who is reserved in expressing their affection.

As they go through life, many Social Engagers discover that not everyone is as expressive as they are – and that’s okay. These types may need to use their social acumen to connect with the ways their partners *do* share love. For example, they may realize that their partner expresses affection through physical touch, spending time together, or even helping out around the house. Once they attune themselves to the ways other personalities demonstrate their love, Social Engagers can find incredible fulfillment and joy in their romantic relationships.

Working It

Social Engagers may find themselves drawn to lines of work that involve plenty of human interaction. The service industry can be a natural fit for these personality types, as can nearly any job that involves helping customers solve problems. Social Engagers are energized by the opportunity to talk with others, and they’re especially invigorated when they can tell that they’ve actually made someone’s day a little better.

This isn’t to say that Social Engagers are anything less than ambitious. In their own way, these personalities do care about being successful. Everyone has a unique definition of “success,” of course, but many Social Engagers feel especially successful when they receive recognition, such as awards, promotions, or positive feedback on their work. These types tend to be motivated by a desire to impress and please others – not only because they enjoy praise, but also because they genuinely value the good opinion of their bosses, coworkers, and customers. And of course a salary increase is always nice, too.

Social Engagers’ ambition and desire to please can make them wonderful employees and colleagues. At times, however, these personality types often discover a need to

pause and make sure they're being true to themselves as well. Their personal development path may lead them to consider their own values and needs – and make sure that their professional lives line up with these values and needs.

That said, these types know that their career is just one aspect of their lives. 74% of Social Engagers say they're always looking for new hobbies to get into – more than any other personality Strategy. Whether those hobbies include volleyball, viticulture, or volunteering, these types care about being well-rounded. Paradoxically, this well-roundedness can help them to find more enjoyment in their careers as well as in other aspects of their lives.

The Highs and the Lows

Social Engagers can experience highs and lows – sometimes within a matter of minutes. Their Extraversion can push their Turbulent need for success into overdrive. Meanwhile, their Turbulent personality trait can trigger almost instant self-doubt. Although these types are capable of taking quick action in a way that seems decisive, they may find themselves plagued by uncertainty afterward.

As they grow, many Social Engagers learn how to use this unusual combination of traits to their advantage. Their Extraversion can help them move past the self-doubt that comes with the Turbulent trait, enabling them to expand their comfort zones even when it isn't easy. Meanwhile, their Turbulent trait can help them to be more considerate in their boldness. The result is that these personality types can hold many contradictory traits in harmony, being both fun and responsible, active and reflective.

This push and pull can be stressful, but it's part of this Strategy's charm. These personality types chase their goals relentlessly, but they also indulge their desires

and seek out fun. Thanks to this balance, they can lead happy and fruitful lives – sharing adventures and accomplishments with others whenever possible. Whatever direction these personalities pull, they are sure to pull the crowd with them.

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